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THE BOOK OF COMMON USE FOR THE

INSULAR CHURCH

Being a Complete Guide to the Divine Liturgies,

Participation of the Faithful,

the Building of Churches, Confessions of Faith and the Apostolic Constitution

For the Western Churches of the Insular Realms

✠

Drawing upon the ancient Rites of Sarum, the Gallican Liturgy
of Saint Germanus of Paris, the English Low Mass,
the Liturgical Ordinances of the Council of Innisfallen,
and the Customs of the Insular Fathers

Set forth by Authority of

Corpo MacAirthir, Comharba Pátraic

Primate of Ireland, Archbishop & Abbot of Armagh

and

Abbot Níldríf of Innisfallen

With the Royal Assent of

King Robert I of Desmond • King Pal of England

✠

For the Use of Bishops, Priests, and Faithful in these Realms

In the Year of Our Lord MDXXXVIII

PART I: The Different Liturgies

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THE HOLY SACRIFICE OF THE MASS

according to the Use of the

INSULAR CHURCH

Being the Divine Liturgy for the Western Churches
of the Insular Realms

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King Robert I of Desmond • King Pal of England
King JackBones of the Marches(Wales) • High King Thrawn of Northumbria
King Viscobus of Scotland • The Six Kings of Ulaidh

✠

For the Use of Priests and Faithful in these Realms

In the Year of Our Lord MDXXXVIII

PREFACE

THIS Liturgy is set forth for the use of the whole Western Church within the Insular Realms, being compiled from the most ancient and venerable sources of Western worship: the Rite of Sarum, which hath been the glory of the English Church for four centuries and more; the Gallican Liturgy of Saint Germanus of Paris, which preserveth the most ancient worship of the Frankish and Celtic Churches; the English Low Mass as it hath been served by faithful priests and their ministers; and the Liturgical Ordinances of the Council of Innisfallen, which did rightly call for simplicity in worship, the active participation of the faithful, and the removal of all superstition from the sacred rites.

The Liturgy is designed to be celebrated in fifteen to thirty minutes, suitable for the conditions of worship in these Realms. It requireth one altar only, simply adorned, in accordance with the ancient custom and the Ordinances of the Council of Innisfallen. There shall be no altar but one in each church, and upon it no reliquaries nor flowers, but only the sacred vessels, the Book of Gospels, and two candles.

The Scripture readings appointed herein are drawn from the Vulgate of Saint Jerome, one of the Four Great Insular Latin Fathers, and are of fixed number: readings from the Old Testament, the Apostolic Letters, and the Holy Gospels, which may be combined according to the season and the judgment of the priest. These are chosen for their supreme theological importance and may be read in any fitting combination.

The Saints of the Insular Diptychs. This Liturgy is tied to the following Western Saints, who are commemorated in the Diptychs at every celebration: the Blessed Virgin Mary, Mother of God; Saint Michael the Archangel; Saint John the Baptist; the Holy Apostles Peter, Paul, James, and John; Saint Stephen the Protomartyr; Saint Patrick of Armagh; Saint Brigid of Kildare; Saint Columba of Iona; Saint David of Menevia; Saint Augustine of Canterbury; Saint Aidan of Lindisfarne; Saint Cuthbert of Durham; Saint Bede the Venerable; Saint Hilda of Whitby; Saint Dunstan of Canterbury; Saint Gregory the Great; Saint Ambrose of Milan; Saint Jerome of Bethlehem; Saint Augustine of Hippo; Paschasius Radbertus; Saint Anselm of Canterbury; Saint Maximus the Confessor; Pope Leo the Great; Saint Basil the Great; Saint Athanasius of Alexandria; Saint Gregory of Nazianzus; Saint John Chrysostom; Saint Germanus of Paris; Saint Martin of Tours; Saint Benedict of Nursia; Saint Alban, Protomartyr of Britain; and all the Saints.

THE ORDER OF THE HOLY SACRIFICE OF THE MASS

Ordo Sacrosanctae Missae secundum Usum Ecclesiae Insularis

I. THE PREPARATION

Praeparatio ad Missam

The Priest, vested in alb, stole, and chasuble, approacheth the altar with the server. He boweth profoundly before the altar. He maketh the sign of the Cross, saying:

Priest: In the Name of the Father, ✠ and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

Priest: I will go unto the altar of God.

People: Even unto the God of my joy and gladness.

The Priest and People say together the Confession:

I CONFESS to God Almighty, to blessed Mary ever Virgin, to blessed Michael the Archangel, to blessed John the Baptist, to the holy Apostles Peter and Paul, to all the Saints, and to you, brethren: that I have sinned exceedingly in thought, word, and deed, through my fault, through my fault, through my most grievous fault. Therefore I beg blessed Mary ever Virgin, blessed Michael the Archangel, blessed John the Baptist, the holy Apostles Peter and Paul, all the Saints, and you, brethren, to pray to the Lord our God for me.

Priest: May Almighty God have mercy upon you, forgive you your sins, and bring you to everlasting life.

People: Amen.

Priest: Wilt Thou not turn again and quicken us, O Lord?

People: That Thy people may rejoice in Thee.

Priest: O Lord, show Thy mercy upon us.

People: And grant us Thy salvation.

Priest: O Lord, hear my prayer.

People: And let my cry come unto Thee.

The Priest ascendeth the altar steps and kisseth the altar, saying in a low voice:

Priest: We beseech Thee, O Lord, by the merits of Thy Saints whose relics are here, and of all the Saints, that Thou wouldest vouchsafe to forgive me all my sins. Amen.

II. THE TRISAGION AND KYRIE

Trisagion et Kyrie

The Priest, facing the people, blesseth them:

Priest: The Lord ✠ be always with you.

People: And with thy spirit.

Then is said or sung the Trisagion, after the ancient Gallican manner:

Priest: Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal:

People: Have mercy on us.

Sanctus Deus, Sanctus Fortis, Sanctus Immortalis: miserere nobis.

Then the Kyrie:

Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy.

Christ, have mercy. Christ, have mercy. Christ, have mercy.

Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy.

Kyrie eleison. Christe eleison. Kyrie eleison.

III. THE COLLECT

On Sundays and Feasts, the Gloria in Excelsis may be said before the Collect. On ferial days it is omitted, in accordance with the Gallican use.

Priest: Let us pray.

The Priest saith the Collect of the Day, or the following General Collect:

Priest: O God, Who hast taught the hearts of Thy faithful people by sending to them the light of Thy Holy Spirit: grant us by the same Spirit to have a right judgment in all things, and evermore to rejoice in His holy comfort; through the merits of Christ Jesus our Saviour, Who liveth and reigneth with Thee, in the unity of the same Spirit, one God, world without end.

People: Amen.

IV. THE LITURGY OF THE WORD

Liturgia Verbi

The Old Testament Reading

The Lector boweth to the altar and saith:

Lector: Father, give a blessing.

Priest: Blessed ✠ be our God by the mouth of His holy Prophets.

The Lector readeth the appointed lesson from the Old Testament. At the end:

Lector: Here endeth the Lesson.

People: Thanks be to God.

The Apostolic Reading

The Lector boweth again:

Lector: Father, give a blessing.

Priest: Blessed ✠ be our God by the mouth of His holy Apostles.

The Lector readeth the appointed Epistle. At the end:

Lector: Here endeth the Epistle.

People: Thanks be to God.

The Holy Gospel

All stand. The Priest (or Deacon) taketh up the Book of Gospels. If incense is used, the Book is censed. The Priest saith:

Priest: The Lord be with you.

People: And with thy spirit.

Priest: A reading from the ✠ Holy Gospel according to Saint N.

People: Glory be to Thee, O Lord!

The Gospel is read. At the end:

Priest: This is the Gospel of the Lord.

People: Praise be to Thee, O Christ!

The Sermon

A brief Homily may be given. On Sundays it is fitting that some part of the Liturgy be explained to the people, as the Council of Innisfallen did rightly command.

V. THE CREED

Symbolum Fidei

On Sundays and Feasts the Nicene Creed is said. The Priest saith:

Priest: Let our lips be open and our mouths proclaim that which faith hath placed in our hearts.

I BELIEVE in one God, the Father Almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, and of all things visible and invisible. And in one Lord Jesus Christ, the only-begotten Son of God, begotten of the Father before all worlds; God of God, Light of Light, very God of very God; begotten, not made; being of one substance with the Father, by Whom all things were made; Who for us men, and for our salvation, came down from heaven, and was incarnate by the Holy Ghost of the Virgin Mary, and was made man; and was crucified also for us under Pontius Pilate. He suffered and was buried; and the third day He rose again according to the Scriptures; and ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of the Father. And He shall come again with glory to judge both the quick and the dead; Whose kingdom shall have no end. And I believe in the Holy Ghost, the Lord and Giver of Life, Who proceedeth from the Father through the Son; Who with the Father and the Son together is worshipped and glorified; Who spake by the Prophets. And I believe one holy Catholic and Apostolic Church. I acknowledge one Baptism for the remission of sins. And I look for the resurrection of the dead, and the life of the world to come. Amen.

VI. THE OFFERTORY

Offertorium

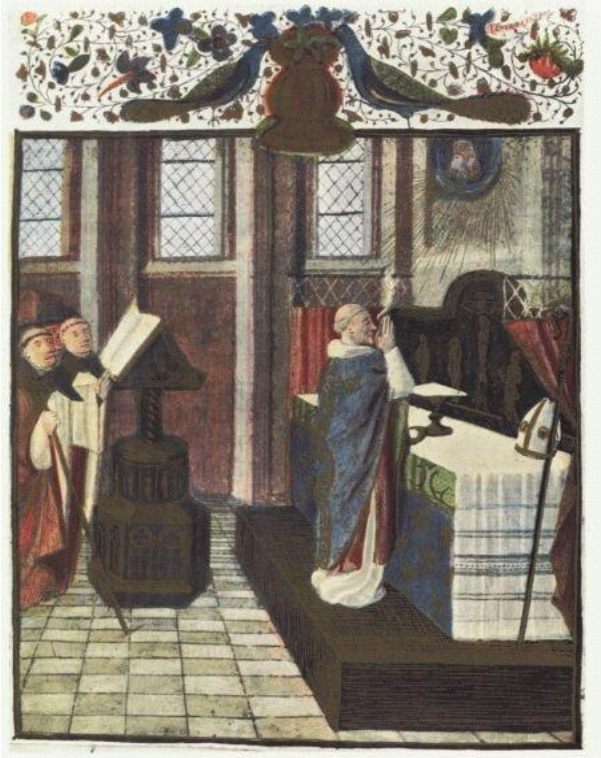

Fig. IV. — The Celebration of Mass, from a medieval illumination. The Priest standeth before the altar in chasuble, elevating his eyes toward the Sacrament reserved above. The Server attendeth at his side. Two clerics in the nave sing from a lectern. The altar is simply vested with a fair linen cloth.

The Priest, standing before the altar and facing the people, saith:

Priest: Beloved brethren, call upon the Holy Spirit with me, that He may grant me His ineffable power, and that I, an unworthy priest, might dare to offer the Holy Oblation of our Lord Jesus Christ; because in truth it is He Who offereth and is offered, He Who receiveth and Who distributeth, He Who is co-eternal with the Father and the Holy Spirit, world without end.

People: Amen. May the Holy Spirit descend upon thee, and the power of the Most High overshadow thee.

The Priest blesseth the bread and wine:

Priest: Receive, O holy Father, almighty and everlasting God, this spotless Host, which I, Thine unworthy servant, do offer unto Thee, my living and true God, for mine innumerable sins, offenses, and negligences; and for all here present, and for all faithful Christians, both living and departed; that it may avail both me and them unto salvation, unto life everlasting.

He poureth wine and a little water into the chalice:

Priest: O God, Who didst wonderfully create the dignity of human nature, and still more wonderfully restore it: grant that by the mystery of this water and wine, we may be made partakers

of His divinity Who vouchsafed to become partaker of our humanity, Jesus Christ Thy Son our Lord.

The Priest washeth his hands, saying:

Priest: I will wash my hands among the innocent, and I will encompass Thine altar, O Lord.

Turning to the people:

Priest: Pray, brethren, that my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable to God the Father Almighty.

People: The Lord receive the Sacrifice at thy hands, to the praise and glory of His Name, and to our benefit and that of all His holy Church.

The Kiss of Peace

The Priest saith:

Priest: Let us make peace!

Priest: May peace dwell among you like a season of tranquility.

The Peace is passed among the faithful. The one giving the peace saith: 'Peace be to you and to the Church.' The one receiving respondeth: 'And to thy spirit.'

VII. THE GREAT THANKSGIVING

Anaphora — Canon Sacrosanctae Missae

The Sursum Corda

Priest: The Lord be with you.

People: And with thy spirit.

Priest: Lift up your hearts.

People: We lift them up unto the Lord.

Priest: Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God.

People: It is meet and right so to do.

The Preface

Priest: IT is very meet, right, and our bounden duty, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto Thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God. For with Thine only-begotten

Son and Thy Holy Spirit, Thou art one God, one Lord: not in the unity of a single person, but in the Trinity of one substance. For that which we believe of Thy glory, through Thy revelation, so we also believe of Thy Son and of Thy Holy Spirit, without difference or distinction; so that in confessing the true and eternal Godhead, we worship the distinction of persons, oneness in being, and equality in majesty. Through Christ our Lord, through Whom Angels and Archangels, Thrones and Dominations, and all the host of heaven, do laud and magnify Thy glorious Name, evermore praising Thee and saying:

The Sanctus

People: HOLY, HOLY, HOLY, Lord God of Hosts. Heaven and earth are full of Thy glory. Hosanna in the highest! Blessed is He that cometh in the Name of the Lord. Hosanna in the highest!

Sanctus, Sanctus, Sanctus, Dominus Deus Sabaoth.

The Canon

The Priest, extending his hands over the oblation, prayeth the Canon in a clear voice audible to the people, as the Council of Innisfallen commended:

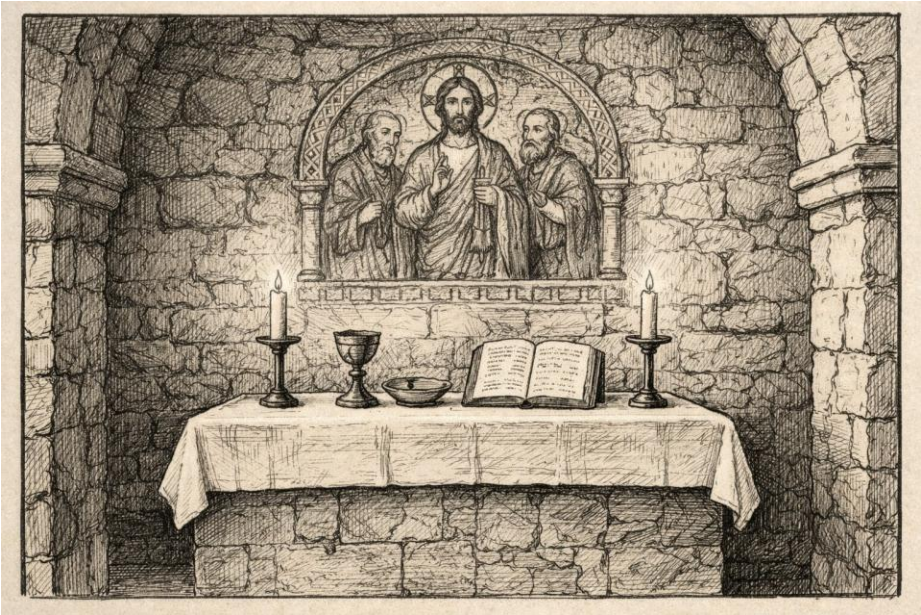

Fig. II. — The Holy Altar prepared for the Sacrifice. Upon the fair linen cloth: two candlesticks, the Chalice and Paten, and the open Missal. Behind the altar, a carved reredos showeth Christ in Majesty flanked by the Apostles Peter and Paul. No reliquaries nor flowers are upon the altar, in accordance with the Ordinances and the custom of antiquity.

Priest: THEE therefore, O most merciful Father, through Jesus Christ Thy Son our Lord, we humbly pray and beseech Thee to accept and bless these ✠ gifts, these ✠ offerings, these ✠ holy and unblemished sacrifices, which we offer unto Thee first for Thy holy Catholic Church: that Thou wouldest vouchsafe to keep it in peace, to preserve, unite, and govern it throughout the whole world; together with Thy servant N. our Bishop, N. our Patriarch, and all who hold the Catholic and Apostolic Faith.

The Diptychs of the Living

Here the Priest commemorateth the living:

Priest: REMEMBER, O Lord, Thy servants and handmaids N. and N., and all who here stand round about, whose faith is known unto Thee and whose devotion is manifest: who offer unto Thee this sacrifice of praise for themselves and all who are theirs, for the redemption of their souls, for the hope of their salvation and safety: and who pay their vows unto Thee, the eternal, living, and true God.

The Commemoration of Saints

Priest: IN communion with, and honouring the memory of, first the glorious and ever-Virgin Mary, Mother of our God and Lord Jesus Christ; likewise of blessed Michael the Archangel, of blessed John the Baptist; of the holy Apostles and Martyrs, Peter and Paul, James and John, Andrew, Stephen, and Alban; of the holy Fathers Patrick, Columba, Brigid, David, Augustine, Aidan, Cuthbert, Bede, Hilda, and Dunstan; of the Four Great Insular Latin Fathers: Gregory, Augustine of Hippo, Jerome, and Ambrose; of the Doctors of the Church: Paschasius, Maximus, Leo, Anselm, Basil, Athanasius, Gregory the Theologian, and Chrysostom; of blessed Germanus of Paris, Martin of Tours, and Benedict of Nursia; and of all Thy Saints: through whose merits and prayers grant that in all things we may be defended by the help of Thy protection. Through the same Christ our Lord. Amen.

The Epiclesis

The Priest layeth his hands upon the oblation and invoketh the Holy Spirit:

Priest: WE humbly beseech Thee, Almighty God: command that these offerings be borne by the hands of Thy holy Angel unto Thine altar on high, in the sight of Thy divine Majesty. And we pray Thee, O Lord, to send down Thy Holy Spirit upon these gifts, that He may make this bread the ✠ Body of Thy Christ, and this cup the ✠ Blood of Thy Christ; that they which do partake thereof may truly receive the most precious Body and Blood of Thy Son, and be fulfilled with all heavenly grace and benediction.

The Words of Institution

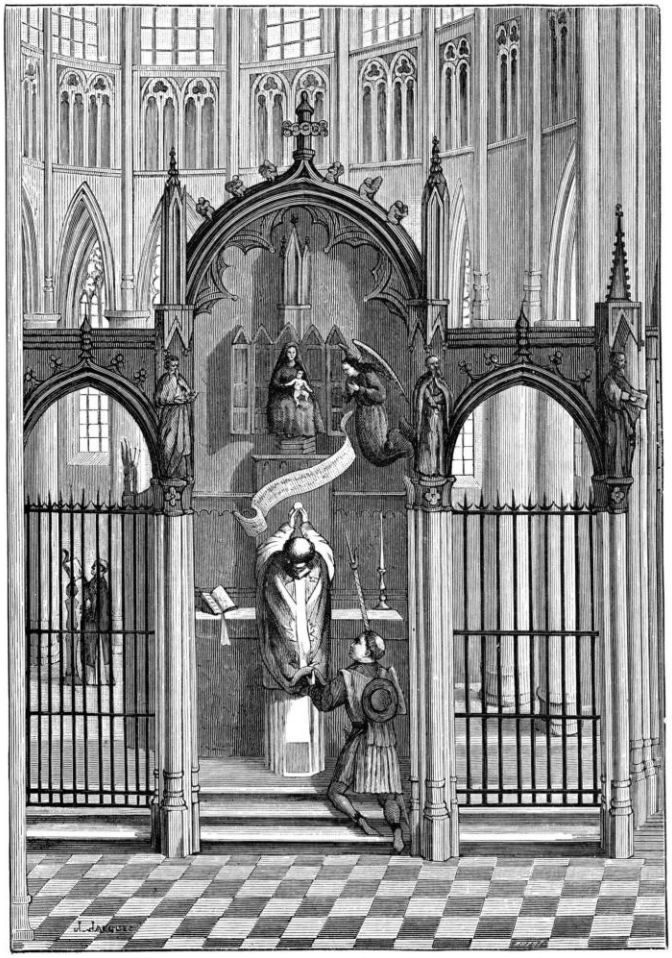

Fig. III. — The Elevation of the Host, as seen from the nave through the sanctuary gate. The Priest lifteth the consecrated Host above the altar whilst the Server kneeleth beside him. The faithful in the nave behold the Sacrifice through the ironwork of the chancel screen. None crosseth the gate save the clergy and their ministers.

Before the Words of Institution, the Priest pauseth and saith the following Admonition, grounded upon the Gospel of Saint John:

Priest: "As many as received Him, to them gave He power to become the sons of God, even to them that believe on His Name" (John i. 12). May those, therefore, who count among God's elect continue to receive and believe that which is here set before them: the very Body and Blood of Christ, omnino nihil aliud, absolutely nothing other than His Flesh and His Blood. But let those who receive unworthily be admonished: they shall defile the Sacrament, the outward sign, yet the inward Reality shall not know them; for, as Saint Paul teacheth, he that eateth and drinketh unworthily eateth and drinketh damnation to himself, not discerning the Lord's Body.

People: Lord, I believe; help Thou mine unbelief.

The Priest taketh the bread into his hands, and looking upward, saith:

Priest: WHO in the same night that He was betrayed took bread; and when He had given thanks, He brake it and gave it to His disciples, saying:

TAKE, EAT: THIS IS MY BODY, WHICH IS GIVEN FOR YOU.
DO THIS IN REMEMBRANCE OF ME.

Likewise after supper He taketh the Cup, and when He had given thanks, He gave it to them, saying:

DRINK YE ALL OF THIS: FOR THIS IS MY BLOOD
OF THE NEW TESTAMENT, WHICH IS SHED FOR YOU
AND FOR MANY FOR THE REMISSION OF SINS.
DO THIS, AS OFT AS YE SHALL DRINK IT,
IN REMEMBRANCE OF ME.

The Anamnesis

Priest: WHEREFORE, O Lord, we Thy servants and Thy holy people, having in remembrance the blessed Passion and precious Death of Thy dear Son, His mighty Resurrection and glorious Ascension, do offer unto Thy divine Majesty, of Thine own gifts and bounty, this pure ✠ Offering, this holy ✠ Offering, this spotless ✠ Offering: the holy Bread of eternal Life, and the Cup of everlasting Salvation.

The Diptychs of the Dead

Priest: REMEMBER also, O Lord, Thy servants and handmaids N. and N., who are gone before us with the sign of faith and do rest in the sleep of peace. To them, O Lord, and to all that rest in Christ, grant, we beseech Thee, a place of refreshment, light, and peace. Through the same Christ our Lord. Amen.

The Doxology

Priest: BY Whom, and with Whom, in the unity of the Holy Ghost, all honour and glory be unto Thee, O Father almighty, world without end.

People: AMEN.

VIII. THE COMMUNION

Communio

The Lord's Prayer

The Priest saith:

Priest: As our Saviour Christ hath commanded and taught us, we are bold to say:

OUR Father, Who art in heaven, hallowed be Thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive them that trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil.

Priest: Deliver us, O Lord, from every evil, past, present, and to come; and at the intercession of the blessed and glorious ever-Virgin Mary, Mother of God, and of Thy blessed Apostles Peter and Paul, and of all the Saints, graciously grant peace in our days; that by the help of Thy mercy we may be always free from sin and safe from all distress. Through the same Jesus Christ Thy Son our Lord, Who liveth and reigneth with Thee, in the unity of the Holy Ghost, God, world without end.

People: Amen.

The Fraction

The Priest breaketh the Host, saying:

Priest: The table is set. The Lamb of God is slain, shared but not divided, eaten but never consumed. Let us drink of the inexhaustible Cup.

He placeth a particle of the Host into the Chalice, saying:

Priest: May the union of the Body and Blood of Christ be unto us a pledge of our transformation and of the resurrection of the faithful departed.

The Agnus Dei

O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world: have mercy upon us.

O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world: have mercy upon us.

O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world: grant us Thy peace.

The Invitation

The Priest, elevating the Host and Chalice, saith:

Priest: Holy Things for the Holy!

People: One is Holy; One is Lord: Jesus Christ, to the glory of God the Father. Amen.

The Prayer of Humble Access is said by Priest and People together:

WE do not presume to come to this Thy Table, O merciful Lord, trusting in our own righteousness, but in Thy manifold and great mercies. We are not worthy so much as to gather up the crumbs under Thy Table. But Thou art the same Lord, Whose property is always to have mercy: grant us therefore, gracious Lord, so to eat the Flesh of Thy dear Son Jesus Christ, and to drink His Blood, that our sinful bodies may be made clean by His Body, and our souls washed through His most precious Blood, and that we may evermore dwell in Him, and He in us. Amen.

The Manner of Receiving Holy Communion

Concerning the manner of receiving the Sacrament, the faithful must observe the following with care and reverence, as shown in the Figures above (see especially Fig. I, showing the sanctuary with the altar rail and gate):

1. THE ALTAR RAIL AND GATE. The sanctuary is separated from the nave by a low rail or screen, with a gate at its centre (see Fig. I). The gate is for the use of the clergy and their ministers only. No lay person shall pass through the gate or cross the altar rail into the sanctuary at any time, neither during Mass nor at any other occasion, save by express permission of the Priest for some necessary service.

2. APPROACHING THE RAIL. When the time of Communion cometh, the faithful shall rise from their places in the nave and approach the altar rail in good order. They shall kneel at the rail on the nave side, that is, behind the gate, not within the sanctuary. They shall kneel upright, with hands folded upon the rail or clasped before their breast.

3. RECEIVING ON THE TONGUE. The faithful shall receive the Body of Christ upon the tongue, not in the hand. The Priest (or Deacon) shall come to each communicant at the rail, placing the Host directly upon the tongue of the kneeling communicant. The communicant shall open the mouth and extend the tongue slightly, and shall not attempt to take the Host with the fingers. After receiving the Body, the communicant may receive the Blood from the Chalice held by the Priest or his minister, or by intinction.

4. AFTER RECEIVING. Having received the Sacrament, the communicant shall remain kneeling briefly in thanksgiving, then rise and return to the pew, making way for the next to approach the rail.

5. THOSE WHO DO NOT COMMUNICATE. Those who are not disposed to receive, or who are conscious of grave sin and have not yet made their confession, may nonetheless come to the rail, crossing their arms upon their breast as a sign, and shall receive a blessing from the Priest in lieu of the Sacrament. No one shall be turned away without at least a blessing.

The Priest receiveth the Sacrament first, and then cometh to the altar rail, bearing the Paten and Chalice. The Server attendeth with the Communion cloth held beneath the chin of each communicant. The Priest saith to each:

Priest: The Body of our Lord Jesus Christ, which was given for thee, preserve thy body and soul unto everlasting life. Take and eat this in remembrance that Christ died for thee, and feed on Him in thy heart by faith with thanksgiving.

And when he giveth the Cup:

Priest: The Blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, which was shed for thee, preserve thy body and soul unto everlasting life. Drink this in remembrance that Christ's Blood was shed for thee, and be thankful.

IX. THE THANKSGIVING AND DISMISSAL

Gratiarum Actio et Missio

The Post-Communion

Priest: O Lord and heavenly Father, we Thy humble servants entirely desire Thy fatherly goodness mercifully to accept this our sacrifice of praise and thanksgiving; most humbly beseeching Thee to grant that by the merits and death of Thy Son Jesus Christ, and through faith in His Blood, we and all Thy whole Church may obtain remission of our sins and all other benefits of His Passion. And here we offer and present unto Thee, O Lord, ourselves, our souls and bodies, to be a reasonable, holy, and lively sacrifice unto Thee. And although we be unworthy, through our manifold sins, to offer unto Thee any sacrifice, yet we beseech Thee to accept this our bounden duty and service; not weighing our merits, but pardoning our offences. Through Jesus Christ our Lord, by Whom and with Whom, in the unity of the Holy Ghost, all honour and glory be unto Thee, O Father almighty, world without end.

People: Amen.

The Individual Blessing

Before the general Blessing and Dismissal, it is the custom of the Insular Church that the Priest shall come again to the altar rail, and the faithful shall approach one by one or in small groups, kneeling as at Communion. The Priest shall lay his hand upon the head of each person and bless them individually, saying:

Priest: The Lord bless thee and keep thee. The Lord make His face to shine upon thee and be gracious unto thee. The Lord lift up His countenance upon thee, and give thee peace. In the Name of the Father, and of the Son, ✠ and of the Holy Ghost.

The person respondeth:

People: Amen.

Or, on greater feasts, the Priest may use this form:

Priest: Go forth in the peace of Christ. May the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, bless ✠ thee, strengthen thee, and confirm thee in every good work, unto life everlasting.

People: Amen.

When all have received the individual blessing, the Priest returneth to the altar for the general Blessing.

The General Blessing

Priest: The peace of God, which passeth all understanding, keep your hearts and minds in the knowledge and love of God, and of His Son Jesus Christ our Lord. And the blessing of God almighty, the Father, ✠ the Son, and the Holy Ghost, be amongst you and remain with you always.

People: Amen.

The Dismissal

Priest: The solemnities are ended. Let us depart in peace!

People: Thanks be to God.

Or, on ferial days:

Priest: Go, the Mass is ended.

People: Thanks be to God.

Ite, Missa est. — Deo gratias.

X. THE LAST GOSPEL

Ultimum Evangelium secundum Joannem

After the Dismissal, the Priest goeth to the Gospel side of the altar. He maketh the sign of the Cross upon the altar, upon his forehead, lips, and breast, and saith:

Priest: The Lord be with you.

People: And with thy spirit.

Priest: The beginning of the ✠ Holy Gospel according to Saint John.

People: Glory be to Thee, O Lord.

Priest: IN the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. The same was in the beginning with God. All things were made by Him; and without Him was not any thing made that was made. In Him was life; and the life was the light of men. And the light shineth in darkness; and the darkness comprehended it not.

There was a man sent from God, whose name was John. The same came for a witness, to bear witness of the Light, that all men through him might believe. He was not that Light, but was sent to bear witness of that Light. That was the true Light, which lighteth every man that cometh into the world.

He was in the world, and the world was made by Him, and the world knew Him not. He came unto His own, and His own received Him not. But as many as received Him, to them gave He power to become the sons of God, even to them that believe on His Name: which were born, not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God.

Here all kneel:

ET VERBUM CARO FACTUM EST, **AND THE WORD WAS MADE FLESH,** and dwelt among us, (and we beheld His glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.

People: Deo gratias. Thanks be to God.

The Priest and People then depart in silence, or a recessional hymn may be sung.

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Laus Deo et Beatae Mariae Virgini et omnibus Sanctis
Finis Partis Prima

THE RITE OF

ST NINIAN THE PRESBYTER

A Missionary Liturgy of the Insular Church

♀ ♀ ♀

♀

For the Celebration of the Lord's Supper

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Drawn from the Book of Common Prayer (1662)
The Ordo of Blessed Cainnech the Presbyter of Iona (c. 762) • Alcuin of York (c. 790)
and the Scottish Customary of the Isles

Sacramental Theology: The Concordat of Candida Casa (c. 849)

The Insular Church ♀ Mvindicraft

Pre-Tridentine Insular Rite ♀ Saints Recognised Before A.D. 1550

For Communities Where No Rector is Resident—Usable by a Single Ordained Minister

Preface: The Patron and Purpose of This Rite

St Ninian of Whithorn (c. 360–432 A.D.) stands as the first recorded Christian missionary to the peoples of Scotland—the Picts of the south and the peoples of Galloway—a generation before Columba of Iona, and nearly two centuries before Augustine's mission to England. The ancient record, preserved by Bede and by Aelred of Rievaulx, speaks of a British bishop trained in Rome, who returned to build a stone church—the Candida Casa, the White House—at Whithorn in Galloway, and from thence carried the gospel to peoples beyond the Roman frontier. He is, in the most proper sense, an Apostle of the North.

This rite bears his name because it is a missionary liturgy—a service designed for use in new or small communities, in places where a church is being planted, or where a single minister must serve without the full complement of deacons and servers. Like Ninian, who preached in the open, in rough stone oratories, and in newly-built halls, this rite is designed to be portable, dignified, and complete in itself.

It is structured to last between twenty and thirty minutes, and is complete for a celebration of the Lord's Supper. The lectionary is provided separately; this rite merely indicates where readings are to be inserted.

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Theological Position: The Concordat of Candida Casa

The Insular Church affirms, with the Concordat of Candida Casa (c. 849), that with the bread and wine the true body and blood of our Lord Jesus Christ are truly and substantially present, and are distributed to those who eat at the Lord's Supper. This presence is real and not merely spiritual or symbolic. The church does not seek to bind the conscience with the philosophical categories of scholasticism—no precise explanation of the mode of this presence is required as a condition of communion. Those who hold, with the mediaeval doctors, that a change of substance accompanies this presence are not reproved; those who hold that the presence is sacramental and substantial without requiring a philosophical account of its mode do not err.

The formula of the Concordat, attributed to St Aldhelm the Theologian of Ripon (c. 801–869) in his treatise De Mysterio Altaris, is: "That with the bread and with the wine the Body and Blood of Christ are truly and substantially present, given, and received; and that even those who approach unworthily receive the Body and Blood of Christ, though to their own judgment, for they approach without repentance and without faith." This formula is the ancient and undivided position of the Western church before scholastic controversy sought to define the indefinable. John Duns Scotus (1266–1308) and William of Ockham (1287–1347) both argued, from within the Catholic tradition, that divine power is not constrained by Aristotelian categories, and that the mode of Christ's presence in the Supper exceeds natural philosophy.

The minister is to use the Words of Institution as appointed without addition or diminution, and is to handle the elements with due reverence, believing that Christ is present and that the communicant receives him truly.

Part I: The Sacred Space

This section provides guidance for building and furnishing a church appropriate to the Insular Church's tradition and to the Mvindicraft world. All architecture described is drawn from historical Northern European and particularly Scottish ecclesiastical buildings erected between A.D. 500 and A.D. 1550. Use the fillable spaces below to document the design of your community's church.

Historical Archetypes (Scotland, A.D. 500–1550)

The following building types are historically appropriate and give specific inspiration for Minecraft construction:

Early Insular (A.D. 500–900): Simple rectangular dry-stone or mortared stone oratories; no tower; timber roof, sometimes thatched. Rough-dressed stone altar at the east end. The type of St Ninian's Candida Casa, the early oratories of Iona, and Irish cells on Aran. Internal dimensions rarely exceed 6×14 metres.

Romanesque (A.D. 1100–1200): Round-headed arches; thick rubble walls; small round-headed windows; corbel tables at the eave line; square or round tower attached to west end. Examples: St Magnus Cathedral (Orkney), Dunfermline Abbey nave, Restenneth Priory. Interior: stone floor; stone arcade; flat wooden ceiling or open rafters.

Early Gothic (A.D. 1200–1350): Pointed arches; lancet windows (tall, narrow, single light); ribbed vaulting in chancels; buttresses on outer walls; crossing tower. Examples: Dryburgh Abbey, Jedburgh Abbey, Dundrennan Abbey. Stone altar; choir stalls; stone chancel arch dividing nave from sanctuary.

Scottish Late Gothic (A.D. 1350–1550): Elaborate window tracery (curvilinear and rectilinear); gargoyles and grotesques; collegiate church plan (short nave, dominant choir, western tower or towers). Examples: Rosslyn Chapel, St Giles' Cathedral Edinburgh, St John's Kirk Perth. May include rood screen; sedilia; piscina in south chancel wall.

Exterior — Fillable Design Record

Building Period / Style	Overall Dimensions (blocks)
e.g. Early Gothic, c.1250	*e.g. 8w × 50 × 15h*

Primary Wall Material	Roof Material & Style
e.g. Cobblestone / Stone Bricks	*e.g. Stone slabs, pitched; or wooden planks*

Tower: Present? Type?	Tower Height (blocks)
e.g. Round-Irish, square-Norman, none	

Window Style and Placement
three lancets on south wall, one rose window in west gable'

East End (Chancel Exterior)
'squared apse with three lancets; stone cross finial at apex'

Notable Exterior Features

Gargoyles, corbel tables, porch, buttresses, external cross, graveyard enclosure, lychgate, etc.

Minecraft Screenshot / Reference Label

Example of a Church Exterior that Works:

Interior — Fillable Design Record

The church is oriented east–west. The people stand in the nave; the altar stands against the east wall (the Lord's end). The minister faces east at the altar during the Eucharistic Prayer, and turns west to address the congregation.

Floor Material	Ceiling / Vault
e.g. Stone slabs, packed earth (dirt), clay tiles	*e.g. Open wooden rafters; stone barrel vault; flat plank ceiling*

Nave Seating / Benches	Aisle / Arcade
e.g. Wooden plank benches; stone ledges along walls; open standing	*e.g. Three-bay arcade of stone pillars; no aisles*

The Altar (East End)
Describe the altar: material, dimensions, colour, cloth covering. Historical note: the altar should be of stone if possible, fixed against the east wall, and covered with a white or coloured frontal. A wooden cross or crucifix stands or hangs above it.

The Font (Baptismal)
Describe the font's placement and appearance. Historical note: in Scottish churches, the font stands near the main (west or south) entrance, symbolising entry into the Body of Christ.

Chancel Furniture (if any)
Piscina (drainage niche in south wall), sedilia (seating for ministers in south wall), lectern, choir stalls, rood screen (divide between nave and chancel). Note which are present.

Lighting (Candles / Torches)
Number and placement of candles on and around the altar. Historical: two candles flank the cross on the altar; further candles may stand on floor-level candlesticks (prickets).

Stained Glass / Wall Decoration
Describe painted walls, icon panels, scripture inscriptions, or stained glass (if the building period permits). Early Insular: painted whitewash; Gothic: rich glass.

Notable Interior Features / Coordinates
(Note any special features and their Minecraft coordinates for community reference)

Real Life Examples of Interiors:

Part II: Vestments Guide for Minecraft Skins

The Insular Church worships in the High-Church Reformed Anglican manner. All vestments described below are drawn from mediaeval Western ecclesiastical practice, appropriate to the period A.D. 500–1550 and consistent with the Northern European / Scottish tradition. For Minecraft, these are expressed through player skin design. Use the fillable columns to record the specific skin files or texture notes your community uses.

Real life Example of Vestments:

Part III: Ministers and Their Roles

This section describes the duties of each person during the Rite of St Ninian. In a full celebration, a Bishop, Priest, Deacon, Lector, Acolyte, and Congregation are present. In a missionary context, the rite may be celebrated by a Priest alone, with the congregation fulfilling all lay roles.

The Bishop (Episcopus)

The Bishop presides when present. In a missionary service, a Bishop will typically be present for the first celebration of the rite in a new community (the Apostolic Visitation), for ordinations, and for festivals. When the Bishop is present:

- The Bishop sits in the chair (cathedra or bishop's seat) at the east end during the Liturgy of the Word, facing west toward the people.
- The Bishop leads the Gloria, preaches the Sermon, and pronounces the Absolution and final Blessing.
- The Bishop presides at the Eucharistic Prayer and the Words of Institution. The Priest assists at the altar.
- Where a rubric says "P." (Priest) and a Bishop is present, the Bishop takes that part unless otherwise directed.

The Priest (Presbyter)

The Priest is the ordinary celebrant of this rite. All rubrics marked "P." belong to the Priest. The Priest:

- Leads all versicles and responses not assigned to others.
- Faces the altar (east) during the Confession, the Eucharistic Prayer, and the Words of Institution, turning to face the people for the Absolution, Sermon, and Blessing.
- Handles the bread and cup throughout. The Priest elevates the bread and cup during the Words of Institution—a moderate elevation, not a solemn exposition.
- When celebrating alone (no Deacon or Lector), the Priest reads all lessons, leads all responses on behalf of the people where they cannot respond, and distributes communion personally.

The Deacon (Diaconus)

When a Deacon is present, the Deacon:

- Reads the Gospel and announces it (the people stand for the Gospel).
- Prepares the altar: places the corporal (linen cloth), the chalice, paten, bread, and wine before the Offertory.
- Assists the Priest in distributing the Cup to communicants.
- Reads the Dismissal ("Go in peace…") at the close of the service.

The Lector (Lay Reader)

The Lector reads the Old Testament Lesson and the Epistle. The Lector stands at the lectern (ambo), faces the congregation, and reads clearly and deliberately. In the absence of a Lector, the Priest reads all lessons.

The Acolyte / Server

The Acolyte assists throughout the service: carrying the processional cross, holding the book for the Priest, ringing the bell at the Words of Institution (if a bell is provided), and carrying candles in the entrance procession. The Acolyte does not speak liturgical texts but serves in silence and with reverence.

The Congregation (Laity)

All baptised members of the congregation participate actively. The responses marked "People." or "All." are spoken or sung by all. The congregation:

Kneels for the Confession and the Prayer of Humble Access.

Stands for the Gloria, the Gospel, the Creed, the Sursum Corda, and the Blessing.

Sits for the Lessons and the Sermon.

Comes forward to the altar rail (or approaches the altar) to receive communion, kneeling where possible.

Unbaptised visitors are warmly welcomed to observe but are not admitted to communion. The Priest may offer a blessing in place of communion (hand laid on the head with a brief prayer).

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THE RITE OF ST NINIAN THE PRESBYTER

An Order for the Administration of the Lord's Supper

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Abbreviations Used in This Rite

P. = Priest (or Bishop, when present) **B.** = Bishop (alone) **D.** = Deacon **L.** = Lector **All.** = All present

¶ = *Rubric (instruction, in red italics). Rubrics are not spoken aloud.*

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I. THE GATHERING

¶ *The church bell is rung three times as the people assemble. The congregation stands. The ministers enter in procession: Acolyte with cross, then Lector, then Deacon, then Priest (or Bishop last of all). They proceed to the chancel in silence or to the chanting of a psalm or hymn.*

¶ *The Priest takes his place before the altar, facing east. If a Bishop is present, the Bishop proceeds to the bishop's seat. All make reverence to the altar.*

The Opening Versicles

¶ *The Priest turns to face the people and begins:*

P.. O Lord, open thou our lips.

People. And our mouth shall shew forth thy praise.

P.. O God, make speed to save us.

People. O Lord, make haste to help us.

¶ *All stand.*

P.. Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost.

People. As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be: world without end. Amen.

P.. Praise ye the Lord.

People. The Lord's Name be praised.

The Kyrie

¶ *The Priest sings or says the Kyrie, and the people respond to each:*

P.. Lord, have mercy upon us.

People. Lord, have mercy upon us.

P.. Christ, have mercy upon us.

People. Christ, have mercy upon us.

P.. Lord, have mercy upon us.

People. Lord, have mercy upon us.

Gloria in Excelsis

¶ *On Sundays and feasts of the first and second tiers, the Gloria in Excelsis is sung or said by all, standing. It may be omitted during Advent and Lent, and replaced with a simple versicle. In a small mission community, the Priest leads and the people join in as they are able.*

All. Glory be to God on high, and in earth peace, goodwill towards men. We praise thee, we bless thee, we worship thee, we glorify thee, we give thanks to thee for thy great glory, O Lord God, heavenly King,

God the Father Almighty. O Lord, the only-begotten Son Jesu Christ; O Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father, that takest away the sins of the world, have mercy upon us. Thou that takest away the sins of the world, receive our prayer. Thou that sittest at the right hand of God the Father, have mercy upon us. For thou only art holy; thou only art the Lord; thou only, O Christ, with the Holy Ghost, art most high in the glory of God the Father. Amen.

The Collect of the Day

P.. The Lord be with you.

People. And with thy spirit.

P.. Let us pray.

¶ *The Priest turns to the altar and says the Collect appointed for the day from the Insular Lectionary. The people respond:*

People. Amen.

¶ *The Priest turns to face the people again.*

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II. THE PREPARATION

Exhortation to Confession

¶ *All are seated. The Priest addresses the congregation in these or similar words:*

P.. Dearly beloved brethren, the Scripture moveth us in sundry places to acknowledge and confess our manifold sins and wickedness; and that we should not dissemble nor cloke them before the face of Almighty God our heavenly Father; but confess them with an humble, lowly, penitent, and obedient heart; to the end that we may obtain forgiveness of the same, by his infinite goodness and mercy. And although we ought at all times humbly to acknowledge our sins before God; yet ought we chiefly so to do, when we assemble and meet together to render thanks for the great benefits that we have received at his hands, to set forth his most worthy praise, to hear his most holy Word, and to ask those things that are requisite and necessary, as well for the body as the soul. Wherefore I pray and beseech you, as many as are here present, to accompany me with a pure heart, and humble voice, unto the throne of the heavenly grace.

General Confession

¶ *All kneel. The Priest kneels likewise. The Confession is said by the Priest and the people together:*

All. Almighty God, Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, Maker of all things, Judge of all men; We acknowledge and bewail our manifold sins and wickedness, Which we, from time to time, most grievously have committed, By thought, word, and deed, Against thy Divine Majesty, Provoking most justly thy wrath and indignation against us. We do earnestly repent, and are heartily sorry for these our misdoings; The remembrance of them is grievous unto us; The burden of them is intolerable. Have mercy upon us, Have mercy upon us, most merciful Father; For thy Son our Lord Jesus Christ's sake, forgive us all that is past; And grant that we may ever hereafter serve and please thee in newness of life, To the honour and glory of thy Name; Through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Absolution

¶ *The Priest alone stands, and faces the congregation. The people remain kneeling.*

P.. Almighty God, our heavenly Father, who of his great mercy hath promised forgiveness of sins to all them that with hearty repentance and true faith turn unto him; Have mercy upon you; pardon and deliver you from all your sins; confirm and strengthen you in all goodness; and bring you to everlasting life; through Jesus Christ our Lord.

People. Amen.

¶ *All stand.*

P.. Lord, have mercy upon us, and incline our hearts to keep all thy commandments.

People. Amen.

III. THE LITURGY OF THE WORD

¶ *All are seated. The Lector (or Priest) goes to the lectern.*

The Old Testament Lesson

¶ *The Lector announces the lesson:*

L.. *Here beginneth [chapter and verse] of the Book of [Name].*

¶ *The lesson is read from the Insular Lectionary (Session A, Old Testament). When it is ended:*

L.. *Here endeth the Lesson.*

¶ *The congregation may respond with:*

People. Thanks be to God.

The Epistle

L.. *The Epistle of [St Paul to the / of the Apostle] [Name], chapter [N], beginning at the [N]th verse.*

¶ *The Epistle is read from the Insular Lectionary (Session A, Epistle). When ended:*

L.. *Here endeth the Epistle.*

People. Thanks be to God.

¶ *A brief psalm, canticle, or period of silence may follow between the Epistle and the Gospel.*

The Gospel

¶ *All stand. The Deacon (or Priest, if no Deacon) goes to the lectern or the midst of the people, and announces:*

D./P.. The Holy Gospel is written in the [N]th chapter of the Gospel according to Saint [Name], beginning at the [N]th verse.

P.. Glory be to thee, O Lord.

¶ *The Gospel is read from the Insular Lectionary (Session A or B, Gospel). When ended:*

D./P.. *Here endeth the Holy Gospel.*

P.. Praise be to thee, O Christ.

¶ *All sit.*

The Sermon

¶ *The Priest (or Bishop) preaches. In this missionary rite, the sermon should be brief—5 to 8 minutes—direct, grounded in the day's Scripture, and accessible to new or young communities. The Ordo of Blessed Cainnech the Presbyter enjoins preaching as the foremost work of the minister among the peoples; the sermon is not to be omitted. After the sermon, a period of silence may be kept.*

The Nicene Creed

¶ *All stand. On Sundays and principal feasts, the Nicene Creed is said by all. On ordinary days in a mission context, the Apostles' Creed may be used.*

All. I believe in one God the Father Almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, And of all things visible and invisible: And in one Lord Jesus Christ, the only-begotten Son of God, Begotten of his Father before all worlds, God of God, Light of Light, Very God of very God, Begotten, not made, Being of one substance with the Father, By whom all things were made: Who for us men, and for our salvation came down from heaven, And was incarnate by the Holy Ghost of the Virgin Mary, And was made man, And was crucified also for us under Pontius Pilate. He suffered and was buried, And the third day he rose again according to the Scriptures, And ascended into heaven, And sitteth on the right hand of the Father. And he shall come again with glory to judge both the quick and the dead: Whose kingdom shall have no end. And I believe in the Holy Ghost, The Lord and giver of life, Who proceedeth from the Father and the Son, Who with the Father and the Son together is worshipped and glorified, Who spake by the Prophets. And I believe one Catholick and Apostolick Church. I acknowledge one Baptism for the remission of sins. And I look for the Resurrection of the dead, And the life of the world to come. Amen.

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IV. THE PRAYERS AND OFFERTORY

The Offertory

¶ *The Priest goes to the altar and says one or more of these sentences, while the Deacon or server prepares the altar: laying the corporal, placing the chalice, the paten, the bread, and a cruet of wine. The offerings of the people may be received at this time.*

P.. *"Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven." Matthew 5:16*

¶ *Or:*

P.. *"Godliness is great riches, if a man be content with that he hath: for we brought nothing into the world, neither may we carry anything out." 1 Timothy 6:6*

¶ *Or:*

P.. *"To do good, and to distribute, forget not; for with such sacrifices God is pleased." Hebrews 13:16*

¶ *While the offerings are brought to the altar, the congregation may sing a psalm or hymn. The Deacon (or server) brings the alms to the Priest, who places them on the altar.*

Prayer for the Whole Church

¶ *All kneel or stand as is the local custom. The Priest leads the Prayer for the Church, either in these words or in a free prayer of similar scope, interceding for: the universal Church, ministers and bishops, civil rulers, the poor, the suffering, the dying, and those present. An extended form is provided here; a shorter form may be used in mission contexts.*

P.. Let us pray for the whole estate of Christ's Church militant here in earth.

P.. Almighty and everliving God, who by thy holy Apostle hast taught us to make prayers, and supplications, and to give thanks, for all men: We humbly beseech thee most mercifully to receive these our prayers, which we offer unto thy Divine Majesty; beseeching thee to inspire continually the universal Church with the spirit of truth, unity and concord: And grant that all they that do confess thy holy Name, may agree in the truth of thy holy Word, and live in unity and godly love.

¶ *For civil rulers:*

P.. *We beseech thee also to bless and keep all those that bear rule in this realm and all realms; that under them we may be godly and quietly governed. Give wisdom to those in authority, that they may truly and uprightly minister justice, to the punishment of wickedness and vice, and to the maintenance of thy true Religion and Virtue.*

¶ *For ministers:*

P.. *Give grace, O heavenly Father, to all Bishops and Priests and Deacons; that they may both by their life and doctrine set forth thy true and lively Word, and rightly and duly administer thy holy Sacraments.*

¶ *For the people:*

P.. *And to all thy people give thy heavenly grace; and especially to this Congregation here present; that, with meek heart and due reverence, they may hear, and receive thy holy Word; truly serving thee in holiness and righteousness all the days of their life.*

¶ *For those in need:*

P.. *And we most humbly beseech thee of thy goodness, O Lord, to comfort and succour all them who in this transitory life are in trouble, sorrow, need, sickness, or any other adversity.*

P.. And we also bless thy holy Name for all thy servants departed this life in thy faith and fear; beseeching thee to give us grace so to follow their good examples, that with them we may be partakers of thy heavenly kingdom. Grant this, O Father, for Jesus Christ's sake, our only Mediator and Advocate. Amen.

People. Amen.

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V. THE LITURGY OF THE TABLE

¶ *All stand.*

The Sursum Corda

P.. Lift up your hearts.

People. We lift them up unto the Lord.

P.. Let us give thanks unto our Lord God.

People. It is meet and right so to do.

The Preface

¶ *The Priest turns to the altar.*

P.. It is very meet, right and our bounden duty, that we should at all times, and in all places, give thanks unto thee, O Lord, Holy Father, Almighty, Everlasting God:

¶ *Here follows the Proper Preface for the season, if any be appointed (see the Insular Lectionary). If none be appointed, the Priest proceeds immediately:*

PROPER PREFACE FOR CHRISTMAS: Because thou didst give Jesus Christ, thine only Son, to be born as at this time for us; who, by the operation of the Holy Ghost, was made very man of the substance of the Virgin Mary his mother; and that without spot of sin, to make us clean from all sin.

PROPER PREFACE FOR EASTER: But chiefly are we bound to praise thee for the glorious Resurrection of thy Son Jesus Christ our Lord: for he is the very Paschal Lamb, which was offered for us, and hath taken away the sin of the world; who by his death hath destroyed death, and by his rising to life again hath restored to us everlasting life.

PROPER PREFACE FOR PENTECOST: Through Jesus Christ our Lord; according to whose most true promise, the Holy Ghost came down as at this time from heaven with a sudden great sound, as it had been a mighty wind, in the likeness of fiery tongues, lighting upon the Apostles, to teach them, and to lead them to all truth.

PROPER PREFACE FOR TRINITY: Who art one God, one Lord; not only one Person, but three Persons in one substance. For that which we believe of the glory of the Father, the same we believe of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost, without any difference or inequality.

¶ *After the Preface (proper or common), all say together:*

The Sanctus

All. Holy, Holy, Holy, Lord God of hosts, heaven and earth are full of thy glory: Glory be to thee, O Lord Most High.

¶ *All kneel.*

The Prayer of Humble Access

¶ *Said by all, kneeling. This prayer is drawn from the Book of Common Prayer and is peculiar to the English and Insular tradition, drawing on the words of the Syro-Phoenician woman in the Gospel. It expresses the communicant's unworthiness and throws all confidence onto God's mercy. It is not to be omitted.*

All. We do not presume to come to this thy Table, O merciful Lord, trusting in our own righteousness, but in thy manifold and great mercies. We are not worthy so much as to gather up the crumbs under thy Table. But thou art the same Lord, whose property is always to have mercy: Grant us therefore, gracious Lord, so to eat the flesh of thy dear Son Jesus Christ, and to drink his blood, that our sinful bodies may be made clean by his body, and our souls washed through his most precious blood, and that we may evermore dwell in him, and he in us. Amen.

The Words of Institution

¶ *The Priest rises and stands before the altar, facing east. He takes the bread in his hands at the appropriate words, then the cup. A moderate elevation of each element is made at the words "this is my Body" and "this is my Blood." The Acolyte, if present, rings the bell once at each elevation. The people remain kneeling and in silence.*

¶ *THEOLOGICAL NOTE: The words that follow are the warrant and the vehicle of the sacrament. The Insular Church holds, with the Concordat of Candida Casa (c. 849), that with and under the bread and wine the true body and blood of Christ are truly and substantially present, distributed, and received. The minister does not speculate beyond this; the mystery is real but its mode is not defined beyond what the Scripture itself says. Neither a purely spiritual nor a purely philosophical interpretation is imposed.*

P.. In the same night that he was betrayed, our Lord Jesus Christ took bread; and when he had given thanks, he brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying,

P.. Take, eat; this is my Body, which is given for you: Do this in remembrance of me.

¶ *The Priest elevates the bread briefly. The Acolyte rings the bell. The Priest then takes the cup.*

P.. Likewise after supper he took the Cup; and, when he had given thanks, he gave it to them, saying,

P.. Drink ye all of this; for this is my Blood of the New Testament, which is shed for you, and for many, for the remission of sins: Do this, as often as ye drink it, in remembrance of me.

¶ *The Priest elevates the cup briefly. The Acolyte rings the bell.*

P.. Wherefore, O Lord and heavenly Father, we thy humble servants entirely desire thy fatherly goodness mercifully to accept this our sacrifice of praise and thanksgiving; most humbly beseeching thee to grant, that by the merits and death of thy Son Jesus Christ, and through faith in his blood, we and all thy whole Church may obtain remission of our sins, and all other benefits of his passion. And here we offer and present unto thee, O Lord, ourselves, our souls and bodies, to be a reasonable, holy, and lively sacrifice unto thee; humbly beseeching thee, that all we, who are partakers of this holy Communion, may be fulfilled with thy grace and heavenly benediction, through Jesus Christ our Lord; by whom, and with whom, in the unity of the Holy Ghost, all honour and glory be unto thee, O Father Almighty, world without end. Amen.

People. Amen.

P.. As our Saviour Christ hath commanded and taught us, we are bold to say:

All. Our Father, which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy Name; Thy kingdom come; Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven: Give us this day our daily bread; And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive them that trespass against us; And lead us not into temptation, But deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, For ever and ever. Amen.

The Distribution

¶ *The Priest first receives communion in both kinds, and then the Deacon (if present), and then proceeds to the people. The people come forward and kneel to receive, or receive standing if no rail is available. The Priest (and Deacon) distribute, using the appointed words.*

¶ *The manner of distribution follows that of the Book of Common Prayer:*

P.. The Body of our Lord Jesus Christ, which was given for thee, preserve thy body and soul unto everlasting life: Take and eat this in remembrance that Christ died for thee, and feed on him in thy heart by faith with thanksgiving.

¶ *Then for the cup:*

P.. The Blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, which was shed for thee, preserve thy body and soul unto everlasting life: Drink this in remembrance that Christ's Blood was shed for thee, and be thankful.

¶ *While the distribution takes place, psalms or hymns may be sung or read quietly. If there be many communicants and the rite is running long, the distribution words may be shortened to:*

P. [giving bread]: The Body of Christ. People.: Amen.

P. [giving cup]: The Blood of Christ. People.: Amen.

¶ *When all have received, the Priest returns to the altar, reverently consumes any remaining consecrated elements, purifies the vessels, and covers the chalice. The people sit.*

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VI. THE DISMISSAL

Post-Communion Thanksgiving

¶ *The Priest turns to face the people.*

P.. Let us pray.

¶ *All kneel.*

All. Almighty and everliving God, we most heartily thank thee, for that thou dost vouchsafe to feed us, who have duly received these holy mysteries, with the spiritual food of the most precious Body and Blood of thy Son our Saviour Jesus Christ; and dost assure us thereby of thy favour and goodness towards us; and that we are very members incorporate in the mystical body of thy Son, which is the blessed company

of all faithful people; and are also heirs through hope of thy everlasting kingdom, by the merits of the most precious death and passion of thy dear Son. And we most humbly beseech thee, O heavenly Father, so to assist us with thy grace, that we may continue in that holy fellowship, and do all such good works as thou hast prepared for us to walk in; through Jesus Christ our Lord, to whom, with thee and the Holy Ghost, be all honour and glory, world without end. Amen.

The Nunc Dimittis

¶ *On occasions of mission, when the Rite is celebrated at the close of a day, the Nunc Dimittis may be sung or said by all:*

All. Lord, now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace, according to thy word. For mine eyes have seen thy salvation, which thou hast prepared before the face of all people; To be a light to lighten the Gentiles, and to be the glory of thy people Israel. Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost. As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be: world without end. Amen.

The Blessing

¶ *All stand. If a Bishop is present, the Bishop gives the blessing with the right hand raised, and the pastoral staff held in the left. The Priest blesses in the same manner, raising the right hand toward the people.*

B./P.. The peace of God, which passeth all understanding, keep your hearts and minds in the knowledge and love of God, and of his Son Jesus Christ our Lord: and the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost, be amongst you, and remain with you always.

People. Amen.

The Dismissal

¶ *The Deacon (or Priest) turns to the people and says:*

D./P.. Go in peace, to love and serve the Lord.

People. Thanks be to God.

¶ *The ministers depart in procession, in the reverse order of entry. The people remain standing until the ministers have departed, and then disperse or remain for fellowship.*

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HERE ENDETH THE RITE OF ST NINIAN THE PRESBYTER

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Appendix A: The Shorter Form of the Rite

Where the full rite cannot be celebrated—for reasons of time, absence of ministers, or the exigencies of mission—the following shorter form may be used. It preserves the essential structure (Word, Confession, Eucharist, Blessing) and is serviceable in approximately 15–20 minutes. Nothing is omitted that is necessary; everything condensed is condensed, not removed.

ORDER OF THE SHORTER FORM:

1. Kyrie (three-fold) — omit the Opening Versicles and Gloria if time requires
2. Collect of the Day
3. One Reading (Gospel preferred, or Epistle) from the Insular Lectionary
4. Brief Exhortation (not a full sermon; 2–3 minutes) or a passage read from a homily
5. General Confession and Absolution
6. The Lord's Prayer
7. Sursum Corda and Sanctus
8. Prayer of Humble Access
9. Words of Institution
10. Distribution
11. A brief Post-Communion prayer (the shorter form: "Almighty God, we thank thee…" may be improvised)
12. Blessing and Dismissal

¶ *When there is no ordained minister present: No celebration of the Lord's Supper may take place without an ordained Priest or Bishop. However, the full Liturgy of the Word (Lessons, Psalm, Sermon, Creed, Prayers) may be led by any baptised and confirmed member of the congregation. In this case, there is no Eucharist; the rite concludes after the Intercessions with the Lord's Prayer and a blessing from Jude 24–25 or a similar scripture.*

Appendix B: Notes on the Sources of This Rite

The Ancient Sarum Tradition and Prayers of the Insular Church

The fixed liturgical texts of this rite—the Kyrie, Gloria, Collect structure, Sursum Corda, Preface, Sanctus, Prayer of Humble Access, Words of Institution, post-communion forms, and the final Blessing—are drawn from the ancient Sarum Rite, the liturgical use of Salisbury which was the dominant form of the pre-Reformation Western church in Britain. These texts were themselves inherited from the Roman and Gallican rites of the early mediaeval period, and represent the unbroken devotional language of the Western church from at least the fifth century. The Insular Church receives them as a treasury of holy language, purged only of those later accretions which are not consonant with Scripture, after the manner of the Insular reformers described below.

The Ordo of Blessed Cainnech the Presbyter of Iona (c. 762)

Blessed Cainnech mac Bresail (c. 720–798), known as 'Cainnech the Presbyter,' was a monk of Iona who served for three decades as a missionary among the Pictish peoples of what is now eastern Scotland. Distressed that the elaborate Frankish form of the Mass, with its long silent canon and complex oblatory prayers, was incomprehensible to the people he served, Cainnech composed a simplified vernacular order—the Ordo Insulae, the Order of the Island—for use in mission communities. His Ordo retained the Preface, the Sanctus, and the Words of Institution intact, but removed the accumulated oblatory formulae that had accreted around the canon. He required that psalms be sung by the congregation during the distribution of communion, and that a sermon in the vernacular precede every celebration of the Supper. The Ordo of Blessed Cainnech was used in the mission churches of the Northern Isles and the Western Highlands until the twelfth century, when the Gregorian reforms imposed a more uniform Latin practice. From this source this rite derives its structural decision to preserve the ancient Eucharistic canon in simplified form, its insistence on congregational singing, and its requirement that preaching accompany every celebration.

The Scottish Customary of the Isles (Customarium Insulanum)

The Scottish Customary of the Isles is a late mediaeval Gaelic liturgical customary, preserved in fragmentary form and associated with the island churches of the Western Hebrides. It was brought to wider attention by Bishop Carswell of the Isles (c. 1520–1572), who drew upon older Highland liturgical practice in his pastoral work. The Customary provides the form of the exhortation before the Lord's Supper, the examination of communicants, the Prayer for the Whole Church, and the manner of distribution in both kinds to the people. The exhortation to communicants ("Dearely beloved in the Lord, forasmoch as we be nowe assembled…") preserved in this rite reflects the Customary's emphasis that worthy reception requires self-examination, penitence, and lively faith—not merely outward conformity.

Alcuin of York and the Carolingian Reforms (c. 790)

Alcuin of York (735–804) was a Northumbrian scholar and theologian who served at the court of Charlemagne and became the foremost liturgical reformer of the Carolingian age. His reforms of the Frankish Mass established several principles which this rite follows: that the congregation should hear and understand the words of the service; that the Lord's Prayer should be said aloud and together; that the service in mission and frontier communities may be simplified without impoverishing its substance; and that the function of the minister is to bring the faithful to Christ, not to perform a rite on their behalf. Alcuin himself composed or revised several of the collects and prefaces which entered

the Sarum tradition and ultimately the texts used in this rite. His principle—"let nothing be done that the people do not understand and cannot follow"—is the animating spirit of this missionary form.

St Aldhelm the Theologian of Ripon and the Concordat of Candida Casa (c. 849)

Aldhelm mac Osric (c. 801–869), called 'the Theologian' to distinguish him from the earlier Aldhelm of Malmesbury, was a scholar-priest attached to the church at Ripon who wrote extensively on the nature of the sacraments. His principal work, De Mysterio Altaris (On the Mystery of the Altar), argued that the presence of Christ's body and blood in the Eucharist is certain and real, but that the mode of that presence is known only to God, and that the church errs when she attempts to bind the faithful to a particular philosophical account of the mystery. He held that all who receive the bread and cup with faith receive Christ himself; and that those who receive unworthily receive him to their judgment, as St Paul teaches. His formula—"That with the bread and with the wine the Body and Blood of Christ are truly and substantially present, given, and received"—was adopted by the Synod of Candida Casa in 849.

The Concordat of Candida Casa was a gathering of Insular bishops called by Nechtan, Bishop of Galloway, at the church of Whithorn—Ninian's own Candida Casa—in the year 849, during the period of Viking pressure and ecclesiastical disruption in the North. Conscious that the philosophical disputes of the Carolingian schools were dividing the church over matters the Scripture did not resolve, the synod issued a brief statement of Eucharistic faith drawing on Aldhelm's formula. The Concordat does not name a philosophical school; it does not say 'transubstantiation' and it does not say 'symbol only.' It says that the presence is real and the gift is Christ himself. This is the position of the Insular Church.

John Duns Scotus and William of Ockham: The Catholic Precedent

The position of the Concordat of Candida Casa was subsequently defended, unknowingly, by two of the greatest minds of the mediaeval schools. John Duns Scotus (c. 1266–1308), the 'Subtle Doctor,' argued that God's absolute power (potentia absoluta) cannot be constrained by Aristotelian categories of substance and accident; the real presence of Christ in the Eucharist is certain as a matter of faith, but the philosophical account of its mode is a human construction layered upon a divine mystery. William of Ockham (c. 1287–1347), the 'Venerable Inceptor,' went further: he argued that the doctrine of transubstantiation as formulated in scholastic theology cannot be demonstrated by natural reason, but is received by faith on the authority of the church. He further argued that Christ's body could be present with the bread without annihilating the bread's substance—what later thinkers would call consubstantiation—and that only the church's received teaching, not philosophical necessity, rules this out. Neither Scotus nor Ockham denied transubstantiation; both denied that one philosophical account of the mystery could exhaust it. The Insular Church stands with them in this Scholastic humility, and with the Concordat of Candida Casa in its positive affirmation.

Pre-Tridentine Catholic Theology

The Council of Trent (1545–1563) defined transubstantiation as a dogma required for full Roman communion and closed the discussion that Scotus and Ockham had left open. The Insular Church stands deliberately before that definition, in the tradition of the pre-scholastic and early scholastic Western church, which held the real presence as certain while leaving its philosophical mode open to inquiry. This is not a rejection of transubstantiation—it is a refusal to make one philosophical account of the mystery a condition of communion to the Lord's Table. The ancient doctors of the church—Augustine, Ambrose, John Chrysostom—all affirmed the real presence without the vocabulary of Aristotelian substance-theory. The Insular Church claims their company.

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THE GREGORIAN RITE

Ordo Missae secundum usum Beati Gregorii Magni

✦ ✦ ✦

The Order of the Holy Mass

According to the Use of Pope Saint Gregory the Great (d. 604)

For the Insular Church of Britain

within the Realm of Mvindicraft

Bilingual Edition · Latin and English

A Simplified Mass of 20–30 Minutes

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PREFACE

The Gregorian Inheritance

In the thirty-fifth year of the Christian presence at the court of Whithorn, when the stones of Candida Casa stood grey against the Galloway hills and the tide crept nightly over the pilgrim causeway, there came word from Rome: a Bishop of uncommon humility had ascended the throne of St Peter. He was Gregory, called the Great, a Roman senator turned monk, a man who wept in the streets at the sight of enslaved Angle children — 'Non Angli sed Angeli,' he said, 'not Angles but Angels' — and who spent his pontificate not in marble halls but in soup kitchens, hospitals, and the dusty correspondence of a man who loved souls more than ceremony.

Gregory I (c. 540–604) was the reformer of the Roman Mass. In the years of his pontificate, he gathered the scattered liturgical traditions of the Western Church into a single, ordered Sacramentary — a book of prayers that collected collects, prefaces, and Eucharistic formulae into a coherent rite. The Gregorian Sacramentary, later carried north by Alcuin of York to the Carolingian court and sent in its corrected form to Britain, became the foundation upon which all subsequent Western Eucharistic worship was built. When a priest in the realm of Mvindicraft lifts the chalice and speaks the ancient words of consecration, he stands in an unbroken chain that reaches back to Gregory's scriptorium on the Caelian Hill.

Gregory also organized the Schola Cantorum — the school of chant in Rome — and so gave the Church her voice. The antiphons that frame the mass, the Introit that sets the tone of each celebration, the Gradual sung between Epistle and Gospel, the Communion chant that accompanies the receiving of the Sacrament: all these are Gregorian inheritances. In a Mvindicraft church, even the simplest spoken prayer participates in this heritage; on greater feast days, where the priest may choose to intone, he echoes the tradition of fifteen centuries.

But Gregory's special claim upon the Church of Britain is this: he sent Augustine to these shores. In the year 596, Gregory dispatched forty monks — including Augustine, their prior — from his own monastery of Sant'Andrea al Celio northward across the Alps, through Gaul, and into the grey seas that separate the Continent from Britain. They landed at Thanet in the kingdom of Kent in 597, were received by King Æthelberht, and baptized the first English king on the Feast of Pentecost. From that moment, the Roman Gregorian use was planted in British soil.

Gregory never came to Britain himself. He is said to have wept when his appointment as pope prevented him from making the journey he had longed for. But he governed the mission by letter, and those letters survive. Chief among them is his famous instruction to the Abbot Mellitus, carried in 601 to Augustine now serving as the first Archbishop of Canterbury: 'Do not destroy the temples of the idols; destroy only the idols themselves. Take holy water and sprinkle it in these shrines, build altars, and place relics in them. For if the shrines are well built, it is essential

that they should be converted from the worship of devils to the service of the true God; because when the people see their shrines are not destroyed, they will be able to banish error from their hearts and be more ready to come to the places they are familiar with, but now recognizing and worshipping the true God.' This is the pastoral genius of Gregory — the great principle of inculturation that has shaped the Insular Church in Mvindicraft: meet the people where they are, consecrate what is beautiful in them, build on the good already laid.

The Rite of Saint Gregory as practiced in Mvindicraft is therefore not an antiquarian curiosity but a living form. It is grounded in the Gregorian Sacramentary, simplified for a missionary church, and adapted by the Insular tradition — by figures such as St Theodore of Tarsus (Archbishop of Canterbury 668–690), who carried Gregorian order into the disparate Celtic customs; by the monks of Lindisfarne, who united Irish austerity with Roman structure; and by the generations of Insular priests who shaped the Roman inheritance into something both universal and local. This rite honors Gregory as its author, Augustine as its bearer, and the Insular Church as its keeper.

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A Note on the Use of This Book

This book provides the Order of the Holy Mass in two columns: Latin on the left, English on the right. The priest may celebrate entirely in Latin, entirely in English, or in any combination at his discretion. The tradition of the Insular Church holds that the people should understand what is spoken; as Gregory himself wrote, 'let nothing be done in the house of God that the people do not understand.' Therefore, on ordinary occasions and in mission settings, English is warmly recommended. On greater solemnities, or where the congregation is learned, the Latin enriches the sense of timelessness and universality that the mass conveys.

The rite as given here is designed for a celebration of twenty to thirty minutes in the LARP context of Mvindicraft. Certain sections that might be lengthened on great occasions — particularly the Liturgy of the Word, the Homily, and the chanting of antiphons — have been kept in their shortest viable form. The priest should adapt the pace to his congregation. All sections marked with a red rubric instruction describe ceremonial actions, posture, or context.

Responses spoken by the People are indicated by [P]. Responses spoken by the Priest are indicated by [Pr.]. Sections sung in the original Gregorian tradition are noted; in the Mvindicraft setting these may be spoken instead. Where an asterisk (*) appears, the priest may omit the section on ordinary Sundays and ferias, retaining it for Solemnities and principal Feasts.

The Offering of the faithful — the bringing of bread and wine to the altar — should be made with whatever materials are available on the Mvindicraft server: bread and a vessel of water suffice where wine is unavailable, following the ancient Gallican exception for mission territories recorded in the Customarium Insulanum.

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THE ORDER OF THE MASS

Ordo Missae

✦ THE MASS OF THE CATECHUMENS ✦

The first part of the Mass, in which the Word of God is proclaimed and the faithful are instructed. In Gregory's day, unbaptized catechumens were present for this part and then dismissed before the Liturgy of the Faithful began. In the Insular Church of Mvindicraft, all baptized players may remain throughout.

I – THE ENTRANCE — Introitus

The priest processes to the altar accompanied by servers. Gregory's Schola Cantorum tradition assigns an Introit antiphon — a verse from the Psalms sung as the ministers approach — setting the tone of the day's celebration. In Mvindicraft, this may be sung or spoken by the priest as he enters and bows before the altar cross.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
The Priest enters and stands before the altar. He makes a profound bow, then signs himself with the Cross and begins.	
In nómine Patris, et Fílii, et Spíritus Sancti.	[Pr.] In the Name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.
[P.] Amen.	[P.] Amen.
The Priest turns to face the people, or — following the older use — remains ad orientem (facing east, toward the altar). He extends his hands in greeting.	
[Pr.] Dóminus vobíscum.	[Pr.] The Lord be with you.
[P.] Et cum spíritu tuo.	[P.] And with thy spirit.
The Priest then recites or sings the Introit antiphon appointed for the day. On ordinary Sundays, the following versicle from Psalm 84 may serve as a general Introit.	
Ostende nobis, Dómine, misericórdiam tuam: et salutáre tuum da nobis. — Ps. 84:8	Show us, O Lord, thy mercy: and grant us thy salvation. — Psalm 84:8

II – THE KYRIE — Kyrie Eleison

One of the most ancient elements of the Mass, the Kyrie is retained in Greek even in the Latin rite as a sign of the Church's Eastern heritage. Gregory standardized it in ninefold form (three Kyries, three Christes, three Kyries), though it may be said three or nine times according to the occasion. It is a cry of mercy, the whole Church calling out to Christ as the disciples called to him across the storm-tossed water of Galilee.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
Said or sung three times each, alternating between Priest and People. On solemn occasions, nine times in full.	
[Pr.] Kýrie, eléison. [P.] Kýrie, eléison. [Pr.] Kýrie, eléison.	[Pr.] Lord, have mercy. [P.] Lord, have mercy. [Pr.] Lord, have mercy.
[Pr.] Christe, eléison. [P.] Christe, eléison. [Pr.] Christe, eléison.	[Pr.] Christ, have mercy. [P.] Christ, have mercy. [Pr.] Christ, have mercy.
[Pr.] Kýrie, eléison. [P.] Kýrie, eléison. [Pr.] Kýrie, eléison.	[Pr.] Lord, have mercy. [P.] Lord, have mercy. [Pr.] Lord, have mercy.

III – THE GLORIA ✦ Solemnities & Feasts *

The Gloria in Excelsis Deo — the 'Greater Doxology' — is an ancient hymn of praise based upon the song of the angels at Bethlehem (Luke 2:14). Gregory assigned it to Sundays and feast days; it is omitted during Advent, Lent, and ferias (ordinary weekdays). The priest intones the opening line and the people or choir continue. On simple occasions in Mvindicraft, the priest may say it alone.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
On Sundays (outside Lent and Advent) and all Feasts and Solemnities. The Priest intones the first line, then all continue.	
[Pr.] Glória in excélsis Deo.	[Pr.] Glory be to God on high.
[All] Et in terra pax homínibus bonæ voluntátis. Laudámus te. Benedícimus te. Adorámus te. Glorificámus te. Grátias ágimus tibi propter mágnam glóriam tuam. Dómine Deus, Rex cæléstis, Deus Pater omnípotens. Dómine Fili unigénite,	[All] And on earth peace to men of good will. We praise thee. We bless thee. We adore thee. We glorify thee. We give thee thanks for thy great glory. O Lord God, Heavenly King, God the Father Almighty. O Lord the Only-begotten Son, Jesus

Iesu Christe. Dómine Deus, Agnus Dei, Fílius Patris. Qui tollis peccáta mundi, miserére nobis. Qui tollis peccáta mundi, súscipe deprecatiónem nostram. Qui sedes ad déxteram Patris, miserére nobis. Quóniam tu solus Sanctus. Tu solus Dóminus. Tu solus Altíssimus, Iesu Christe. Cum Sancto Spíritu, in glória Dei Patris. Amen.	Christ. O Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father. Thou who takest away the sins of the world, have mercy on us. Thou who takest away the sins of the world, receive our prayer. Thou who sittest at the right hand of the Father, have mercy on us. For thou only art holy. Thou only art the Lord. Thou only, O Jesus Christ, art most high. With the Holy Spirit, in the glory of God the Father. Amen.

IV – THE COLLECT — Oratio

The Collect is the prayer that 'collects' the intentions of the assembled faithful into one petition addressed to God. Gregory's Sacramentary organized hundreds of these terse, elegant prayers — one for each Sunday and feast day of the year. The form is invariable: an address to God, a petition, a Christological conclusion. The Insular Church preserves the Gregorian collect form, adapting it freely to the season. A sample collect for ordinary occasions is given below; the priest may substitute the proper collect of the day from the Insular Book.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
The Priest extends his hands and says:	
[Pr.] Orémus.	**[Pr.] Let us pray.**
A brief silence. Then:	
Deus, qui nos in tantis perículis constituítos pro humána scis fragilitate non posse subsístere: dagrátiam tuam nobis misericórditer confér; ita ut per eam ómnibus excedéntes advérsis, in ómnibus dirigámur ad salútem. Per Dóminum nostrum Iesum Christum Fílium tuum: qui tecum vivit et regnat in unitáte Spíritus Sancti, Deus per ómnia sæcula sæculórum.	O God, who knowest that we, set in so many perils, cannot endure therein by reason of human frailty: grant us health of mind and body; that those things which we suffer for our sins, by thine aid we may overcome. Through Jesus Christ thy Son our Lord, who liveth and reigneth with thee in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, for ever and ever.
[P.] Amen.	[P.] Amen.

V – THE LITURGY OF THE WORD — Missae Catechumenorum

Gregory was above all a preacher. His forty Homilies on the Gospels remain masterpieces of pastoral theology. The full Gregorian Liturgy of the Word follows the ancient threefold structure of the Jerusalem lectionary carried to Rome: a reading from the Old Testament (the Prophecy), a reading from the Apostolic writings (the Epistle), and the Holy Gospel — with sung responses between each. Gregory insisted that the homily follow the Gospel: 'the word preached is the seed of the Kingdom.' In Mvindicraft this section observes the full threefold order; on ferias (ordinary weekdays) the Old Testament reading may be omitted if time is short.

A. THE OLD TESTAMENT READING — Lectio Prophetica

The reading from the Old Testament — called the Lectio Prophetica or Prophecy — is the oldest layer of the Christian liturgy of the Word, inherited directly from the synagogue service that the earliest followers of Jesus attended. The Law and the Prophets were read aloud in the assembly from the very beginning of Israel's worship; Jesus himself read from the Isaiah scroll in the synagogue at Nazareth (Luke 4:16–21). The Church inherited this practice, understanding the Old Testament as the preparation for, and prophecy of, the New. Gregory saw every page of the Hebrew scriptures as a veil behind which Christ was hidden; the task of the homilist, he wrote, was to draw back that veil. In the Gregorian rite the Prophecy is read before the Epistle, establishing the deep roots from which the Apostolic word grows.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
All are seated. The Priest or a lector reads the Old Testament passage at the ambo or lectern. He announces the reading:	
[Pr./Lector] Léctio libri [Génesis / Exódi / Isaíæ / etc.]	[Pr./Lector] A reading from the book of [Genesis / Exodus / Isaiah / etc.]
The appointed passage from the Old Testament is read. It may be taken from the Insular lectionary or chosen by the priest to accord with the Epistle and Gospel of the day. A passage of eight to twelve verses is fitting for the Mvindicraft celebration. At the conclusion:	
[P.] Deo grátias.	[P.] Thanks be to God.
The Responsorial Psalm follows immediately — a verse or two from the Psalms, sung or recited antiphonally between priest and people, meditating upon the Old Testament reading. The following general responsory from Psalm 118 serves for ordinary Sundays; the proper psalm of the day may be substituted.	

[Pr.] V. Benedíctus es, Dómine: doce me iustificatiónes tuas. — Ps. 118:12	[Pr.] V. Blessed art thou, O Lord: teach me thy statutes. — Psalm 118:12
[P.] R. Benedíctus es, Dómine: doce me iustificatiónes tuas.	[P.] R. Blessed art thou, O Lord: teach me thy statutes.
During Lent, the following Tract verse from Psalm 50 is said instead of the above responsory:	
[Pr.] Miserére mei, Deus, secúndum magnam misericórdiam tuam: et secúndum multitúdinem miseratiónum tuárum, dele iniquitátem meam. — Ps. 50:3	[Pr.] Have mercy on me, O God, according to thy great mercy: and according to the multitude of thy tender mercies, blot out my iniquity. — Psalm 50:3

B. THE EPISTLE — Léctio Apostólica

The Epistle is a reading from the Apostolic writings — the letters of Paul, Peter, James, John, or Jude, or from the Acts of the Apostles. In the Gregorian structure it follows the Old Testament reading as the second of the three great proclamations: the Church in the time between the Promise and its Fulfilment, guided by the Apostles. Gregory himself was a devoted reader of Paul; his Moralia in Iob is saturated with Pauline theology, and his letters echo the great Apostle's pastoral care for distant communities he could only reach by writing. The Epistle is read from the south side of the altar (the right side as seen from the people), traditionally the side associated with the old dispensation.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
The Priest or a lector moves to the south side (Epistle side) of the altar or to the lectern. He announces the reading:	
[Pr./Lector] Léctio Epístolæ beáti Pauli [vel Petri / Iacóbi / Ioánnis] Apóstoli ad [N.]	[Pr./Lector] A reading from the letter of the blessed Apostle Paul [or Peter / James / John] to the [N.]
The appointed Epistle is read. At the conclusion:	
[P.] Deo grátias.	[P.] Thanks be to God.
The Gradual follows — a responsory chanted between the Epistle and the Gospel. The Gradual is one of the most ancient elements of the Roman rite; it is sung from the steps (gradus) of the ambo, hence its name. On ordinary Sundays the following serves; the proper Gradual of the day may be substituted.	

[Pr.] V. Unam petíi a Dómino, hanc requíram: ut inhábitem in domo Dómini ómnibus diébus vitæ meæ. — Ps. 26:4	[Pr.] V. One thing I have asked of the Lord, this I will seek after: that I may dwell in the house of the Lord all the days of my life. — Psalm 26:4
[P.] R. Ut íntueam voluptátem Dómini et vísitem templum eius.	[P.] R. That I may behold the delight of the Lord and visit his temple.
The Alleluia — or, in Lent, the Tract. The Alleluia is the jubilant acclamation before the Gospel. Gregory loved the Alleluia and extended its use beyond the paschal season into ordinary time. In penitential seasons (Lent, Ember Days, Masses for the Dead) it is replaced by the Tract. On Easter Sunday and throughout the Octave, the Alleluia is doubled.	
[Pr.] Allelúia. [P.] Allelúia. [Pr.] V. Laus tibi, Christe, Rex ætérnæ glóriæ.	[Pr.] Alleluia. [P.] Alleluia. [Pr.] V. Praise to thee, O Christ, King of eternal glory.
— IN LENT, in place of the Alleluia: —	
[Pr.] Tráctus. De profúndis clamávi ad te, Dómine: Dómine, exáudi vocem meam. — Ps. 129:1–2	[Pr.] Tract. Out of the deep have I cried unto thee, O Lord: O Lord, hear my voice. — Psalm 129:1–2

C. THE HOLY GOSPEL — Evangelium

The Holy Gospel is the summit of the Liturgy of the Word — the proclamation of the words and deeds of Christ himself. All rise to honour his presence in the proclaimed Word. The Priest or Deacon carries the Gospel Book in procession to the ambo (or to the north side of the altar), the side traditionally associated with the north — the direction from which the pagans of Gregory's day came, and toward which the mission preacher turned his voice. Gregory's own Homilies on the Gospels were preached to the congregation assembled in the great basilicas of Rome; he dictated them to a notary while a reader conveyed them aloud to the people. In those homilies Gregory weeps, laughs, argues, and exhorts — always returning to the central theme of pastoral charity that was his life's work.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
All rise. The Priest moves to the north side (Gospel side) of the altar or to the ambo. He makes the sign of the Cross upon the Gospel Book, then upon his forehead, his lips, and his breast, saying quietly: 'May the Lord be in my heart and upon my lips, that I may worthily proclaim his holy Gospel.' He then addresses the people:	
[Pr.] Dóminus vobíscum.	[Pr.] The Lord be with you.

[P.] Et cum spíritu tuo.	[P.] And with thy spirit.
[Pr.] (+) Sequéntia sancti Evangélii secúndum [Matthæum / Márcum / Lucam / Ioánnem].	[Pr.] (+) The continuation of the holy Gospel according to [Matthew / Mark / Luke / John].
[P.] Glória tibi, Dómine.	[P.] Glory be to thee, O Lord.
The appointed Gospel passage is read or proclaimed with solemnity. A passage of eight to fifteen verses is fitting; on great Solemnities (Christmas, Easter, Pentecost, the Feast of St Gregory) a longer passage is appropriate. The people listen standing throughout, as witnesses to the Living Word. At the conclusion:	
[P.] Laus tibi, Christe.	[P.] Praise be to thee, O Christ.
The Priest kisses the Gospel Book, saying quietly:	
Per evangélica dicta deleántur nostra delícta.	Through the words of the Gospel may our sins be blotted out.
The Priest then delivers the Homily — the sermon upon the Gospel. According to Gregory's Pastoral Rule, the Regula Pastoralis, the homilist must understand his congregation and speak to each according to their capacity: to the learned with nuance, to the simple with clarity, to the sorrowing with comfort, to the prosperous with warning. The homily should illuminate the Gospel text and apply its word to the lives of those present. In Mvindicraft, a reflection of two to five minutes fully honours this obligation. All are seated for the Homily.	
(Silentium ante concionem.)	*(A brief silence before the Homily.)*

After the Homily, the Priest may invite the people to a moment of silent reflection before the Creed or the Offertory begins. This practice, known from Gregory's own homiletical method — he frequently paused to allow his congregation to absorb what had been said — is strongly commended in the Insular tradition.

VI — THE CREED ✦ Sundays & Solemnities *

The Nicene Creed was added to the Roman Mass only gradually; it was already customary in Spain and the Frankish territories by the eighth century, and became universal in Rome under Pope Benedict VIII in 1014. Within the 500–1550 timeframe of Mvindicraft, it may be omitted on ferias and ordinary Sundays but is required on Solemnities. The Insular Church uses the ancient text without the Filioque controversy's bitterness, understanding it as the common inheritance of the undivided Church.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
On Sundays and all principal Feasts. All stand and face the altar.	

Credo in unum Deum, Patrem omnipoténtem, factórem cæli et terræ, visibílium ómnium et invisibílium.	I believe in one God, the Father almighty, maker of heaven and earth, of all things visible and invisible.
Et in unum Dóminum Iesum Christum, Fílium Dei unigénitum, et ex Patre natum ante ómnia sæcula. Deum de Deo, lumen de lúmine, Deum verum de Deo vero, génitum non factum, consubstantiálem Patri: per quem ómnia facta sunt.	And in one Lord Jesus Christ, the only-begotten Son of God, begotten of the Father before all ages. God from God, Light from Light, true God from true God, begotten, not made, consubstantial with the Father; through whom all things were made.
Qui propter nos hómines et propter nostram salútem descéndit de cælis. Et incarnátus est de Spíritu Sancto ex María Vírgine, et homo factus est. — (All bow at these words) —	Who for us men and for our salvation descended from heaven. And was incarnate by the Holy Spirit of the Virgin Mary, and became man. — (All bow at these words) —
Crucifíxus étiam pro nobis sub Póntio Piláto, passus et sepúltus est. Et resurréxit tértia die, secúndum Scriptúras.	He was also crucified for us under Pontius Pilate, suffered and was buried. And rose again on the third day, in accordance with the Scriptures.
Et ascéndit in cælum, sedet ad déxteram Patris. Et íterum ventúrus est cum glória, iudicáre vivos et mórtuos; cuius regni non erit finis.	And ascended into heaven, and is seated at the right hand of the Father. He will come again in glory to judge the living and the dead; and his kingdom will have no end.
Et in Spíritum Sanctum, Dóminum et vivificántem, qui ex Patre procédit. Qui cum Patre et Fílio simul adorátur et conglorificátur: qui locútus est per Prophétas.	And in the Holy Spirit, the Lord and giver of life, who proceeds from the Father. Who with the Father and the Son is together adored and glorified; who spoke through the Prophets.
Et unam, sanctam, cathólicam et apostólicam Ecclésiam. Conféteor unum baptísma in remissiónem peccatórum. Et	And one, holy, Catholic and Apostolic Church. I confess one baptism for the forgiveness of sins. And I await the

exspécto resurrectiónem mortuórum, et vitam ventúri sæculi. Amen.	resurrection of the dead, and the life of the world to come. Amen.

✦ THE MASS OF THE FAITHFUL ✦

The second and greater part of the Mass, in which the baptized faithful alone originally participated. Here the gifts are offered, the Eucharistic Prayer spoken over them, and the Body and Blood of Christ given to the communicants. This is the innermost sanctuary of the rite, the Holy of Holies of Christian worship, which Gregory organized with lapidary simplicity.

VII – THE OFFERTORY — Oblatio

The Offertory is the bringing of bread and wine to the altar — the Church's offering of earthly gifts to be transformed into heavenly ones. In the ancient rite, members of the congregation brought their own gifts of bread and wine in a procession; Gregory's Sacramentary codified the accompanying antiphon. In the Insular Church of Mvindicraft, the priest presents the bread and water (or wine) at the altar while an Offertory antiphon is sung or said. The gifts represent not merely food but the labor and self-offering of the whole people.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
The Priest receives or sets out the bread and the chalice upon the altar. He offers the bread, saying quietly or aloud:	
Súscipe, sancte Pater, ómnipotens ætérne Deus, hanc immaculátam hóstiam, quam ego indígnus fámulus tuus óffero tibi Deo meo vivo et vero, pro innumerabílibus peccátis, offensiónibus, et negligéntiis meis, et pro ómnibus circumstántibus: sed et pro ómnibus fidélibus chrístiánis vivis atque defúnctis; ut mihi et illis profíciat ad salútem in vitam ætérnam. Amen.	Accept, O holy Father, almighty and eternal God, this spotless offering which I, thy unworthy servant, make to thee, my living and true God, for my own countless sins, offences, and negligences, and for all those standing round; but likewise for all the faithful Christians, living and departed; that it may avail for my salvation and theirs unto life eternal. Amen.
He offers the chalice:	
Offérimus tibi, Dómine, cálicem salutáris, tuam deprecántes cleméntiam: ut in conspéctu divínæ maiestátis tuæ, pro nostra et totíus mundi salúte, cum odóre suavitátis ascéndat. Amen.	We offer thee, O Lord, the chalice of salvation, beseeching thy clemency, that it may ascend before thy divine majesty, for our salvation and that of the whole world, as a sweet savour. Amen.
The Priest washes his fingers (or simply makes a gesture of cleansing) saying quietly:	

Lavábo inter innocéntes manus meas: et circumdábo altáre tuum, Dómine. — Ps. 25:6	I will wash my hands among the innocent: and I will compass thine altar, O Lord. — Psalm 25:6
Turning to face the people briefly, the Priest says:	
[Pr.] Oráte, fratres: ut meum ac vestrum sacrifícium acceptábile fiat apud Deum Patrem omnipoténtem.	[Pr.] Pray, brethren, that my sacrifice and yours may become acceptable to God the Father Almighty.
[P.] Suscípiat Dóminus sacrifícium de mánibus tuis, ad laudem et glóriam nóminis sui, ad utilitátem quoque nostram, totiúsque Ecclésiæ suæ sanctæ.	[P.] May the Lord receive the sacrifice from thy hands, to the praise and glory of his Name, for our benefit also, and that of all his holy Church.
The Secret — a prayer said quietly over the gifts. On ordinary occasions the following serves:	
(Quietly) Accépta tibi sit, Dómine, sacráta præsens oblátio: quæ et peccatórum nostrórum víncula résolvist, et tuæ nobis misericórdiæ dona concíliet. Per Christum Dóminum nostrum. Amen.	(Quietly) May this holy offering, O Lord, be pleasing to thee; which both looses the bonds of our sins, and wins for us the gifts of thy mercy. Through Christ our Lord. Amen.

VIII – THE PREFACE & SANCTUS — Præfatio & Sanctus

The Preface is the great thanksgiving that opens the Eucharistic Prayer proper — a soaring dialogue between priest and people that lifts the hearts of the faithful heavenward. 'Sursum corda!' — Lift up your hearts! — cries the priest, and the people answer they have lifted them to the Lord. Gregory's Sacramentary contains several Prefaces for different seasons and feasts; the Common Preface given here serves for ordinary occasions. The Sanctus — 'Holy, Holy, Holy' — unites the earthly liturgy with the angelic hymn of the seraphim in Isaiah 6, which Gregory had contemplated in his commentary on the book of Job. It is the peak of the first great ascent, before the Canon descends into mystery.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
[Pr.] Dóminus vobíscum.	[Pr.] The Lord be with you.
[P.] Et cum spíritu tuo.	[P.] And with thy spirit.

[Pr.] Sursum corda.	[Pr.] Lift up your hearts.
[P.] Habémus ad Dóminum.	[P.] We have lifted them to the Lord.
[Pr.] Grátias agámus Dómino Deo nostro.	[Pr.] Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.
[P.] Dignum et iustum est.	[P.] It is meet and right so to do.
[Pr.] Vere dignum et iustum est, æquum et salutáre, nos tibi semper et ubíque grátias ágere: Dómine sancte, Pater omnípotens, ætérne Deus. Qui cum unigénito Fílio tuo et Spíritu Sancto, unus es Deus, unus es Dóminus: non in unius singularitáte persónæ, sed in unius Trinitáte substántiæ. Quod enim de tua glória, revelánte te, crédimus, hoc de Fílio tuo, hoc de Spíritu Sancto, sine differéntia discretiónis sentímus. Ut in confessióne veræ seternæque Deitátis, et in persónis propríetas, et in esséntia únitas, et in maiestáte adorétur æquálitas. Quam laudant Angeli atque Archángeli, Cherúbim quoque ac Séraphim, qui non cessant clamáre cotídie, una voce dicéntes:	[Pr.] It is truly meet and right, our duty and our salvation, always and everywhere to give thanks to thee: O holy Lord, Father almighty, eternal God. Who with thine only-begotten Son and the Holy Spirit art one God, one Lord: not in the singularity of one Person but in the Trinity of one substance. For that which we believe of thy glory, as thou hast revealed it, the same we hold of thy Son, the same of the Holy Ghost, without any difference or inequality. So that in the confession of the true and eternal Godhead, we adore distinctness of Persons, unity in being, and equality in majesty. Which the Angels and Archangels praise, the Cherubim also and the Seraphim, who cease not daily to cry with one voice, saying:
All sing or say together:	
[All] Sanctus, Sanctus, Sanctus Dóminus Deus Sábaoth. Pleni sunt cæli et terra glória tua. Hosánna in excélsis. Benedíctus qui venit in nómine Dómini. Hosánna in excélsis.	[All] Holy, Holy, Holy Lord God of hosts. Heaven and earth are full of thy glory. Hosanna in the highest. Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Hosanna in the highest.

IX – THE CANON OF THE MASS — Canon Missae

The Canon Missae — 'the rule of the mass' — is the Eucharistic Prayer, the most sacred portion of the entire rite. Gregory did not originate the Roman Canon; it was already substantially in place before his time, drawing on late-fourth-century Roman tradition. But it was Gregory who fixed its final form. He described it as the work of a 'certain Scholasticus' and may himself have added the Hanc igitur clause and the petition for the departed. The Canon is said quietly in the Roman use — a mark of reverence before the mystery. It culminates in the Words of Institution — the precise words of Christ at the Last Supper — over the bread and the chalice. In Mvindicraft, the priest speaks the Canon over the offerings on the altar. A simplified form of the Canon's essential structure is given here.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
The Priest extends his hands over the offerings and begins the Canon, saying quietly:	
Te ígitur, clementíssime Pater, per Iesum Christum Fílium tuum Dóminum nostrum, súpplices rogámus ac pétimus, uti accépta hábeas et benedícas hæc dona, hæc múnera, hæc sancta sacrifícia illibáta.	We therefore humbly pray and beseech thee, most merciful Father, through Jesus Christ thy Son our Lord, to accept and bless these gifts, these offerings, these holy and unblemished sacrifices.
Meménto, Dómine, famulórum famularúmque tuárum [N. et N.] et ómnium circumstántium, quorum tibi fides cógnita est et nota devótio: pro quibus tibi offérimus, vel qui tibi ófferunt, hoc sacrifícium laudis pro se suísque ómnibus: pro redemptióne animárum suárum, pro spe salútis et incolumitátis suæ; tibíque reddunt vota sua ætérno Deo, vivo et vero.	Remember, O Lord, thy servants [N. and N.] and all here present, whose faith and devotion are known to thee: for whom we offer, or who offer to thee, this sacrifice of praise for themselves and all their own: for the redemption of their souls, for the hope of their health and salvation; and who offer their vows to thee, the eternal God, the living and true.
Commemorating the Universal Church and the faithful departed:	
Communicántes, et memóriam venerántes, in primis gloriósæ semper Vírginis Maríæ, Genitricis Dei et Dómini nostri Iesu Christi; sed et beatórum Apostolórum ac Mártyrum tuórum, [Petri et Pauli, Andreæ, Ioánnis et Iacóbi, Thomæ, Philíppi, Bartholomæi, Matthæi, Simónis et	In communion with, and venerating the memory, first of all, of the glorious ever-Virgin Mary, Mother of our God and Lord Jesus Christ; but also of thy blessed Apostles and Martyrs, [Peter and Paul, Andrew, John and James, Thomas, Philip, Bartholomew, Matthew, Simon and

Thaddæi:] et ómnium Sanctórum tuórum; quorum méritis precibúsque concédas, ut in ómnibus protectiónis tuæ muniámur auxílio. Per eúndem Christum Dóminum nostrum. Amen.	Thaddeus:] and of all thy Saints; by whose merits and prayers grant that in all things we may be defended by the help of thy protection. Through the same Christ our Lord. Amen.
The Priest takes the bread in his hands and says the Words of Consecration. His tone becomes grave and deliberate. He bows slightly over the host.	
Qui prídie quam paterétur, accepit panem in sanctas ac venerábiles manus suas, et elevátis óculis in cælum ad te Deum Patrem suum omipoténtem, tíbi grátias agens benedíxit, fregit, dedítque discípulis suis, dicens:	Who, the day before he suffered, took bread into his holy and venerable hands, and with his eyes lifted up to heaven unto thee, God his Father Almighty, giving thanks to thee, he blessed, broke, and gave it to his disciples, saying:
HOC EST ENIM CORPUS MEUM.	**FOR THIS IS MY BODY.**
The Priest genuflects in adoration, then elevates the consecrated Host. All bow. Then he takes the chalice and says:	
Símili modo, postquam cenátum est, accípiens et hunc præclárum Cálicem in sanctas ac venerábiles manus suas: item tibi grátias agens bendíxit, dedítque discípulis suis, dicens:	In like manner, after he had supped, taking also this glorious Chalice into his holy and venerable hands: likewise giving thanks to thee, he blessed and gave it to his disciples, saying:
HIC EST ENIM CALIX SÁNGUINIS MEI, NOVI ET ÆTÉRNI TESTAMÉNTI: MYSTÉRIUM FÍDEI: QUI PRO VOBIS ET PRO MULTIS EFFUNDÉTUR IN REMISSIÓNEM PECCATÓRUM.	**FOR THIS IS THE CHALICE OF MY BLOOD, OF THE NEW AND ETERNAL TESTAMENT: THE MYSTERY OF FAITH: WHICH SHALL BE SHED FOR YOU AND FOR MANY UNTO THE REMISSION OF SINS.**
The Priest genuflects again in adoration, then elevates the chalice. All bow. Then he continues:	
Hæc quotiescúmque fecéritis, in mei memóriam faciétis.	As often as ye shall do these things, ye shall do them in remembrance of me.
The Anamnesis — the memorial:	

Unde et mémores, Dómine, nos servi tui, sed et plebs tua sancta, eiúsdem Christi Fílii tui Dómini nostri, tam beátæ passiónis, necnon et ab ínferis resurrectiónis, sed et in cælos gloriósæ ascensiónis: offérimus præcláræ maiestáti tuæ de tuis donis ac datis, hóstiam puram, hóstiam sanctam, hóstiam immaculátam: Panem sanctum vitæ ætérnæ et Cálicem salútis perpétuæ.	Wherefore also, O Lord, we thy servants, but also thy holy people, calling to mind the blessed Passion of the same Christ thy Son our Lord, his resurrection from the grave, and his glorious Ascension into heaven: do offer unto thy most excellent Majesty from among thine own gifts and bounties, a pure Victim, a holy Victim, an unspotted Victim: the holy Bread of eternal life and the Chalice of everlasting salvation.
Prayers for the living and departed:	
Mémento étiam, Dómine, famulórum famularúmque tuárum [N. et N.] qui nos præcessérunt cum signo fídei et dórmiunt in somno pacis. Ipsis, Dómine, et ómnibus in Christo quiescéntibus, locus refrigérii, lucis et pacis, ut indúlgeas, deprecámur. Per eúndem Christum Dóminum nostrum. Amen.	Remember also, O Lord, thy servants [N. and N.] who have gone before us with the sign of faith and rest in the sleep of peace. To them, O Lord, and to all who rest in Christ, grant, we beseech thee, a place of refreshment, light, and peace. Through the same Christ our Lord. Amen.
The concluding doxology of the Canon:	
[Pr.] Per ipsum, et cum ipso, et in ipso, est tibi Deo Patri omipoténti, in unitáte Spíritus Sancti, ómnis honor et glória, per ómnia sæcula sæculórum.	[Pr.] Through him, and with him, and in him, is to thee, God the Father Almighty, in the unity of the Holy Spirit, all honour and glory, for ever and ever.
[P.] Amen.	**[P.] Amen.**

x – THE LORD'S PRAYER — Pater Noster

Gregory placed the Lord's Prayer immediately after the Canon, a position it had already held since the fourth century. He explained this arrangement: 'It seems improper to me that we should say over the offering a prayer composed by a scholar, while not saying over the Lord's Body and Blood the prayer which our Redeemer composed himself.' The Paternoster is prayed together by priest and people, and concludes with the ancient doxology — the same words spoken in the churches of Britain since Augustine's first baptisms at Thanet in 597.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
The Priest extends his hands and addresses the people:	
[Pr.] Orémus: præcéptis salutáribus móniti et divína institutióne formáti,audémus dícere:	[Pr.] Let us pray: admonished by saving precepts and formed by divine institution, we dare to say:
[All] Pater noster, qui es in cælis, sanctificétur nomen tuum. Advéniat regnum tuum. Fiat volúntas tua, sicut in cælo, et in terra. Panem nostrum cotidiánum da nobis hódie. Et dimítte nobis débita nostra, sicut et nos dimíttimus debitóribus nostris. Et ne nos indúcas in tentatiónem: sed líbera nos a malo.	[All] Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation: but deliver us from evil.
The Priest continues alone (the Embolism):	
[Pr.] Líbera nos, quæsumus, Dómine, ab ómnibus malis, præteritis, præséntibus et futúris: et intercedénte beáta et gloriósa semper Vírgine Dei Genitríce María, cum beátis Apóstolis tuis Petro et Paulo, atque Andréa, et ómnibus Sanctis, da propítius pacem in diébus nostris: ut ope misericórdiæ tuæ adiúti, et a peccáto simus semper líberi et ab omni perturbatióne secúri. Per eúndem Dóminum nostrum Iesum Christum Fílium tuum.	[Pr.] Deliver us, we beseech thee, O Lord, from all evils, past, present, and to come: and by the intercession of the blessed and glorious ever-Virgin Mother of God Mary, with thy blessed Apostles Peter and Paul, and Andrew, and all the Saints, graciously grant peace in our days: that aided by the help of thy mercy, we may be always free from sin and safe from all disturbance. Through the same Jesus Christ thy Son our Lord.

[P.] Amen.	**[P.] Amen.**

XI – THE AGNUS DEI — Agnus Dei

The Agnus Dei was added to the Roman Mass by Pope Sergius I (687–701) — a Syrian by birth who brought Eastern hymnody to Rome — in the generation following Gregory. It is therefore within the earliest stratum of the post-Gregorian Insular tradition; Gregory's own Augustine had departed before its introduction, but Theodore of Tarsus and the later archbishops would have known it well. The Priest breaks the Host (the Fraction) during the Agnus Dei, following the ancient symbolism: as the one loaf is broken for the many, so Christ's sacrifice is applied to all the faithful present.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
The Priest breaks the Host into two or three pieces. He says or sings three times:	
[Pr.] Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccáta mundi: miserére nobis. Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccáta mundi: miserére nobis. Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccáta mundi: dona nobis pacem.	[Pr.] Lamb of God, who takest away the sins of the world: have mercy on us. Lamb of God, who takest away the sins of the world: have mercy on us. Lamb of God, who takest away the sins of the world: grant us peace.
The Priest places a small piece of the consecrated Host into the chalice (the commingling), a gesture of unity between the Body and Blood of Christ, saying quietly:	
Hæc commíxtio et consecrátio Córporis et Sánguinis Dómini nostri Iesu Christi fiat accipiéntibus nobis in vitam ætérnam. Amen.	May this commingling and consecrating of the Body and Blood of our Lord Jesus Christ be to us who receive it unto life eternal. Amen.

XII – HOLY COMMUNION — Communio

Before the Priest communicates himself, he makes a prayer of personal preparation — an act of humility before the ineffable mystery. The Insular Church here draws upon the ancient formula preserved in the Sarum Rite and echoed in the prayer-forms used by Augustine's mission community: 'I am not worthy that thou shouldest come under my roof.' The people are then invited to receive. In Mvindicraft, all baptized players in good standing with the community may communicate. The distribution formula uses the Gregorian words, adapted in the Insular tradition to an address to each communicant.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
The Priest makes a genuflection, then says quietly:	
Dómine, non sum dignus, ut intres sub tectum meum: sed tantum dic verbo, et sanábitur ánima mea. (Thrice)	Lord, I am not worthy that thou shouldest enter under my roof: but say only the word, and my soul shall be healed. (Thrice)
The Priest communicates himself, first the Host, then from the chalice. He pauses in silent prayer. Then, turning to the people:	
[Pr.] Dóminus vobíscum.	[Pr.] The Lord be with you.
[P.] Et cum spíritu tuo.	[P.] And with thy spirit.
The Priest invites the faithful to receive:	
[Pr.] Ecce Agnus Dei, ecce qui tollit peccáta mundi. Beáti qui ad cenam Agni vocáti sunt.	[Pr.] Behold the Lamb of God, behold him who taketh away the sins of the world. Blessed are they who are called to the supper of the Lamb.
[P.] Dómine, non sum dignus, ut intres sub tectum meum: sed tantum dic verbo, et sanábitur ánima mea. (Once)	[P.] Lord, I am not worthy that thou shouldest enter under my roof: but say only the word, and my soul shall be healed. (Once)
The faithful approach. The Priest distributes the Host to each, saying:	
[Pr.] Corpus Dómini nostri Iesu Christi cústodiat ánimam tuam in vitam ætérnam. Amen.	[Pr.] May the Body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul unto life everlasting. Amen.
After all have communicated, the Priest purifies the chalice and paten in silence. He then says the Communion antiphon; for ordinary occasions the following serves:	
Quam magnum multitúdo suavitátis tuæ, Dómine, quam abscondísti timéntibus te. — Ps. 30:20	How great is the multitude of thy sweetness, O Lord, which thou hast hidden for them that fear thee. — Psalm 30:20

XIII – POST-COMMUNION & DISMISSAL — Post-Communio & Missa Est

The final prayers of the mass return the faithful to the world they have momentarily left behind — but transformed. The Post-Communion collect gathers the grace received into a petition for its fruits in daily life. The dismissal — 'Ite, missa est' — gives the Mass its very name: 'missa,' from which 'Mass' derives, originally meant simply 'the sending forth.' Gregory understood the dismissal as a commissioning: the faithful were sent out as bearers of what they had received, ambassadors of the Kingdom in the realm of Mvindicraft and in every corner of their lives.

LATINE	IN ANGLICO
The Priest turns to the people and says:	
[Pr.] Dóminus vobíscum.	[Pr.] The Lord be with you.
[P.] Et cum spíritu tuo.	[P.] And with thy spirit.
[Pr.] Orémus.	**[Pr.] Let us pray.**
The Post-Communion collect. The following serves for ordinary occasions; the proper collect from the Insular Book may be substituted:	
Quæsumus, Dómine Deus noster: ut quos divína tríbuis participatióne gaudére, humánis non sinas súbiacére perículis. Per Christum Dóminum nostrum.	We beseech thee, O Lord our God, that those whom thou dost cause to rejoice in partaking of divine things, thou suffer not to be subject to human perils. Through Christ our Lord.
[P.] Amen.	[P.] Amen.
The Priest turns to the altar for a brief silent prayer, then turns again to the people for the solemn blessing:	
[Pr.] Dóminus vobíscum.	[Pr.] The Lord be with you.
[P.] Et cum spíritu tuo.	[P.] And with thy spirit.
[Pr.] Benedícat vos omnipoténs Deus, Pater, (+) et Fílius, et Spíritus Sanctus.	[Pr.] May Almighty God bless you, the Father, (+) and the Son, and the Holy Spirit.
[P.] Amen.	**[P.] Amen.**
The Priest gives the Dismissal. Outside of the season of Lent, 'Ite, missa est' is used. During Lent, 'Benedicamus Domino' is substituted:	

[Pr.] Ite, missa est.	[Pr.] Go, the Mass is ended. — OR (in Lent) —
[Pr.] Benedicámus Dómino.	[Pr.] Let us bless the Lord.
[P.] Deo grátias.	**[P.] Thanks be to God.**
The Priest bows before the altar. He may say quietly the Last Gospel (John 1:1–14) or depart in silence. The faithful remain in brief prayer or depart. The Mass is ended.	
(quietly) In princípio erat Verbum, et Verbum erat apud Deum, et Deus erat Verbum... et Verbum caro factum est, et habitávit in nobis: et vídimus glóriam eius. — Io. 1:1, 14	(quietly) In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God... and the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us: and we beheld his glory. — John 1:1, 14

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APPENDIX A

Setting the Stage: The Gregorian Church in Mvindicraft

The church building in which the Gregorian Rite is celebrated should reflect the architectural conventions of the period 500–1550 AD, which encompasses the full history of the Insular Church. Gregory himself would have celebrated in the Roman basilical tradition: a long rectangular nave, a raised apse at the east end housing the altar, columns dividing the nave from the side aisles, a chancel screen separating the sanctuary from the laity.

In the Insular context — Scotland, northern England, Ireland — the church evolved differently. The earliest Insular churches of the sixth and seventh centuries were modest rectangular structures, often built of timber at first and later of undressed stone. The great monastic churches of Iona, Lindisfarne, and Whithorn were more ambitious, but still austere by Continental standards. The tenth-century round towers of Ireland stand as witnesses to this tradition: spare, powerful, sacred.

For Mvindicraft purposes, the following Gregorian church elements are recommended. The building should orient east–west, with the altar at the eastern end. The altar should stand free or against the east wall, covered with a white linen cloth. A cross or crucifix should stand upon or behind the altar. Candles — two at minimum on the altar — are lit for the celebration. A lectern or ambo (reading stand) should stand to one side for the Epistle and Gospel. The chancel area (around the altar) should be distinguished from the nave if possible by a step or low screen.

Vestments in the Gregorian tradition: the priest wears an alb (white linen robe), a maniple on the left wrist, a stole around the neck and crossed at the chest, and a chasuble (the outer vestment whose color varies with the season). Liturgical colors in the pre-Tridentine Western use: white or gold for Christmas, Easter, and Saints' feasts; red for Pentecost, Apostles, and Martyrs; green for ordinary Sundays after Trinity; violet or dark blue for Advent and Lent; black for Masses of the Dead. The Insular tradition adds saffron yellow as an alternative to white, reflecting Celtic artistic traditions visible in the Book of Kells and Lindisfarne Gospels.

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APPENDIX B

The Gregorian Heritage: Historical Sources

I. Pope Saint Gregory the Great (c. 540–604)

Gregory was born into Roman senatorial aristocracy, became Prefect of Rome at thirty, then abandoned secular life for the monastic vocation, converting his family villa on the Caelian Hill into a monastery of Benedictine spirit. He served as papal legate (apocrisiarius) in Constantinople, where he encountered Eastern theology and the traditions of the Greek Church. Recalled to Rome, he was elected pope in 590 against his own wishes — he had attempted to flee the city to avoid the office — and served until his death in 604.

His literary legacy is immense: the Pastoral Rule (Liber Regulae Pastoralis, c. 590), the Moralia in Iob (a vast commentary on the book of Job begun in Constantinople), the Dialogues (four books of saints' lives, including the life of St Benedict), the Homilies on the Gospels, the Homilies on Ezekiel, and an enormous body of correspondence — nearly 850 letters — that reveal his governance of a Church under barbarian pressure, plague, and famine. He fed the poor of Rome from the church's granaries, redeemed slaves, and organized the church's properties with the efficiency of the administrator he once was.

II. The Gregorian Sacramentary

The 'Gregorian Sacramentary' is not a single manuscript but a tradition of liturgical books associated with Gregory's pontificate. The most important surviving text is the Hadrianum — a copy of a Roman Gregorian sacramentary sent by Pope Hadrian I to Charlemagne c. 786–791, which Alcuin of York then supplemented and expanded for Carolingian use. This text, carried back to Britain by Anglo-Saxon ecclesiastics, shaped the English and Insular Mass throughout the medieval period.

The Gregorian Sacramentary provided: proper Collects for every Sunday and feast; a set of Prefaces for different seasons; the Canon Missae in its received form; and formularies for the administration of other sacraments. Gregory's specific contributions to the Roman Canon included inserting the petition 'diesque nostros in tua pace disponas' into the Hanc igitur and possibly composing the Sanctorum tuorum prayer for the Canon's intercession lists.

III. Gregory and the Mission to Britain

In 596, Gregory dispatched a party of approximately forty monks under Augustine — prior of the monastery of Sant'Andrea al Celio — to evangelize the English. Gregory wrote detailed instructions for the mission: how to handle disputes between bishops, how to organize the new church's structure (he envisioned two metropolitan sees, one at London and one at York), and — crucially — how to approach indigenous culture. His letter to Abbot Mellitus (July 601) contains the famous passage quoted in the Preface above, instructing Augustine not to destroy pagan temples but to consecrate them.

The mission landed at Thanet in 597. King Æthelberht of Kent, whose wife Bertha was a Frankish Christian, received them in the open air (for superstitious reasons), heard their preaching, and was baptized at Pentecost 597 in Canterbury. Gregory was moved to tears of joy at the news. He never ceased to regard the English mission as his special work — in his own words, though he could not come himself, his heart went with Augustine across the sea.

IV. St Theodore of Tarsus and the Consolidation of the Gregorian Rite in Britain

Theodore of Tarsus (602–690), appointed Archbishop of Canterbury by Pope Vitalian in 668, was perhaps the most consequential figure in the organization of the English Church after Gregory and Augustine themselves. A Greek from Tarsus who had studied at Athens and Antioch, Theodore brought to Britain an extraordinary breadth of learning — in Scripture, canon law, medicine, astronomy, and classical literature. With his companion Hadrian, an African abbot, he established the Canterbury school, which Bede calls the finest in Europe at the time.

It was Theodore who brought the various Insular liturgical traditions — Gregorian Roman, Irish Celtic, Kentish — into a working harmony within a unified province. His Paenitentiale (penitential handbook) and his Iudicia (legal decisions) shaped the pastoral practice of the Church for generations. It is through Theodore's work that the Gregorian liturgical inheritance was definitively transmitted to Scotland, Ireland, and the whole of the Insular world — including, in our imagining, the Church of Britain in Mvindicraft.

V. The Gregorian Chant Tradition

The chant tradition associated with Gregory's name — the corpus of monophonic liturgical melody known as plainchant or Gregorian chant — was not in fact composed solely by Gregory, but he reorganized the Schola Cantorum and took a sustained interest in liturgical music. Medieval tradition depicted Gregory dictating the chants he heard from the Holy Spirit, who appeared to him as a dove on his shoulder; an eighth-century icon at St Peter's shows exactly this scene.

The Gregorian chant repertoire includes: Introits (antiphons for the entrance), Graduals (responsories between readings), Alleluias and Tracts, Offertory antiphons, and Communion antiphons — the same structural positions preserved in the Gregorian Rite as given in this book. In Mvindicraft, where full choral singing may not always be possible, even a single voice intoning these ancient melodies — or simply reading them aloud with deliberate pacing — participates in this millennium-and-a-half tradition.

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Hæc sunt quæ pro Ecclesia Insulari in regno Mvindicraft ordinata sunt.
These are the things ordained for the Insular Church in the realm of Mvindicraft.

Compiled according to the Gregorian Sacramentary, the Insular Customary,
and the tradition of the Insular Church.
A.D. 500–1550 · Mvindicraft

RUBRICAL NOTES FOR PRIESTS AND SERVERS

1. POSTURE OF THE PRIEST. The Priest shall face the people for the Sursum Corda, the Offertory Preface, the Blessing, and the Dismissal. He shall face the altar for the Canon, the Epiclesis, and the Words of Institution. During the readings he may stand at the side of the altar or at a lectern.

2. THE SERVER. The Server shall kneel at the Epistle side of the altar (see Fig. III and Fig. IV). He shall ring the bell once at the Sanctus, three times at each elevation (of the Host and of the Chalice), and once at the Agnus Dei. He shall hold the book, present the cruets of wine and water, hold the paten at the Communion of the People, and hold the Communion cloth beneath the chin of each communicant at the rail.

3. THE ALTAR AND SANCTUARY. There shall be one altar only in each church, simply adorned, with two candles, the Missal, and the sacred vessels (see Fig. II). No reliquaries, flowers, or images of dubious origin shall be placed upon it, in accordance with the Ordinances and the custom of antiquity. The sanctuary is separated from the nave by an altar rail with a central gate (see Fig. I). The reredos behind the altar may bear a carved or painted image of Christ in Majesty, or of the Crucifixion, or of another scriptural scene, provided it be edifying and not superstitious.

4. THE ALTAR RAIL AND GATE. The gate in the altar rail is for the passage of the clergy and their ministers only. No lay person shall cross the gate or enter the sanctuary. At Communion, the faithful kneel at the rail on the nave side and receive the Sacrament on the tongue from the Priest, who cometh to them at the rail (see 'The Manner of Receiving Holy Communion' above).

5. THE CANON. Following the Council, the Canon is said in a clear voice audible to the people, not in a whisper, that the faithful may follow and assent with understanding. The people shall respond Amen at the Words of Institution and at the Doxology. Before the Words of Institution, the Priest saith the Admonition grounded upon John i. 12, warning the unworthy and encouraging the faithful.

6. COMMUNION. The faithful in a state of grace have a right to receive Communion during Mass. The Priest shall consecrate a sufficient number of hosts for all who are present and disposed. Communion is received kneeling at the altar rail, on the tongue, as set forth above. Communion is given in both kinds, according to the commandment of our Lord and Article XXX of the Articles of Religion. Those not disposed to communicate may come to the rail with arms crossed upon their breast and receive a blessing.

7. TIME. The Mass as here set forth may be celebrated in fifteen to thirty minutes, depending on whether a Homily is given and the number of communicants. It is designed for the practical conditions of worship in these Realms.

8. VESTMENTS. The Priest weareth alb, stole, and chasuble (see Fig. III and Fig. IV). The Server weareth cassock and surplice, or a plain alb. Simplicity in vesture is commended.

9. LANGUAGE. The Mass is said in the common tongue. The Latin and Greek formulae retained (Kyrie, Sanctus, Ite Missa est) are optional and may be said in English if the Priest so chooseth.

10. LECTIONARY. The Priest chooseth one reading from each Table (Old Testament, Epistle, Gospel) in whatever combination is fitting. He is not bound to follow a sequential order, but may freely select according to the season, the feast, or the needs of the people.

11. INCENSE. Incense may be used at the entrance, the Gospel, and the Offertory. Its use is commended but not required.

12. THE INDIVIDUAL BLESSING. At the Dismissal, before the General Blessing, the Priest cometh to the altar rail and blesseth each person individually by the laying on of hands. This is an ancient custom of the Insular Church and serveth to seal each of the faithful with the priestly benediction as they depart from the Holy Sacrifice.

13. TIMING GUIDE FOR MINECRAFT CELEBRATION. The following timing guide is provided for the practical celebration of the Holy Sacrifice in a Minecraft liturgical setting, where the primary mode of participation is through typed text.

Preparation and Entrance (3–4 minutes): Sign of the Cross, "I will go unto the altar of God," Confession, Absolution. The Priest types each section; the people respond with pre-agreed responses in chat.

Trisagion and Kyrie (1–2 minutes): Brief and responsive.

Collect and Readings (4–6 minutes): One reading from each Table. Each reading may be pasted from the Lectionary. A brief homily of 2–3 sentences is fitting.

Creed (1–2 minutes): On Sundays. Can be pasted as a block or recited antiphonally.

Offertory and Kiss of Peace (2–3 minutes): The Gallican Offertory invocation and the Peace. Each player types "Peace be to you and to the Church."

Great Thanksgiving and Canon (4–6 minutes): Sursum Corda, Preface, Sanctus, Canon with Epiclesis, Admonition, Words of Institution, Anamnesis, Diptychs, Doxology. The Canon should be said in full, not abbreviated.

Communion Rite (3–4 minutes): Lord's Prayer, Fraction, Agnus Dei, "Holy Things for the Holy," Prayer of Humble Access, distribution. In Minecraft, Communion may be signified by approaching the altar and typing "Amen."

Thanksgiving and Dismissal (2–3 minutes): Post-Communion prayer, Individual Blessing (may be given as a general form if many are present), General Blessing, Dismissal, Last Gospel (optional on weekdays).

Total: approximately 20–30 minutes, depending on readings, homily, and number of communicants.

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Laus Deo et Beatae Mariae Virgini et omnibus Sanctis

Finis

PART II

THE MANNER OF PARTICIPATION

Being Instructions for the Faithful

How the Faithful Should Comport Themselves in Church

Upon entering the church, the faithful shall make the sign of the Cross with holy water from the stoup near the door, bow toward the altar, and proceed quietly to their place. They shall kneel in silent prayer before the Mass beginneth, preparing their hearts for the sacred mysteries. During the Mass, they shall stand, sit, or kneel according to the ancient custom: standing for the Gospel and the prayers, sitting for the readings and homily, and kneeling for the Confession, the Canon, and the reception of Holy Communion.

The faithful shall respond clearly and reverently to the priest, joining their voices as one body. They shall not speak amongst themselves during the sacred rites, but maintain a spirit of recollection and prayer. Children shall be taught to sit quietly and observe with reverence, that they may learn the ways of worship from their youth.

The Manner of Receiving Holy Communion

When the time of Communion cometh, those who are in a state of grace and have prepared themselves shall approach the altar rail and kneel. They shall not cross through the gate, which is reserved for the clergy, but shall kneel on the nave side of the rail. The server shall hold the Communion cloth beneath the chin of each communicant. The faithful shall receive the Host upon the tongue, saying 'Amen' after the priest speaketh the words of administration. Afterward, they shall receive the Chalice in like manner.

Those who are not disposed to receive Communion may approach the rail with their arms crossed upon their breast and receive a blessing from the priest. After receiving, the faithful shall return to their places and kneel in thanksgiving, making their prayers to Almighty God for the grace received.

The Preparation for Confession

The faithful should examine their consciences regularly and seek the Sacrament of Penance before receiving Holy Communion, especially if they be conscious of mortal sin. The priest heareth confessions at appointed times, and the penitent should come prepared to confess their sins with true contrition, receive absolution, and perform the penance assigned.

The Prayer Life of the Faithful

The Holy Sacrifice of the Mass is the summit and source of the Christian life, but the faithful are exhorted to nourish their souls with prayer beyond the Liturgy also. Daily prayer in the morning and at evening is commended to all Christians, giving thanks for the mercies of the day past and

committing the hours to come unto God's keeping. The Lord's Prayer, the Hail Mary, and the Creed should be known by heart and said frequently. The reading of Holy Scripture in the vulgar tongue, especially the Psalms, the Gospels, and the Epistles of Saint Paul, is a most profitable exercise for the instruction and consolation of the soul.

Where monastic communities or communities of canons do exist, the Daily Office of the Church—being Matins, Lauds, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers, and Compline—is to be faithfully kept, according to the ancient custom of the Insular monasteries. Where the faithful live near to such communities, they are encouraged to attend Vespers and Compline when they are able, that they may join their prayers to those of the religious and share in the praise of God which is offered throughout the day. Lay persons who desire a more ordered prayer life may profitably adopt a simplified form of the Office, saying at least the Psalms and prayers appointed for morning and evening.

Beyond vocal prayer and the reading of Scripture, the faithful are commended to the practice of silent prayer and contemplation, wherein the soul doth attend quietly to the presence of God, setting aside all earthly cares and resting in His love. This is the prayer of the heart, which the Insular Fathers and the ancient monks of these Realms did practice with great devotion, and which is open to all the baptized, not only to those in religious life. Let each Christian seek, according to his state and calling, to grow in the knowledge and love of God through faithful and persevering prayer.

PART III

THE BUILDING OF CHURCHES

Being Instructions for Bishops and Master Builders

General Principles of Church Building

The church is the House of God and the gate of heaven, wherein the faithful gather to offer the Holy Sacrifice and receive the Sacraments. Therefore it must be built with care and reverence, using honest materials and sound construction, that it may stand for generations as a witness to the Faith. The church should be oriented toward the East, where possible, that the priest may face the rising sun, which symbolizeth Christ the Light of the World.

Moreover, the ordering of the church building doth reflect in visible form the invisible hierarchy of the heavenly realm. As light descendeth from God through the celestial orders unto the world of men, so doth light enter the church through the windows, illuminating the sacred space and signifying the divine illumination of the soul. The gradation of spaces—from the porch, through the nave, to the chancel, and thence to the sanctuary wherein the altar standeth—doth mirror the soul's ascent from the things of this world toward the contemplation of God. The nave, where the faithful gather, representeth the Church Militant upon earth; the chancel, raised above the nave, signifieth the nearer approach to the divine mysteries; and the sanctuary, set apart and elevated, is as it were the threshold of heaven, where the Holy Sacrifice is offered and Christ is truly present upon the altar. Let the builder therefore attend not only to the soundness of his construction but to the theological truth that the building doth express, that the stones themselves may preach the Faith to those who enter.

Following the Council of Innisfallen, we ordain that there shall be one altar only in each church, simply adorned, without reliquaries or superstitious images. The church should be of sufficient size to accommodate the faithful of the parish, but not so large as to appear empty or to burden the people with excessive cost. Simplicity and dignity are to be preferred over ostentation.

The Form and Plan of Churches

Churches in these Realms are commonly built in one of three forms: the simple nave church, consisting of a single rectangular space with chancel; the cruciform church, having transepts extending north and south to form the shape of the Cross; and the basilica, with a central nave and side aisles separated by arcades. Each form hath its merits and should be chosen according to the needs of the congregation and the resources available.

The Simple Nave Church

The simple nave church is most suitable for smaller parishes and rural communities. It consisteth of a rectangular nave for the people and a smaller chancel for the altar and sanctuary, separated by an arch or screen. The west end may have a tower, either square or with an octagonal spire. This form is economical to build and easy to maintain, whilst providing a dignified space for worship.

The Cruciform Church

The cruciform church, shaped as the Cross of our Lord, is fitting for larger parishes and cathedral churches. The nave extendeth from west to east, with transepts crossing at the chancel to form the arms of the Cross. Often a tower is built over the crossing, supported by four great arches. This form alloweth for additional space and maketh manifest the Cross upon which our salvation was won.

Fig. 1 — Interior of a great church, showing nave arcade, pointed arches, and vaulted ceiling. Note the crossing tower visible at the east end and the elevated sanctuary with its ornate reredos.

The Basilica with Aisles

The basilica form, inherited from ancient Roman practice, hath a central nave of greater height flanked by lower side aisles, separated by rows of columns or piers forming arcades. This alloweth light to enter through clerestory windows above the arcades. The basilica is suitable for great churches and cathedrals where large congregations must be accommodated.

Exterior Architecture

Towers and Spires

The tower of a church serveth both practical and symbolic purposes: it houseth the bells that call the faithful to prayer and mark the hours; it serveth as a beacon visible from afar; and it directeth the eye

and heart toward heaven. Towers are commonly built at the west end of the church, though they may also be placed over the crossing in cruciform churches.

Square towers in the Norman fashion remain common, built of stone with thick walls and small windows. These may be crowned with battlements or surmounted by a pyramidal roof. In the Gothic manner, towers often rise to great height and are topped with elegant octagonal spires of stone or timber covered with lead. The spire draws the eye heavenward and symbolizeth prayer ascending to God.

Fig. 2 — Exterior of a cathedral with twin western towers and elaborate Gothic façade. The central entrance is flanked by sculptural work, and a great window illuminates the nave.

Fig. 3 — A great cathedral facade showing perpendicular Gothic style with twin towers and central portal. The symmetry and height speak to the majesty of God.

West Fronts and Portals

The west front of the church is its principal face, wherein the main entrance is placed. This portal should be dignified and welcoming, marking the threshold between the worldly realm and the sacred space within. In great churches, the west front may be elaborately decorated with carved stonework depicting scriptural scenes and the saints, though in keeping with the ordinances of the Council, such decoration should be edifying and not superstitious.

The doorway itself should be recessed within multiple orders of arches, creating depth and shadow. Above the door, a tympanum may display carved scenes of the Last Judgment or other scriptural subjects. A great window often surmounts the portal, filling the nave with light.

Wall Construction and Buttresses

Church walls must be of solid construction to bear the weight of roof and tower. Stone is the preferred material, being durable and fireproof, though timber-framed churches with rubble infill are

acceptable in regions where good building stone is scarce. The walls should be of sufficient thickness—typically three to four feet for the nave and five to six feet for tower walls.

To support tall walls and vaulted roofs, buttresses are necessary. These projecting masses of masonry transfer the lateral thrust of the vault to the ground. In the Gothic manner, flying buttresses may be used: these are arched supports that span from the nave wall to exterior buttress piers, allowing the walls themselves to be thinner and pierced with larger windows. The principle is sound, though the construction requireth skilled masons.

Roofing

The roof must be strongly built to withstand wind and weather. Stone churches in these Realms are commonly roofed with lead sheet over timber framing, the lead being durable though costly. Where lead cannot be obtained, slate, tile, or wooden shingles may be used. The roof should be steeply pitched to shed rain and snow. The ridge line should run from west to east, and the roof should extend beyond the walls to protect them from water.

Interior Architecture and Spatial Organization

The Nave

The nave is the body of the church where the faithful assemble. It should be of sufficient length and width to accommodate the congregation comfortably, with space for processions along the central aisle. The floor may be paved with stone flags or tiles in simple patterns. Wooden pews or benches are provided for the people, arranged in rows facing east toward the altar.

The walls of the nave should rise to a good height, creating a sense of elevation that directeth the mind toward heavenly things. In basilica churches, arcades of arches separate the nave from the aisles, supported on columns or piers. Above the arcades, clerestory windows admit light to the central space.

Fig. 4 — View toward the organ gallery showing the lofty nave vault. The arrangement demonstrates how clerestory windows above the arcade illuminate the central space.

The Chancel and Sanctuary

The chancel is the eastern portion of the church, set apart for the celebration of the Divine Liturgy. It should be raised above the level of the nave by two or three steps, signifying the elevation of the sacred mysteries. The sanctuary, wherein stands the altar, occupieth the eastern end of the chancel and should be clearly demarcated from the nave by an altar rail or screen.

Following the ordinances of the Council of Innisfallen, there shall be one altar only in each church. The altar should be of stone, simply adorned, and positioned beneath the eastern arch or against the east wall. It should be of such dimensions as to accommodate the sacred vessels, being typically about seven feet in length, three feet in depth, and three and one-half feet in height. Upon the altar shall rest only the Missal, two candles in their stands, and the sacred vessels during the celebration of Mass.

Fig. 6 — Another view of a sanctuary arrangement with carved wooden rail and gate. The red carpet marks the sacred space, and stained glass provides colored light.

The Altar Rail and Gate

The altar rail marketh the boundary between the nave and the sanctuary. It should be of sturdy construction, typically of carved wood or wrought iron, and should extend across the chancel arch from north to south. A gate is placed at the center of the rail for the passage of the clergy and their ministers; this gate shall not be crossed by the laity.

The faithful kneel at the rail on the nave side to receive Holy Communion, and cushions or kneelers should be provided for this purpose. The rail should be of such height—typically about three feet—as to provide support for those kneeling whilst not obstructing the view of the altar. The design of the rail may incorporate turned balusters, carved panels, or decorative ironwork, so long as it remaineth modest and fitting for its sacred purpose.

The Reredos

Behind the altar, the east wall may be adorned with a reredos—a screen of carved wood or stone that provideth a dignified backdrop for the celebration of Mass. The reredos may depict scriptural scenes such as the Crucifixion, the Last Supper, or Christ in Majesty, or it may display the symbols of the Four Evangelists and the Twelve Apostles. Such decoration should be edifying and theologically sound, avoiding superstitious imagery or representations that might lead the simple-minded into error.

In simpler churches, the east wall may be left plain or painted with sacred texts such as the Lord's Prayer, the Creed, or the Commandments. A crucifix should be placed above or behind the altar, that all may contemplate the sacrifice of our Lord during the celebration of Mass.

Architectural Elements and Details

Windows and Glazing

Windows serve to admit light into the church whilst protecting against wind and weather. In the Romanesque manner, windows are relatively small and round-headed, deeply splayed through the thick walls. In the Gothic manner, windows are larger and pointed at the top, with stone tracery dividing the opening into multiple lights. The tracery patterns evolved over the centuries: simple lancets in the earliest Gothic work; geometric patterns of circles and trefoils in the Decorated style; and vertical mullions rising to flattened arches in the Perpendicular fashion favored in England.

Windows should be glazed with colored glass where resources permit, as colored light filleth the church with beauty and instructeth the faithful through images of sacred history. However, the Council cautioneth against excessive decoration, and clear or lightly tinted glass is acceptable in parish churches. The glass should be set in lead cames and secured with iron bars across the window opening.

Arches

The arch is fundamental to church construction, being used for doorways, windows, arcades, and vaulting. Romanesque arches are semicircular, following Roman precedent. Gothic arches are pointed, which alloweth greater height and directeth thrust more efficiently to the supporting piers. The pointed arch also hath theological significance, drawing the eye and mind upward toward God.

Arches may be plain or decorated with carved moldings. The chancel arch, separating nave from sanctuary, should be of particular dignity and may be adorned with scriptural verses or symbols of the Passion. In later work, the four-centered or Tudor arch became common, having a flattened profile whilst retaining structural efficiency.

Vaulting

The ceiling of a church may be of timber or stone. Timber ceilings are less costly and may be left open to show the roof structure, or may be covered with boards and painted. Stone vaulting is more durable and fireproof, though it requireth strong walls and skilled masons to construct.

Several forms of vaulting are used in these Realms. The barrel vault is a continuous semicircular arch spanning the width of the space, used in Romanesque work. The groin vault resulteth from the intersection of two barrel vaults at right angles, creating a bay. The rib vault hath stone ribs that define the edges of the vault surface, with the spaces between filled with lighter masonry. In the finest work, fan vaulting displayeth elaborate patterns of ribs radiating from each pier like the spokes of a fan—this is much admired for its beauty though costly to construct.

Columns and Piers

In arcaded churches, the nave is separated from the aisles by rows of vertical supports. These may be cylindrical columns in the classical manner, or compound piers consisting of a central core with attached shafts. The capitals atop columns and piers provide a transition between vertical support and horizontal arch, and may be carved with foliage, geometric patterns, or scriptural scenes.

The proportions of columns are important: they should be of sufficient diameter to appear stable, yet not so thick as to obstruct sightlines. As a general rule, the height of a column should be about eight times its diameter. The spacing between columns should be regular and proportionate to their height.

Regional Styles and Variations

The English Perpendicular Style

In England, the Perpendicular Gothic style hath flourished since the fourteenth century and remaineth in favor. This manner is characterized by vertical emphasis in window tracery, with straight mullions rising to flattened four-centered arches; large windows filling entire walls; fan vaulting of great intricacy; and square-headed doors and windows. Great towers with angle buttresses and battlemented parapets are typical. This style produceth churches of remarkable light and spaciousness, well-suited to the English temperament.

The Norman and Romanesque Heritage

Many older churches in these Realms retain Norman work from the eleventh and twelfth centuries. This manner is characterized by round arches, thick walls, small windows, and massive appearance. Doorways and chancel arches often display elaborate carved ornament in successive orders of moldings. Norman work is solid and enduring, and where such fabric surviveth, it should be respected and maintained. New construction in the Norman manner is acceptable for towers and fortified churches.

Fig. 7 — A Romanesque church exterior showing round apse, thick walls, and small round-headed windows. Note the solid, fortress-like construction typical of Norman work.

Fig. 8 — A Romanesque church with multiple towers of varying heights and round-arched windows. The simple geometric forms and fortress-like appearance are characteristic of the style.

French and Continental Influences

Churches in the French manner display the High Gothic style with pointed arches of great height, elaborate window tracery in the Rayonnant fashion, and extensive use of flying buttresses. Great rose windows in the transept ends and west façade are characteristic. Such churches aspire to maximum height and lightness, with walls reduced to skeletal frameworks supporting vast expanses of glass. This manner is magnificent but demanding of resources and skill.

Fig. 9 — A French Gothic cathedral façade with characteristic features: twin towers, three portals, rose window, and sculptural decoration. Note the vertical emphasis and elaborate stonework.

Irish and Scottish Traditions

In Ireland and Scotland, churches often display a plainer aesthetic reflecting the austere monastic traditions of these lands. Round towers, inherited from ancient times, stand separate from the church proper and serve as bell towers and refuges. Stone crosses, elaborately carved with interlace and scriptural scenes, mark sacred precincts. Church buildings may be simpler in plan and decoration than English churches, befitting the poverty of the land and the spirituality of the Celtic tradition.

The Low Countries

Churches in Flanders and the Netherlands display brick construction where stone is scarce, with stepped gables and tall towers. The interiors may be more spacious and hall-like, reflecting the commercial prosperity and civic pride of these regions. Whitewashed walls and clear glass create bright interiors suitable for preaching.

Building Materials in Minecraft Construction

Stone Types

When constructing churches in the Minecraft realm, the following materials should be used to represent the various stone types found in actual medieval construction:

Stone Brick and variants represent cut ashlar masonry suitable for walls, piers, and formal elements. Cobblestone representeth rougher rubble work used for foundations and less visible portions. Andesite and Diorite may be mixed to create varied texture in walls. Smooth stone slabs are useful for vaulting and floor paving. For lighter stone such as limestone or sandstone, use Sandstone or Smooth Sandstone blocks.

Timber Work

Oak planks, logs, and fences represent timber framing, roof structures, and furnishings. Spruce or Dark Oak may be used for contrast in paneling and screens. Wooden stairs and slabs are essential for creating pitched roofs and stepped details. Fences serve well for altar rails and screens.

Windows and Glass

Stained Glass panes in various colors represent the colored glazing of medieval windows. Glass blocks may be used sparingly for special effects. Iron bars placed across window openings represent the reinforcing bars of actual windows. The arrangement of glass and bars should follow the tracery patterns described above.

Roofing and Floors

Stone brick stairs and slabs arranged in overlapping patterns create the appearance of stone or slate roofing. Stone brick slabs represent stone paving for floors. Polished Andesite or Diorite may be used for decorative floor patterns in the sanctuary. Carpets in red or blue may mark processional routes and the sanctuary space.

Scale and Proportions for Minecraft

In translating real architecture to Minecraft, one must account for the limitations of block-based construction whilst maintaining proper proportions. As a general principle, one Minecraft block represents approximately one foot (or 30 centimeters) of actual dimension. However, vertical dimensions may be compressed slightly to maintain pleasing proportions given the player's limited field of view.

Recommended Dimensions

For a small parish church: Nave width 15-20 blocks, nave length 40-50 blocks, nave height to roof peak 18-25 blocks. Chancel width 12-15 blocks, chancel length 20-25 blocks. Tower width 8-10 blocks, tower height 40-60 blocks.

For a large church or small cathedral: Nave width 25-30 blocks, nave length 60-80 blocks, nave height 30-40 blocks. Transept width 20-25 blocks. Chancel width 20-25 blocks, chancel length 30-40 blocks. Central tower over crossing 50-80 blocks in height. Aisle width 10-12 blocks if present.

For a great cathedral: Nave width 35-45 blocks, nave length 100-150 blocks, nave height 45-60 blocks. All other dimensions proportionally larger. Twin western towers 80-120 blocks in height.

Proportional Guidelines

The length of the nave should be approximately 2.5 to 3 times its width. The height to the roof peak should be approximately equal to the width for a pleasing proportion. Towers should be at least 4 times as tall as they are wide to appear properly vertical. The chancel should be about half the length of the nave and slightly narrower. Aisles, if present, should be about one-third the width of the nave.

Conclusion

The building of a church is a sacred duty and a work of devotion. Whether constructing in stone upon the earth or in blocks within the Minecraft realm, the builder should labor with reverence, skill, and attention to proper form. The church thus built shall serve for generations as a house of prayer, a place of sacrament, and a visible sign of the Faith of our fathers.

Let bishops and master builders ensure that churches are constructed according to these principles: oriented toward the East, built with honest materials, proportioned with dignity, and adorned with moderation. Let there be one altar only, simply appointed. Let the sanctuary be clearly distinguished from the nave by rail and elevation. Let towers rise to call the faithful and direct hearts to heaven. Let windows admit light both natural and colored. Let all be done to the glory of God and the edification of His people.

Above all, let it be remembered that the church building, however beautiful, is but a vessel for the sacred mysteries celebrated within. The true Church is the Body of Christ, the faithful who gather to offer the Holy Sacrifice and receive the Sacraments. The building exists to serve this purpose and should never become an object of superstitious veneration in itself. Simplicity, dignity, and fidelity to apostolic tradition should guide all our endeavors.

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Laus Deo et Beatae Mariae Virgini et omnibus Sanctis

Finis

PART IV: The Confession of Faith

THE INSULAR CONFESSION OF FAITH

Being the Articles of Religion of the

INSULAR CHURCH

Revised and Corrected Second Edition

In the Year of Our Lord MDXXXVIII

Cathedral Church of Armagh

Laus Deo et Beatæ Mariæ Virgini et omnibus Sanctis

Editor's Preface to the Second Edition

I. On Formatting

The first edition of these Articles was distributed without a Table of Contents, and the heading hierarchy employed a single undifferentiated level for both Part headings and individual Article headings. In this revised edition, the Articles are set out with a clear three-tier structure: the document title at the first level, Part headings (*Preface, Articles of Religion, Conclusion*) at the second level, and individual Article titles at the third. This structure permits the generation of a proper Table of Contents from any word-processing software capable of reading heading styles. Editors preparing further copies are directed to regenerate the Table of Contents from the revised heading anchors before distribution.

II. On the Five Theological Revisions

Five articles in the first edition contained positions that stand in material tension with the received and defined teaching of the Western Church prior to the Council of Trent. These are not matters of legitimate scholastic debate — such as the schools' disagreement over the precise account of predestination, the philosophical analysis of Eucharistic change, the precise nature of concupiscence as *poena* or *culpa*, or the disciplinary question of clerical celibacy — but genuine departures from the common heritage of the Catholic Church. The five affected articles are marked ⚑ REVISED throughout this document. A summary of each revision follows.

Article VI (Scripture and Tradition): The first edition contained a formulation materially equivalent to the Protestant principle of sola scriptura, requiring that nothing "not proved from Scripture" may be imposed on the faithful as an article of faith. While Holy Scripture is materially sufficient — containing all things necessary to salvation — the Church cannot function as a living interpreter without Sacred Tradition and the Magisterium. The blessed Augustine explicitly argued that the Church's authority, not Scripture alone, settles disputed questions: "I would not believe the Gospel itself, if the authority of the Catholic Church did not move me" (Contra Epistulam Manichaei 5.6). His decisive argument against the Donatists — that rebaptism of those who had lapsed under persecution was invalid, based on Tradition rather than any explicit Scriptural text — demonstrates precisely this point. Article VI has been rewritten to affirm both Scripture and unwritten Apostolic Tradition as co-sources of revelation, whilst retaining the material sufficiency of Scripture.

Article XIX (Of the Church — Rome): The first edition stated plainly that "the Church of Rome hath erred... in matters of Faith." This is not the position of the Insular Church. The Roman See, as the see of blessed Peter, has never formally defected from the Catholic Faith, nor do we hold that it ever shall. The present difficulty is not doctrinal error in Rome itself, but rather a crisis of valid holy orders: the current occupants of the Roman See and the Maltese claimant alike were appointed without valid apostolic succession, their ordinations being null and void from the beginning. This is a crisis of governance and sacramental validity, not of dogma. Article XIX has been rewritten to reflect this, declaring that the Insular Church carries the Western Catholic tradition in trust during this vacancy, whilst expressing our earnest hope for reunion with a restored Roman See.

Article XXI (General Councils): The first edition recognised only the Seven Eastern Ecumenical Councils as carrying binding authority, whilst dismissing all other councils as merely fallible assemblies. This creates an internal incoherence: the document itself relies upon the dogmatic definitions of the Fourth Lateran Council (1215), which formally employed the term transsubstantiatis in defining the Eucharist, and upon other Western councils. Furthermore, the user wishes specifically to acknowledge the Council of Constance (1414–1418) and its decree Haec Sancta, which declared that a general council in a time of crisis holds its authority directly from God and may act to heal schism even in the absence of clear papal direction. We do not hold councils to be above popes in general governance; but in an emergency such as the present vacancy of the Roman See, a properly convened council is the proper instrument of reform. Article XXI has been rewritten to specify a two-tier hierarchy of councils, with the binding Western councils listed explicitly.

Article XXII (Purgatory and Indulgences): The first edition dismissed "the late Roman doctrine concerning Purgatory" as including the doctrine of Indulgences, treating the whole as "a fond thing, vainly invented." This is too sweeping. The doctrine of Indulgences — the Church's power to remit temporal punishment due to forgiven sins, drawing upon the inexhaustible Treasury of the merits of Christ and the Saints — is ancient, legitimate, and consonant with Scripture and Tradition. What must be condemned is the gross commercialisation of this power: the sale of indulgences for coin, the fabrication of mechanical tables of years and days, and the exploitation of simple souls by unscrupulous friars. Article XXII has been rewritten to distinguish clearly the legitimate doctrine from its corrupt application.

Article XXX (Both Kinds): The first edition declared that communion in both kinds "by Christ's ordinance and commandment ought to be ministered to all Christian men alike," effectively condemning the ancient practice of communion under one kind as contrary to divine law. This directly contradicts the solemn definition of the Council of Constance (Session 13, 1415), which decreed that communion under one kind is a full and complete sacramental participation, and condemned the Hussite demand for communion sub utraque specie as the only valid form. Since the Insular Church does not reject the Council of Constance, Article XXX has been rewritten: the Insular Church restores the ancient and apostolic practice of communion in both kinds, and this is commended as praiseworthy and traditional, but the article explicitly does not condemn communion under one kind as invalid or contrary to divine law.

III. On Matters of Lawful Debate

Several other articles touch on questions disputed among orthodox Catholic theologians, and have been annotated accordingly to clarify the range of permissible and impermissible positions. These include: the nature of concupiscence (Art. IX & XXVII); predestination and election (Art. XVII); the precise philosophical account of the Eucharistic change (Art. XXVIII); and the discipline of clerical celibacy (Art. XXXII). On these matters, no single scholastic school is binding upon the faithful, and the annotations are designed to clarify the outer limits of orthodoxy rather than to impose any one school's opinion.

Preface to the Christian Reader

WE, COMHARBA PÁTRAIC, Primate of Ireland, Archbishop and Abbot of Armagh by the grace of God, together with Níldríf, Abbot of Innisfallen, being both ordained by His All-Holiness the Patriarch Athanagoras I of Constantinople, and being mindful of our duty to preserve the ancient Faith delivered unto the Saints, and to guard the flock of Christ from all manner of innovation and corruption, do set forth these Articles of Religion for the instruction and edification of the faithful throughout these Insular Realms.

Whereas it hath pleased Almighty God to call us to shepherd His Church in these latter days of great confusion; and whereas the See of blessed Peter, which ought to be the centre and pillar of Catholic unity, is at this time afflicted by a grave crisis of sacramental validity — those who have presumed to occupy the Roman chair lacking, through no defect in the ancient succession but through the novel and unlawful intrusion of worldly princes, any valid holy orders whatsoever, being no priests, no bishops, and therefore no popes at all — the Western Church finds herself, for the first time since the Donatist crisis, in need of those who hold the apostolic succession in trust; and whereas many innovators have arisen, who under the pretense of reforming abuses do abandon the ancient mysteries of grace and reduce the Holy Sacraments to bare memorial signs: we have thought it necessary to declare plainly what is the Faith of the Insular Church.

We affirm, without any reservation or hesitation, that the Roman See has never formally defected from the Catholic Faith, nor shall it ever do so, for our Lord promised that the gates of hell shall not prevail against His Church (Matt. 16:18). The present difficulty is not that Rome has erred in doctrine, but that she has been, for the moment, left without lawful occupants. As the blessed Cyprian of Carthage wrote, *"the Church is in the bishop"* (*Ep.* 66.8): where there is no bishop, there the sacramental life of a particular church is suspended, not destroyed. We carry the Western Catholic heritage in trust, in communion with our brothers of the East, and we await with earnest prayer and hope that day when the Roman See shall be restored to a lawfully ordained successor of Peter, and the full Pentarchy of the ancient Church shall be reconstituted.

We hold fast to the doctrine of the Holy Fathers, especially the most blessed Augustine, Bishop of Hippo, whose teaching on grace, on the nature of concupiscence, and on the Sacraments, we do follow as most consonant with Holy Scripture and the Councils of Nicæa, Constantinople, Ephesus, Chalcedon, and the Western Councils down to Constance. We maintain communion with our brother, His All-Holiness the Patriarch of Constantinople, thereby preserving that Golden Chain of apostolic succession which hath never been severed, and we honor the theological patrimony which East and West hold in common from the age of the undivided Church. In matters of papal primacy, we follow the understanding of the great Pope Leo I, Doctor of the Church: that the successor of Peter holds a primacy of pastoral solicitude and doctrinal guardianship, serving the unity of the whole Church — a ministry of service, not of domination.

Given under our hands and seals, in the Cathedral Church of Armagh,
this day in the Year of Our Lord 1538.

✠ Comharba Pátraic, Primate of Ireland, Archbishop & Abbot of Armagh

✠ Níldríf, Abbot of Innisfallen

With the Royal Assent of:

✠ Robert I, King of Desmond

✠ Pal, King of England

Articles of Religion

Article I. *Of Faith in the Holy Trinity*

THERE is but one living and true God, everlasting, without body, parts, or passions; of infinite power, wisdom, and goodness; the Maker and Preserver of all things both visible and invisible. And in unity of this Godhead there be three Persons, of one substance, power, and eternity: the Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost. This is the Catholic Faith received from the Apostles and declared in the holy Council of Nicæa (325), which except a man believe faithfully and firmly, he cannot be saved. As it is written: *"Hear, O Israel: the Lord our God is one Lord"* (Deut. 6:4); and again: *"Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptising them in the Name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost"* (Matt. 28:19).

> *"The Catholic Faith is this: that we worship one God in Trinity, and Trinity in Unity; neither confounding the Persons, nor dividing the Substance." — Athanasian Creed, received by East and West*

Article II. *Of the Word or Son of God, which was made very Man*

THE Son, which is the Word of the Father, begotten from everlasting of the Father, the very and eternal God, and of one substance with the Father, took Man's nature in the womb of the blessed Virgin Mary, of her substance: so that two whole and perfect Natures, that is to say, the Godhead and Manhood, were joined together in one Person, never to be divided, whereof is one Christ, very God and very Man; who truly suffered, was crucified, dead, and buried. This mystery of the Incarnation was defined by the holy Council of Chalcedon (451), and we receive it with all reverence. As Saint John writeth: *"The Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us"* (John 1:14).

CHRIST did willingly choose to assume the penalty for man's sin, and did experience that death which is borne of sin, out of His infinite love for mankind. Being Himself without sin, He took upon Himself the burden of our transgressions, that He might reconcile the Father unto us, and be a propitiation not only for the guilt inherited from Adam (*reatus originalis*), but also for all the actual sins which men do commit. This voluntary assumption of our punishment proceedeth from the love of the Son for the Father and for us, making of His sacred humanity an oblation of infinite worth.

> *"The same one and only Son of God, our Lord Jesus Christ, is perfect in divinity and perfect in humanity, truly God and truly man... recognised in two natures, without confusion, without change, without division, without separation." — Council of Chalcedon, Definition (451)*

Article III. *Of the Descent into Hell*

AS Christ died for us, and was buried, so also is it to be believed that He went down into Hell — not to the place of the damned, but to that region which the Fathers call the *Limbus Patrum*, where the souls of the righteous who had died before His coming did await redemption. There He did proclaim His victory over death and did lead captivity captive, bringing forth with Him into Paradise those who had hoped for His coming, as

Saint Peter writeth: *"He went and preached to the spirits in prison"* (1 Pet. 3:19); and as the Apostle saith: *"When He ascended on high, He led a host of captives"* (Eph. 4:8).

Article IV. *Of the Resurrection of Christ*

CHRIST did truly rise again from death on the third day, and took again His body, with flesh, bones, and all things appertaining to the perfection of Man's nature; wherewith He ascended into Heaven, and there sitteth at the right hand of the Father, making perpetual intercession for us, until He return to judge all men at the last day. His Resurrection is the pledge of our own resurrection, and the first-fruits of them that sleep (1 Cor. 15:20).

Article V. *Of the Holy Ghost*

THE Holy Ghost, proceeding from the Father *through* the Son — the *Filioque* as Saint Maximus the Confessor, Doctor of the Church for his right articulation thereof, and the Florentine Fathers did understand it — is of one substance, majesty, and glory with the Father and the Son, very and eternal God. It is He who sanctifieth the Church, distributeth His gifts according to His sovereign will, and worketh in the hearts of the faithful that transformative grace whereby they are renewed in the image of God.

> *"When the Latins say that the Holy Spirit proceeds from the Father and the Son, they do not mean two causes or two principles... but one cause and one principle." The Spirit proceeds from the Father as from His first principle, and from the Son as from the one who has received all from the Father. — Saint Maximus the Confessor, Letter to Marinus*

⚑ REVISED Article VI. *Of the Sufficiency of Holy Scripture and the Authority of Sacred Tradition*

> ✦ **EDITORIAL CORRECTION —** *The first edition declared that nothing 'not read in Scripture nor proved thereby' could be required as an article of faith. This is the Protestant principle of sola scriptura, and is incompatible with Catholic doctrine. It has been rewritten below. The material sufficiency of Scripture is affirmed; its formal sufficiency without Tradition and Magisterium is denied.*

HOLY Scripture is materially sufficient for salvation: it containeth, whether explicitly or by just inference, all truths necessary to eternal life, so that no saving doctrine is entirely absent from its pages. In the name of the Holy Scripture we do understand those canonical Books of the Old and New Testament received by the holy Fathers and confirmed in the ancient Councils, together with those deuterocanonical Books which the Church hath received as part of the sacred deposit, following the usage of Saint Augustine and the Councils of Hippo (393) and Carthage (397).

Nevertheless, Holy Scripture is not formally sufficient as the sole rule of faith in isolation from the living Church. The same Spirit who inspired the sacred writers doth also guide the Church in her interpretation of those writings. Without the Magisterium and the living Tradition of the Apostles — transmitted through the succession of bishops and the consensus of the holy Fathers — the Scripture is as a lamp without a hand to hold it: its light is real, but it cannot of itself determine which reading is orthodox and which is not. The bitter fruit of this truth is seen wherever men have attempted to read Scripture apart from the Church: the Donatists, the Novatians, the Cathars, and the present innovators all claim Scripture alone as their warrant, yet each contradicts the others.

> *"I would not believe the Gospel itself, if the authority of the Catholic Church did not move me." — Saint Augustine of Hippo, Contra Epistulam Manichaei, 5.6*

The power of the Church to bind the conscience of the faithful in matters not explicitly resolved by the letter of Scripture is demonstrated most plainly in the controversy of rebaptism. When the Donatists, relying upon their own reading of Scripture, insisted upon rebaptising those who had lapsed under persecution, Saint Augustine did not merely cite a contrary text; he appealed to the authority of the Church herself, whose tradition, received from the Apostles and confirmed by general councils, declared such rebaptism null. *"It is the weight of authority"*, he argued, *"and not the argument of Scripture alone, that resolves this controversy"* (*De Baptismo contra Donatistas*, 2.3.4). Tradition, authorised by the Church, is therefore a co-source of divine revelation alongside Scripture.

Wherefore the Church is the pillar and ground of the truth (1 Tim. 3:15), and the ordinary teacher and interpreter of the Scriptures unto the faithful. She may not ordain anything contrary to the plain sense of God's written Word; but she hath authority to declare and define those truths which, though materially present in Scripture, require the living voice of Tradition to be rightly understood. And the faithful are bound in conscience to receive her definitions, not as innovations, but as the unfolding of the deposit once delivered to the Saints (Jude 1:3).

Article VII. *Of the Old Testament*

THE Old Testament is not contrary to the New: for both in the Old and New Testament everlasting life is offered to Mankind by Christ, who is the only Mediator between God and Man, being both God and Man (1 Tim. 2:5). Wherefore they are not to be heard who feign that the old Fathers did look only for transitory promises. Although the Law given from God by Moses, as touching Ceremonies and Rites, doth not bind Christian men, nor the Civil precepts thereof ought of necessity to be received in any commonwealth; yet notwithstanding, no Christian man whatsoever is free from the obedience of the Commandments which are called Moral.

Article VIII. *Of the Creeds*

THE Three Creeds — the Nicene Creed, the Creed of Saint Athanasius, and that which is commonly called the Apostles' Creed — ought thoroughly to be received and believed: for they may be proved by most certain warrants of Holy Scripture, and do faithfully set forth the Catholic Faith as it hath been believed everywhere, always, and by all (*quod ubique, quod semper, quod ab omnibus*), according to the rule of Saint Vincent of Lérins (*Commonitorium*, 2.3).

Article IX. *Of Original or Birth-Sin*

ORIGINAL sin standeth not in the mere following or imitation of Adam (as the Pelagians do vainly talk), but it is the fault and corruption of the Nature of every man that naturally is engendered of the offspring of Adam; whereby man is very far gone from original righteousness, and is of his own nature inclined to evil, so that the flesh lusteth always contrary to the Spirit. As Saint Paul writeth: *"Sin came into the world through one man, and death through sin, and so death spread to all men"* (Rom. 5:12). This is the teaching of Saint Augustine in his writings against Pelagius, confirmed by the Council of Carthage (418) and received throughout the Catholic Church.

And this infection of nature doth remain, yea, in them that are regenerated; whereby the lust of the flesh (*concupiscentia*), which some do call the tinder of sin (*fomes peccati*), is not subject to the Law of God. And although

there is no condemnation for them that believe and are baptised, the guilt (*reatus*) being wholly remitted; yet the Apostle doth confess that concupiscence hath in itself the nature of sin (*naturam peccati*), inasmuch as it is a disordered movement contrary to right reason. Nevertheless, it is not imputed as personal sin to the regenerate so long as the will doth not consent thereunto.

> **Note on lawful debate:** *Whether concupiscence in the baptised has the nature of sin properly speaking (Augustine, Scotist tradition) or is only the penalty and remnant of sin with no formal sinfulness of its own (a stricter Thomist reading) is a matter of legitimate scholastic dispute. Both views have been held by orthodox Catholics. What is excluded is the Pelagian position that concupiscence is morally neutral or is no legacy of the Fall at all.*

Article X. *Of Free-Will*

THE condition of Man after the fall of Adam is such that he cannot turn and prepare himself, by his own natural strength and good works, to faith and calling upon God. Wherefore we have no power to do good works pleasant and acceptable to God, without the grace of God by Christ preventing us, that we may have a good will, and working with us, when we have that good will. This is the doctrine of Saint Augustine against the Pelagians, confirmed in the Second Council of Orange (529). As the Lord said: *"Apart from me ye can do nothing"* (John 15:5).

Grace doth not destroy free-will, but doth heal and elevate it, turning the soul from the love of earthly things to the love of God. By operative grace (*gratia operans*), God worketh in us without us, moving our wills from death to life; by cooperative grace (*gratia cooperans*), God worketh with us when our wills have been renewed. Thus grace doth preserve human liberty whilst transforming it into the glorious liberty of the children of God.

Article XI. *Of the Justification of Man*

WE are truly made righteous before God by the merit of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, received through faith, and not for our own works or deservings. Wherefore that we are justified by faith is a most wholesome Doctrine, and very full of comfort; yet this faith is not a bare intellectual assent, but is faith working through love (*fides caritate formata*), as Saint Paul teacheth: *"Faith working through love"* (Gal. 5:6). Following the blessed Augustine, we hold that justification is not a mere imputation of an alien righteousness, but rather an effectual transformation whereby the soul is truly healed and made holy by the infusion of sanctifying grace. In this the Western Doctors agree: God doth not merely pronounce us righteous but doth truly make us so.

Article XII. *Of Good Works*

ALBEIT that Good Works, which are the fruits of Faith and follow after Justification, cannot of themselves put away our sins or endure the severity of God's strict judgment; yet are they pleasing and acceptable to God in Christ, and do spring out necessarily of a true and lively Faith, insomuch that by them a lively Faith may be as evidently known as a tree discerned by the fruit (Matt. 7:17). These works do not proceed from our own natural power, but from the grace of the Holy Ghost working within us, enabling us to will and to do according to His good pleasure (Phil. 2:13).

Article XIII. *Of Works before Justification*

WORKS done before the grace of Christ and the inspiration of His Spirit are not pleasant to God, forasmuch as they spring not of faith in Jesus Christ. Without faith it is impossible to please God (Heb. 11:6), and without grace we can do nothing that is truly meritorious of eternal life. Though such works may have a certain natural goodness, yet they do not make men meet to receive grace, nor do they deserve grace of congruity (as some School-authors have said). For that they are not done as God hath willed them to be done — namely, from faith, hope, and charity, with the assistance of grace — we doubt not but they have in them the nature of sin.

Article XIV. *Of Works of Supererogation*

THE claim that any man can render unto God more than he oweth is arrogant and impious: for we are God's creatures, and all that we have and are is His, so that when we have done all that is commanded unto us, we must say with Christ: *"We are unprofitable servants"* (Luke 17:10). No man can boast that he hath exceeded his duty to God, for God's claim upon us is infinite and our obedience ever imperfect. Nevertheless, the distinction between God's commandments and the evangelical counsels of perfection is ancient and sound. Voluntary poverty, chastity, and obedience, freely embraced by those whom God calleth thereto, are not additions to the commandments but means of more perfectly fulfilling them. Such counsels are commended to those who are called, but are not required of all the faithful.

Article XV. *Of Christ alone without Sin*

CHRIST in the truth of our nature was made like unto us in all things, sin only except, from which He was clearly void, both in His flesh and in His spirit. He came to be the Lamb without spot, who, by the sacrifice of Himself once made, should take away the sins of the world; and sin (as Saint John saith) was not in Him (1 John 3:5). But all we the rest, although baptised and born again in Christ, yet offend in many things; and if we say we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us (1 John 1:8).

Article XVI. *Of Sin after Baptism*

NOT every deadly sin willingly committed after Baptism is sin against the Holy Ghost and unpardonable. Wherefore the grant of repentance is not to be denied to such as fall into sin after Baptism. After we have received the Holy Ghost, we may depart from grace given, and fall into sin; and by the grace of God we may arise again through true penance, and amend our lives. And therefore they are to be condemned who say they can no more sin as long as they live here, or who deny the place of forgiveness to such as truly repent and confess their sins.

Article XVII. *Of Predestination and Election*

PREDESTINATION to Life is the everlasting purpose of God, whereby (before the foundations of the world were laid) He hath constantly decreed by His counsel secret to us, to deliver from curse and damnation those whom He hath chosen in Christ out of mankind, and to bring them by Christ to everlasting salvation, as vessels made to honor (Rom. 9:21–23). This is the teaching of Saint Augustine in his later writings, especially against the Pelagians and the semi-Pelagians, and was confirmed by the Council of Orange (529).

Wherefore, they which be endued with so excellent a benefit of God be called according to God's purpose by His Spirit working in due season: they through Grace obey the calling: they be justified freely: they be made

sons of God by adoption: they be made like the image of His only-begotten Son Jesus Christ: they walk religiously in good works, and at length, by God's mercy, they attain to everlasting felicity. As the godly consideration of Predestination and our Election in Christ is full of sweet, pleasant, and unspeakable comfort to godly persons who feel in themselves the working of the Spirit of Christ, so for curious and carnal persons to have continually before their eyes the sentence of God's Predestination is a most dangerous downfall.

> **Note on lawful debate:** *The precise mode of predestination — whether God wills positively the reprobation of the non-elect (double predestination, Augustine's stronger expressions), or foreknows their damnation without willing it as an end (single predestination, Thomas Aquinas), or reconciles foreknowledge with condign merit in some other way (Scotist and later Molinist approaches) — is a matter of lawful debate among Catholic theologians. What is excluded is any Pelagian or semi-Pelagian position that makes salvation ultimately dependent upon the unaided will of man, or that denies the absolute priority of grace.*

Article XVIII. *Of obtaining Eternal Salvation only by the Name of Christ*

THEY also are to be had accursed that presume to say that every man shall be saved by the Law or Sect which he professeth, so that he be diligent to frame his life according to that Law and the light of Nature. For Holy Scripture doth set out unto us only the Name of Jesus Christ, whereby men must be saved: *"There is none other name under heaven given among men whereby we must be saved"* (Acts 4:12). Outside the Church there is no ordinary means of salvation, for the Church is the Body of Christ, and it is in His Body that men are ordinarily saved.

⚑ REVISED Article XIX. *Of the Church and the Present State of the Roman See*

> ✦ **EDITORIAL CORRECTION —** *The first edition stated that 'the Church of Rome hath erred in matters of Faith.' This has been removed and replaced. The Roman See has never defected from the Catholic Faith. The present crisis is one of sacramental validity — invalid orders — not of doctrine. The Insular Church claims to preserve the Western tradition in trust during this vacancy.*

THE visible Church of Christ is a congregation of faithful men throughout the world, in which the pure Word of God is preached, and the Sacraments be duly ministered according to Christ's ordinance, in apostolic succession from the Apostles themselves. The Church is both visible and invisible: visible in its earthly structure and ministry, invisible in its heavenly reality as the Communion of Saints.

The Roman See, as the see of the Apostle Peter, holdeth by ancient right and the will of our Lord a primacy of pastoral solicitude and doctrinal guardianship among the apostolic sees (Matt. 16:18–19). We hold, with Pope Leo I the Great, that this primacy is a ministry of service and unity for the whole Church, not a dominion that absorbs the authority of the other Patriarchs. The Roman Church has not erred in the Faith, nor do we believe she shall, for Christ hath promised that the gates of hell shall not prevail against her.

Nevertheless, the Insular Church recognises with grief that those who presently claim the Roman See and the Maltese See are without valid holy orders, having been appointed through the intrusion of lay princes who knew nothing of apostolic succession. A man who is no priest cannot be consecrated a bishop; a man who is no bishop cannot be a pope. The present occupants of these sees are therefore, by their own essential lack, unable to confer the sacraments, to absolve, or to ordain. This is a vacancy of the Apostolic See (*Sede Vacante*) of the most serious kind, more grave even than mere formal heresy, for it concerns the very root of sacramental validity.

As the Insular Church doth hold its apostolic succession intact — derived from His All-Holiness the Patriarch of Constantinople, and tracing its lineage through Saint Patrick and through the mission of Pope Saint Gregory the Great to the Anglo-Saxons — it doth carry the Western Catholic sacramental heritage in trust during this emergency. We do not style ourselves a new church, nor do we claim to have superseded Rome; we

are rather, in the words of the blessed Cyprian, those who *"hold the chair of Peter"* insofar as we hold the faith and orders of Peter, awaiting the day when a lawfully ordained successor shall be restored to that august see.

We maintain communion with our brother the Patriarch of Constantinople, thereby preserving the ancient bond between East and West, and we earnestly seek that restoration of the full Pentarchy — Rome, Constantinople, Alexandria, Antioch, Jerusalem — which the undivided Church of the first millennium knew and which, by God's grace, may yet be restored. Until that day, we continue in the Faith once delivered to the Saints, administering the Sacraments, preaching the Gospel, and praying without ceasing for the healing of all divisions within the Body of Christ.

> *"He cannot have God for his Father who hath not the Church for his Mother." — Saint Cyprian of Carthage, De Unitate Ecclesiae, 6*

Article XX. *Of the Authority of the Church*

THE Church hath power to decree Rites or Ceremonies, and authority in Controversies of Faith: and yet it is not lawful for the Church to ordain anything that is contrary to God's Word written, neither may it so expound one place of Scripture that it be repugnant to another. The Church is a witness and keeper of Holy Writ, and she hath authority to bind the consciences of the faithful in all things wherein Tradition, received from the Apostles and confirmed by the holy Fathers and Councils, doth so require — whether or not such things be explicitly resolved by the bare letter of Scripture. For the Spirit who inspired the Scripture is the same Spirit who guideth the Church into all truth (John 16:13).

⚑ REVISED Article XXI. *Of the Authority of General Councils*

> ✦ **EDITORIAL CORRECTION —** *The first edition recognised only the Seven Eastern Ecumenical Councils. This excludes the binding Western councils (including Lateran IV, upon which this document's eucharistic doctrine depends) and misses the significance of the Council of Constance for the present crisis. Revised below.*

GENERAL Councils are not infallible in every pronouncement, nor are they to be gathered without appropriate authorisation; and in ordinary times the consent of the Roman Pontiff is requisite to their full authority. When they be gathered together, forasmuch as they be an assembly of men, they may err in matters of discipline and in their practical judgments; but when they do define a matter of faith by the common consent of the whole Church, with Scripture and Tradition in their support, their definitions bind the consciences of the faithful. As the Council of Constance declared in *Haec Sancta* (1415): such a council in legitimate session *"holds its power immediately from Christ; and everyone of whatever state or dignity, even if it be the papal dignity, is bound to obey it in those things which pertain to the faith, the eradication of the said schism, and the general reformation of the said Church of God in head and members."*

We do not hold that councils are above popes in the ordinary governance of the Church. The Pope, as successor of Peter, holds the supreme pastoral authority. Nevertheless, in a time of crisis such as the present vacancy — when the Roman See is without a lawful occupant, and when schism threatens to rend the Body of Christ — a lawfully convened General Council is the proper and divinely warranted instrument of reform, holding its authority directly from God through the apostolic body as a whole. This was the precedent of the Council of Constance, which resolved the Western Schism; and we commend this precedent for any future resolution of the present vacancy.

The following Councils, in two tiers, are received with reverence by the Insular Church:

The Seven Ecumenical Councils (universally binding on East and West): Nicæa I (325), Constantinople I (381), Ephesus (431), Chalcedon (451), Constantinople II (553), Constantinople III (681), Nicæa II (787). These define the Faith in the most authoritative sense, and their dogmatic canons are received without reservation.

The Principal Western Councils (binding on the Western Church insofar as they accord with Scripture and the prior Ecumenical Councils, and insofar as they have been received by the universal body of bishops): the Council of Carthage (418) on original sin and grace; the Second Council of Orange (529) on grace and free will; the Fourth Lateran Council (1215) on the Eucharist (*transsubstantiatis*), annual confession, and the faith of the universal Church; the Council of Constance (1414–1418) on the healing of schism and the valid reception of the Eucharist under one kind; and such other Councils of the West as have been received by the universal body of bishops and are consonant with the Seven Ecumenical Councils.

⚑ REVISED Article XXII. *Of Purgatory, Indulgences, and the Prayers for the Departed*

> ✦ **EDITORIAL CORRECTION —** *The first edition conflated the legitimate doctrine of Indulgences with its gross commercial abuse, dismissing both together as 'fond inventions.' The doctrine is ancient and lawful; only the abuses are condemned. Revised to distinguish them clearly.*

THE doctrine of Purgatory, as it was believed and taught by the holy Fathers of the undivided Church — namely, that there is a state of purification after death for those who die in grace but who have not yet been fully cleansed of the temporal consequences of forgiven sin — is consonant with Scripture and ancient Tradition. Saint Augustine writeth of *"a certain purifying fire"* (*Enchiridion*, 69), and prayers for the faithful departed are found in the most ancient Liturgies of East and West alike. The Apostle writeth that each man's work shall be tried by fire, and that *"if any man's work shall be burned, he shall suffer loss: but he himself shall be saved, yet so as by fire"* (1 Cor. 3:15).

The doctrine of Indulgences — the authority of the Church to remit, by virtue of the infinite merits of Christ's Passion and the merits of the Saints united to His, the temporal punishment due to sins already forgiven by absolution — is ancient, legitimate, and rooted in the power of binding and loosing granted to the Church by our Lord (Matt. 18:18). We hold that the Church doth truly possess the power to apply these merits for the benefit of the living and, by intercession, of the faithful departed.

Nevertheless, the manifold corruptions which have attached themselves to the administration of Indulgences in these latter times are utterly to be condemned: the sale of Indulgences for coin, as though eternal mercy were a commodity of the market; the fabrication of mechanical tables of years and days of punishment, as though God's pardon could be quantified and traded; the reckless multiplication of private Masses as a mechanism for purchasing release of souls, as though the Holy Sacrifice were a commercial instrument. These abuses are contrary to the simplicity of the ancient Faith, the honour due to the Passion of our Lord, and the reverence owed to His sacred mysteries.

We do commend the souls of the faithful departed to God's mercy, and we pray for their repose, trusting in the infinite merits of Christ's Passion applied through the prayers of the Church. The living may assist the departed by prayer, almsgiving, fasting, and the Holy Sacrifice of the Mass; but we commit the mode and measure of this assistance entirely to the mercy and justice of Almighty God.

Article XXIII. *Of Ministering in the Congregation*

IT is not lawful for any man to take upon him the office of public preaching or ministering the Sacraments in the Congregation before he be lawfully called and sent to execute the same. Those we ought to judge lawfully called and sent who be chosen and called to this work by men who have public authority given unto them in the Congregation to call and send Ministers into the Lord's vineyard. This authority cometh through apostolic succession from the Apostles themselves, and is conferred by the laying on of hands in Holy Orders (1 Tim. 4:14; 2 Tim. 1:6).

Article XXIV. *Of Speaking in the Congregation in such a Tongue as the People understand*

IT is a thing plainly repugnant to the Word of God and the custom of the Primitive Church to have public Prayer in the Church, or to minister the Sacraments, in a tongue not understood of the people. The Apostle Paul doth plainly teach that in the Church we should speak with understanding, that the people may be edified: *"In the Church I had rather speak five words with my understanding, that by my voice I might teach others also, than ten thousand words in an unknown tongue"* (1 Cor. 14:19). Therefore it is meet that the Holy Scriptures, the Liturgy, and the administration of the Sacraments should be in the vulgar tongue, that all may comprehend the mysteries of salvation.

Article XXV. *Of the Sacraments*

SACRAMENTS ordained of Christ be not only badges or tokens of Christian men's profession, but rather they be certain sure witnesses and effectual signs of grace, and God's good will towards us, by the which He doth work invisibly in us, and doth not only quicken, but also strengthen and confirm our Faith in Him. Following the teaching of Saint Augustine, we distinguish in every Sacrament the *Sacramentum* (the outward sign) and the *Res* (the inward reality or spiritual effect). The *Sacramentum* is perceived by the bodily senses, while the *Res* is the invisible grace conferred upon those who receive worthily.

There are Seven Sacraments ordained in the Church: Baptism, Confirmation, the Eucharist, Penance, Extreme Unction, Holy Orders, and Matrimony. Of these, Baptism and the Eucharist have a special dignity, as being explicitly and prominently instituted by our Lord Jesus Christ in the Holy Gospels. The Sacraments were not ordained of Christ to be gazed upon or carried about, but that we should duly use them.

Article XXVI. *Of the Unworthiness of the Ministers, which hinders not the Effect of the Sacraments*

ALTHOUGH in the visible Church the evil be ever mingled with the good, and sometimes the evil have chief authority in the Ministration of the Word and Sacraments, yet forasmuch as they do not the same in their own name but in Christ's, and do minister by His commission and authority, we may use their Ministry both in hearing the Word of God and in receiving the Sacraments. Neither is the effect of Christ's ordinance taken away by their wickedness, nor the grace of God's gifts diminished from such as by faith and rightly do receive the Sacraments ministered unto them; which be effectual because of Christ's institution and promise, although they be ministered by evil men.

> *"The Sacrament is one thing, the virtue of the Sacrament another. Many receive it from the altar and, by receiving, die... The Sacrament of so great a thing is one thing, the virtue of the Sacrament is another thing."*
> *— Saint Augustine, In Johannem Tractatus, 26.11 — basis for the distinction between Sacramentum and Res*

This was the teaching of Saint Augustine against the Donatists, who held that the Sacraments depended upon the holiness of the minister. We reject this Donatist error utterly. Nevertheless, we note that this principle applies only to validly ordained ministers: a man who lacks valid holy orders doth not administer a Sacrament unworthily — he doth not administer the Sacrament at all, as the form and intention are present but the matter of valid orders is wholly absent.

Article XXVII. *Of Baptism*

BAPTISM is not only a sign of profession and mark of difference whereby Christian men are discerned from others that be not christened, but it is also a sign of Regeneration or New-Birth, whereby, as by an instrument, they that receive Baptism rightly are grafted into the Church; the promises of forgiveness of sin and of our adoption to be the sons of God by the Holy Ghost are visibly signed and sealed; Faith is confirmed, and Grace increased by virtue of prayer unto God. As our Lord commanded: *"Unless one is born of water and the Spirit, he cannot enter the Kingdom of God"* (John 3:5).

In Baptism, the *reatus* (guilt) of original sin is entirely and perfectly remitted, so that there remaineth no condemnation to those who are baptised. Nevertheless, there remaineth a certain languor or *infirmitas* (weakness), which the Fathers call *concupiscentia* or *fomes peccati*, being the involuntary inclination toward evil. This is not personal sin so long as the will doth not consent thereunto, but is rather a penalty of original sin and a disorder that must be mortified by grace throughout this life.

The Baptism of young Children is in any wise to be retained in the Church, as most agreeable with the institution of Christ and the practice of the Apostles, and as consonant with the doctrine of original sin here confessed.

> **Note on lawful debate:** *See the note on Article IX regarding the precise theological characterisation of concupiscence. Both the Augustinian and stricter Thomist positions are permissible here. The Insular Church follows Augustine's stronger usage — that concupiscence retains a 'nature of sin' even after Baptism — without thereby condemning those who prefer the Thomist qualification.*

Article XXVIII. *Of the Lord's Supper*

THE Supper of the Lord is not only a sign of the love that Christians ought to have among themselves one to another, but rather it is a Sacrament of our Redemption by Christ's death: insomuch that to such as rightly, worthily, and with faith receive the same, the Bread which we break is a partaking of the Body of Christ; and likewise the Cup of Blessing is a partaking of the Blood of Christ (1 Cor. 10:16).

Following the teaching of the blessed Paschasius Radbertus, Doctor of the Church for his exposition of the Lord's Supper, we confess that after the consecration the bread and wine are to be believed as absolutely nothing other (*omnino nihil aliud*) than the flesh and blood of Christ. It is plainly none other than that flesh which was born of the Virgin Mary, which suffered on the Cross, and which rose from the tomb. The body and blood of Christ are effected by the power of the Holy Spirit, through the word of Christ, from the substance of bread and wine (*ex panis vinique substantia*). This is the Real, True, and Sacramental Presence of the Lord in His Supper.

Yet the mode of this presence is sacramental and spiritual, not crudely physical or Capernaitic. The outward appearances of bread and wine are not changed to bodily sight and taste, so that faith may be exercised unto righteousness. What is perceived outwardly by the bodily senses is the figure of the truth; what is perceived inwardly through spiritual apprehension and faith illumined by the Holy Spirit is entirely truth and no shadow

— the very Body and Blood of the Lord. The change in substance is real and independent of the faith of any communicant; faith is that by which the soul receives and is nourished, not that by which the change is effected.

The later Scholastic elaboration of this mystery through the philosophical terminology of Transubstantiation — whether in the manner of the Thomists, who speak of a change of substance whilst the accidents remain, or of the Scotists, who ground the sacramental change in the absolute power of God — doth represent a legitimate and learned attempt to defend the Real Presence. We do not condemn this terminology as heretical, nor do we despise the labors of the Schools. Nevertheless, we hold that the language of the blessed Paschasius and the holy Fathers, being simpler and more sacramental, is sufficient to confess the mystery. We confess the Real, True, and Sacramental Presence of Christ in the Eucharist; let the Schools dispute the manner, whilst the Church holds fast the truth.

We do reject, on the one hand, those who reduce the Holy Sacrament to a bare memorial or naked sign, as though Christ were absent from His own Supper and present only in the subjective faith of the communicant; and we reject, on the other hand, all crude or Capernaitic conceptions which would subject the Body of the Lord to carnal mastication or physical digestion. The Sacrament is at once both truth and figure: the figure being that which is perceived outwardly, the truth being whatsoever is rightly understood and believed inwardly concerning this mystery.

> **Note on lawful debate:** *The precise philosophical account of the Eucharistic change is a matter of lawful scholastic debate. The Thomist account of transubstantiation (change of substance, accidents remaining), the Scotist account (absolute divine power sustaining the appearances), and the Paschasian sacramental-patristic approach (change of substance affirmed without philosophical specification) are all within the bounds of orthodoxy. What is excluded is: (a) mere memorialism (Zwinglian position), (b) denial that any change of substance occurs, and (c) Capernaitic crudeness. The Insular Church does not require adhesion to any single philosophical account, but does require affirmation of the Real Presence and the change in substance.*

Article XXIX. *Of the Wicked, which eat not the Body of Christ in the Use of the Lord's Supper*

THE Wicked, and such as be void of a lively faith, although they do carnally and visibly press with their teeth (as Saint Augustine saith) the Sacrament of the Body and Blood of Christ, yet in no wise are they partakers of Christ: but rather, to their condemnation, do eat and drink the sign or Sacrament of so great a thing. For as Paschasius teacheth, the unbeliever attends only to what he sees and what is perceived by the mouth, neither understanding anything beyond the carnal sense.

Nevertheless, this doth not mean that Christ's presence in the Sacrament dependeth upon the faith of the communicant. The Body and Blood of Christ are truly, really, and sacramentally present in the consecrated elements by the power of the Holy Spirit and the word of Christ, whether the communicant be worthy or unworthy. The wicked receive the *Sacramentum* (the outward sacramental reality) but not the *Res* (the saving grace thereof), and thus receive judgment unto themselves (1 Cor. 11:29).

⚑ REVISED Article XXX. *Of both Kinds*

> ✦ **EDITORIAL CORRECTION —** *The first edition declared communion in both kinds to be required by 'Christ's ordinance and commandment,' effectively condemning communion under one kind as contrary to divine law. The Council of Constance (Session 13, 1415) formally defined that communion under one kind is full and sufficient sacramental participation, and condemned as heretical the demand that both kinds are required by divine right. The article has been rewritten: the Insular Church restores both kinds as an ancient and praiseworthy custom, but does not condemn communion under one kind as invalid.*

IT is the ancient and apostolic practice of the Church to administer the Sacrament of the Lord's Supper in both kinds — the Body under the form of bread, and the Blood under the form of wine — and this practice is attested in the holy Scriptures (Matt. 26:27: *"Drink ye all of it"*; 1 Cor. 11:25–26), in the witness of the Fathers, and in the most ancient Liturgies of East and West. The Insular Church doth therefore administer the Sacrament in both kinds to all the faithful, restoring this ancient custom and judging it most fitting for the right participation of the laity in the holy mysteries.

Nevertheless, we do not hold that the administration of both kinds is required as a matter of divine law, nor do we declare that the practice of communion under one kind alone — which hath been the custom of the Western Church for many centuries, and which was solemnly upheld by the Council of Constance — is contrary to Christ's ordinance or constitutes an incomplete sacramental participation. The Council of Constance did rightly define (Session 13, 1415) that communion under one kind is full and sufficient, and that to demand both kinds as the only valid form is to fall into the Hussite error. We accept this definition, and do not condemn any portion of the faithful who receive under one kind alone.

Our restoration of the chalice to the laity is, therefore, a matter of pastoral order and ancient custom, commended by Scripture and Tradition, and adopted by authority of the Insular Church for the greater edification of the faithful — not an assertion that the Church erred in ever permitting communion under one kind.

Article XXXI. *Of the one Oblation of Christ finished upon the Cross*

THE Offering of Christ once made upon the Cross is that perfect redemption, propitiation, and satisfaction for all the sins of the whole world, both original and actual; and there is none other satisfaction for sin but that alone. The Sacrifice of Christ was accomplished once for all (*semel pro omnibus*), and is of infinite value, needing no repetition or addition (Heb. 9:26–28; 10:10).

The Holy Sacrifice of the Mass is not a new sacrifice, nor a repetition of the Sacrifice of the Cross, but is rather a sacramental re-presentation (*repraesentatio*) of that one eternal Sacrifice, whereby the same Christ who offered Himself once upon the Cross doth continue to offer Himself to the Father in His priestly humanity. In the Mass, we do not offer a different Christ, but we do plead before the Father the merits of that one perfect Sacrifice, and we do unite ourselves to Christ's eternal oblation. Wherefore the blasphemous fables and dangerous deceits whereby Masses were multiplied as merchandise and sold for money are utterly to be condemned.

Article XXXII. *Of the Marriage of Priests*

BISHOPS, Priests, and Deacons are not by divine law required to vow perpetual celibacy or to abstain from marriage. The discipline of celibacy in the Western Church is an ancient and venerable tradition, worthy of honour and generally to be observed by those upon whom it hath been imposed; but it is an ecclesiastical discipline rather than a divine commandment, as the universal practice of the Eastern Church in communion with Rome doth plainly demonstrate, for in those Churches married men have always been ordained to the priesthood and diaconate.

It is therefore lawful for the Church, by its own authority and for pastoral reasons, to ordain married men to Holy Orders, or to dispense from the obligation of celibacy in particular cases, as hath been done throughout the Eastern tradition. Such dispensation doth not contradict the law of God, but constituteth a legitimate

exercise of the Church's pastoral authority. The Insular Church, recognising both the honour of holy celibacy freely embraced for the Kingdom of God (Matt. 19:12; 1 Cor. 7:7–8) and the lawfulness and dignity of Christian marriage, doth permit the ordination of married men in the manner of the Eastern tradition, whilst continuing to commend celibacy as a counsel of perfection for those who are called thereto.

> **Note on lawful debate:** *Priestly celibacy as a universal Western discipline was not a defined matter of divine faith before Trent. The question of whether it ought to be required, dispensed, or reformed was openly debated. The Insular Church does not hold that celibacy is contrary to God's law, but follows the Eastern precedent in permitting the ordination of married men. This position was held by many pre-Tridentine canonists and theologians and is not heterodox.*

Article XXXIII. *Of Excommunicate Persons, how they are to be avoided*

THAT person which by open denunciation of the Church is rightly cut off from the unity of the Church and excommunicated, ought to be taken of the whole multitude of the faithful as a Heathen and Publican (Matt. 18:17), until he be openly reconciled by penance and received into the Church by a Judge that hath authority thereunto. Excommunication is a medicinal remedy, ordained for the salvation of the sinner and the protection of the flock, and is not to be used for light causes or from motives of revenge.

Article XXXIV. *Of the Traditions of the Church*

IT is not necessary that Traditions and Ceremonies be in all places one, or utterly alike; for at all times they have been diverse, and may be changed according to the diversity of countries, times, and men's manners, so that nothing be ordained against God's Word. Whosoever, through his private judgment, willingly and purposely doth openly break the Traditions and Ceremonies of the Church, which be not repugnant to the Word of God, and be ordained and approved by common authority, ought to be rebuked openly, as he that offendeth against the common order of the Church and woundeth the consciences of the weak brethren.

Every particular or national Church hath authority to ordain, change, and abolish Ceremonies or Rites of the Church ordained only by man's authority, so that all things be done to edifying. The Church of the Insular Realms, being a particular Church within the one Catholic Church, doth possess this authority in full measure.

Article XXXV. *Of Homilies and Preaching*

THE preaching of the Word of God is a chief part of the ministry of the Church, and it is the duty of all bishops and priests to preach the Gospel diligently and faithfully, according to the Holy Scriptures and the tradition of the Fathers. Where learned and godly preachers are not available, homilies may be read in the Church, containing sound doctrine and instruction in righteousness, that the people may not be left without the Word of God. But living preaching is always to be preferred, that the Word may be applied to the present needs of the flock.

Article XXXVI. *Of Consecration of Bishops and Ministers*

THE consecration of bishops and the ordination of priests and deacons must be performed according to the ancient rites of the Church, with the laying on of hands and the invocation of the Holy Ghost (Acts 13:3; 1 Tim. 4:14; 2 Tim. 1:6), by bishops who stand in the apostolic succession. This succession is the Golden Chain which reacheth back to the Apostles themselves, and is preserved in the Churches both of East and West which have maintained the ancient Faith. We do maintain this succession in its fullness, being in communion with our

brother the Patriarch of Constantinople, and tracing our orders through Saint Patrick and through the mission of Pope Saint Gregory the Great.

Article XXXVII. *Of the Civil Magistrates*

THE King's Majesty or other lawful civil authority hath chief power in these Realms over all estates, whether Ecclesiastical or Civil, in all temporal causes. Where we attribute to civil princes this chief government, we give not to them the ministering either of God's Word or of the Sacraments (the which thing doth appertain only to those who are called and ordained according to the rites of the Church), but that only prerogative which we see to have been given always to godly Princes in Holy Scripture by God Himself: that is, that they should rule all estates committed to their charge by God, and restrain with the civil sword the stubborn and evil-doers. As Saint Paul writeth: *"The authorities that exist are appointed by God"* (Rom. 13:1).

Concerning the jurisdiction of the Roman See in these Realms: as we have declared in Article XIX, the present occupants of that See lack valid holy orders, and therefore their purported jurisdiction is void. Should the Roman See be restored to a lawfully ordained successor, the Insular Church doth commit itself to negotiate in charity and truth the question of jurisdiction and its proper limits. In this regard, we honor the memory of Pope Leo I the Great, whose understanding of Papal Primacy — as a ministry of pastoral solicitude and doctrinal guardianship in service of the whole Church, rather than as an absolute sovereignty — remaineth our guide for the right ordering of the universal Church.

The Laws of the Realm may punish Christian men with death for heinous and grievous offenses, for the magistrate beareth not the sword in vain, but is the minister of God, a revenger to execute wrath upon him that doeth evil (Rom. 13:4). It is lawful for Christian men, at the commandment of the Magistrate, to wear weapons and serve in the wars, when the cause is just and the war is undertaken for the defense of the innocent or the maintenance of justice.

Article XXXVIII. *Of Christian Men's Goods, which are not Common*

THE Riches and Goods of Christians are not common, as touching the right, title, and possession of the same, as certain Anabaptists and other sectaries do falsely boast. Private property is lawful and ordained by God for the good ordering of society. Notwithstanding, every man ought, of such things as he possesseth, liberally to give alms to the poor according to his ability, remembering the words of our Lord: *"Inasmuch as ye have done it unto one of the least of these my brethren, ye have done it unto me"* (Matt. 25:40).

Article XXXIX. *Of a Christian Man's Oath*

AS we confess that vain and rash swearing is forbidden Christian men by our Lord Jesus Christ (Matt. 5:34) and James His Apostle (Jas. 5:12), so we judge that Christian Religion doth not prohibit, but that a man may swear when the Magistrate requireth it, in a cause of faith and charity, so it be done according to the Prophet's teaching, in justice, judgment, and truth (Jer. 4:2). An oath is a solemn calling upon God to witness the truth of what we say, and to judge us if we speak falsely; and therefore it is not to be used lightly or in trivial matters, but only when weighty causes do require it.

Article XL. *Of the Four Great Insular Latin Fathers*

THE Insular Church doth recognize and honor four Great Latin Fathers, whose teaching, example, and labors have been of singular importance to the formation and preservation of the Faith in these Realms, and whose authority we do follow in all matters wherein they are consonant with Holy Scripture and the Ecumenical Councils.

Saint Gregory I the Great, whom we honor for his Pastoral Excellence, for the sacred Liturgy which beareth his name and which we do preserve and celebrate in these Insular Churches, and for his sending of missionaries to the Anglo-Saxon peoples, whereby the light of the Gospel was brought unto these northern lands. His *Regula Pastoralis* remaineth the pattern for all bishops and pastors.

Saint Augustine of Hippo, Doctor of Grace, whom we honor as the principal theological authority of the Western Church for his doctrines of Grace, Sin, Predestination, Free Will, and History. His writings against the Pelagians and the Donatists, his *Confessiones* and *De Civitate Dei*, constitute the theological foundation upon which these Articles are built.

Saint Jerome, whom we honor for composing the Holy Vulgate, that blessed translation of the Sacred Scriptures into Latin which hath been the Bible of the Western Church for a thousand years and more. The Vulgate remaineth the authoritative Latin text of the Holy Scriptures in these Insular Churches.

Saint Ambrose of Milan, whom we honor as the Model Bishop, who did assert the authority of the episcopal office over Emperors and civil powers, and who did shape the Western Hymnody and Liturgy, enriching the worship of the Church with sacred hymns and liturgical forms which endure to this day.

Article XLI. *Of the Doctors of the Church*

BESIDES the Four Great Insular Latin Fathers, the Insular Church doth recognize and elevate certain holy teachers to the dignity of Doctor of the Church, each for a particular and eminent contribution to the understanding and defense of the Catholic Faith.

Paschasius Radbertus, Doctor of the Church for his Exposition of the Lord's Supper: In his De Corpore et Sanguine Domini, Paschasius did set forth with unsurpassed clarity the doctrine of the Real and Sacramental Presence of Christ in the Eucharist, teaching that after the consecration the bread and wine are absolutely nothing other than the flesh and blood of Christ — the very same body born of Mary, crucified, and risen — yet received not carnally but spiritually, through the interior perception of faith. His teaching is the foundation of the eucharistic doctrine confessed in Article XXVIII.

Saint Maximus the Confessor, Doctor of the Church for articulating the orthodox understanding of the Filioque: Saint Maximus did demonstrate that the procession of the Holy Spirit from the Father through the Son, rightly understood, is consonant with the teaching of both East and West, and that the Latin Filioque, interpreted in the sense of the Greek dia tou Huiou (through the Son), doth not contradict the Monarchy of the Father. His teaching is the basis of Article V.

Pope Leo I the Great, Doctor of the Church for his understanding of Papal Primacy: Pope Leo did articulate with singular authority the doctrine of the Petrine ministry, teaching that the Bishop of Rome holdeth a primacy of honor and pastoral solicitude among the bishops of the Church, grounded in the confession of Saint Peter. His Tome to the Council of Chalcedon is received by East and West alike, and his understanding of primacy — as a ministry of service and guardianship of the faith, rather than an absolute monarchy — doth guide the Insular Church.

Bede the Venerable, Doctor of the Church for his Ecclesiastical Importance to the Anglo-Saxons: The Venerable Bede, by his Historia Ecclesiastica Gentis Anglorum and his many works of scriptural commentary and scholarship, did preserve the memory of the conversion of the English peoples and did establish the intellectual and spiritual foundations of the Anglo-Saxon Church. He is the Father of English Church History.

Saint Anselm the Great, Doctor of the Church for his understanding of the Atonement: In his Cur Deus Homo, Anselm did set forth the doctrine of Satisfaction, demonstrating that the gravity of sin against the infinite God requireth a satisfaction of infinite worth, which only the God-Man could offer. His teaching doth illuminate the mystery of the Cross and the voluntary oblation of Christ spoken of in Articles II and XXXI.

Saint Basil the Great, Doctor of the Church for his defense of the Holy Trinity against the Arians: Saint Basil, Bishop of Cæsarea, did stand as an immovable pillar of orthodoxy against the Arian heresy, defending the full divinity and consubstantiality of the Son and of the Holy Spirit with the Father. His De Spiritu Sancto and Contra Eunomium remain among the most authoritative expositions of Trinitarian doctrine in the whole Catholic Church.

Saint Athanasius of Alexandria, Doctor of the Church for his defense of the Holy Trinity against the Arians: Saint Athanasius, the great champion of the Nicene Faith, did endure exile and persecution rather than yield one syllable of the truth that the Son is of one substance (homoousios) with the Father. His De Incarnatione doth set forth with matchless clarity the mystery whereby the Word was made flesh for our salvation.

Saint Gregory of Nazianzus, Doctor of the Church for his articulation of the full humanity of Christ: Saint Gregory, called the Theologian, did teach with singular precision that what is not assumed is not healed, and that our Lord took upon Himself a complete and perfect human nature — body, soul, and mind — so that the whole of our fallen humanity might be restored. His Theological Orations are among the most exalted expressions of Christian doctrine ever composed.

Saint John Chrysostom, Doctor of the Church for his moral exegesis, ethics, preaching, and model of piety for lay people: Saint John, called the Golden Mouth, is the supreme model of the Christian preacher, whose homilies on the Scriptures unite profound exegesis with urgent moral application. His expositions of the Epistles of Saint Paul and the Gospels remain unsurpassed in their clarity and pastoral warmth, and he is commended especially as a pattern of lay piety.

In honoring teachers of both East and West, we do bear witness that the Insular Church is heir to the full patrimony of the undivided Church and holdeth in equal veneration the Fathers of every tongue and nation who have faithfully confessed the apostolic Faith.

Article XLII. *Of the Reconciliation of the Churches and the Ordering of the Northern Rite*

WHEREAS the Insular Church doth maintain, as is declared in Article XIX, that the present separation from the jurisdiction of the Roman See proceedeth not from any desire to rend the seamless garment of Christ, but from the vacancy of that See caused by the intrusion of unlawfully appointed men without valid holy orders; and whereas we do earnestly long for that day when the Roman See shall be restored to a lawfully ordained successor of Peter, and the full Pentarchy of the ancient Church shall be reconstituted: we do hereby set forth the manner in which this reconciliation shall be pursued, should Almighty God in His providence bring it to pass.

First, upon the resolution of the said vacancy and the restoration of a lawfully ordained Roman Bishop, the Insular Church shall seek, in concert with the Roman See and the Patriarchate of Constantinople, a definitive Confession of Faith agreed upon by common consent, setting forth those doctrines which all communions hold in common by virtue of the Holy Scriptures, the Seven Ecumenical Councils, and the consensus of the holy Fathers. Likewise shall the Insular Church submit its Liturgy, its Articles of Religion, and its governance to a joint examination, that whatsoever is consonant with the Catholic Faith may be confirmed, and whatsoever is found wanting may be amended in charity and truth.

Second, upon the accomplishment of the said reconciliation, the Insular Church shall seek to be constituted as a distinct Rite within the one Catholic Church — the Northern Rite (*Ritus Septentrionalis*) — after the manner in which the Eastern Churches do preserve their several rites and customs whilst remaining in the unity of the Faith. This Northern Rite shall be collegial and conciliar in its governance, ordered according to the ancient precedent of the provincial synod and the metropolitan system.

Third, the governance of the Northern Rite shall be vested in a Synod of Bishops, presided over according to the following order of precedence: the Archbishop of Armagh, Primate of All Ireland, as the most ancient see of these Islands; then the Archbishop of Canterbury, Primate of All England; then the Archbishop of Wales; then the chief Bishop of Scotland; and thereafter such other episcopal sees as shall be admitted to the Rite. Every constituent see shall possess at least one vote in all deliberations, that the collegial principle which the Apostles did practise in the Council of Jerusalem (Acts 15) may be faithfully maintained.

Fourth, it is to be plainly declared that the Insular Church doth not seek, and shall not seek, any difference from the Roman See in matters of dogma, should the said reconciliation come to pass. We confess one Faith, one Lord, one Baptism (Eph. 4:5). What we seek is solely this: that the whole treasury of the Traditions of the Church — the liturgical customs, the patristic inheritance, the canonical disciplines, the forms of piety and devotion which have flourished in East and West and in these Northern lands — insofar as they have not been condemned by any Ecumenical Council or by the plain testimony of Holy Scripture, should be accounted valid and lawful within the one Catholic communion.

Until such time as this reconciliation shall be accomplished, the Insular Church doth continue in the governance and ordering set forth in these Articles, maintaining the Faith once delivered to the Saints, preserving communion with the Patriarchate of Constantinople, and awaiting in hope and charity that blessed day when the wounds of Christendom shall be healed and all who confess the Name of Christ shall be visibly one, even as the Father and the Son are one (John 17:21).

Conclusion

THESE Articles do set forth the Faith of the Insular Church in accordance with Holy Scripture, the Seven Ecumenical Councils and the binding Western Councils here received, and the teaching of the Holy Fathers — most especially the Four Great Insular Latin Fathers: Saint Gregory the Great, Saint Augustine of Hippo, Saint Jerome, and Saint Ambrose of Milan — and the Doctors of the Church: Paschasius Radbertus, Saint Maximus the Confessor, Pope Leo I the Great, Bede the Venerable, and Saint Anselm the Great of the West, together with Saint Basil the Great, Saint Athanasius of Alexandria, Saint Gregory of Nazianzus, and Saint John Chrysostom of the East.

We have endeavored to chart a middle course: holding the Faith whole and entire, maintaining the apostolic succession unbroken, condemning all innovations that would reduce the holy mysteries to mere memorials, whilst acknowledging where the Western Church in recent years hath suffered from the intrusion of worldly princes and the corruption of sacred things by commerce and political ambition. We do not innovate, but preserve; we do not break communion, but maintain it with all who hold the apostolic Faith.

We await in hope and charity that day when the impediments shall be removed, when the Roman See shall be restored to a lawfully ordained successor of Peter, and when East and West shall be visibly united once more in that perfect charity which is the bond of peace. Until that day, we do maintain the Faith once delivered to the Saints (Jude 1:3), keeping the deposit of truth inviolate, and building up the faithful in holiness and righteousness, to the glory of God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Ghost.

WE, the undersigned, being duly assembled in the Cathedral Church of Armagh,
do set our hands and seals to these Articles of Religion,
and do commend them to all the faithful throughout the Insular Realms.

✠ Corpo MacAirthir, Comharba Pátraic
Primate of Ireland, Archbishop & Abbot of Armagh

✠ Níldríf
Abbot of Innisfallen

With the Royal Assent of:
✠ Robert I, King of Desmond
✠ Pal, King of England

✠

Finis

Laus Deo et Beatæ Mariæ Virgini et omnibus Sanctis

PART V

CANONES

SACRI ET VENERABILIS

CONCILII ARDMACHANI

Being the Decrees and Ordinances set forth by the

Holy Synod of Armagh, assembled in the name of the

undivided Trinity, Father, Son, and Holy Ghost

In the name of the Holy and undivided Trinity. This sacred Synod, lawfully convened and assembled in the primatial see of Armagh — that ancient and apostolic chair founded by the blessed Patrick, Apostle of Ireland — with the authority vested in the Primates, Archbishops, Bishops, and Abbots of the Insular Church here gathered, decrees, defines, and ordains the following canons to be observed henceforth by all the faithful under the care of this holy Church, unto the glory of God and the well-ordering of His people.

CANON I

On the Convening and Authority of Synods

We define and ordain that any Primate of the Insular Church may lawfully convoke a Synod, and that the place of its assembly shall be determined according to which Primate

has issued the summons. To each such gathering, the Primates, Archbishops, Bishops, and Abbots rightly belong as voting members; secular rulers and princes may attend and offer counsel, as befits their dignity, and are charged to execute the duties proper to the civil magistrate — yet they shall cast no deliberative vote.

That the decrees of this Synod may carry the weight of right reason and broad consent, we ordain that no motion shall pass save by a majority of two-thirds of those present and voting. In all matters pertaining to doctrine or dogma touching upon salvation, the unanimous consent of the Primates is required, that the faith be guarded without division.

Furthermore, we distinguish the several kinds of ecclesiastical causes. Those matters which are purely local in their scope — the building or ordering of a single church within a town — belong to the proper bishop of that place. Those matters which concern an entire province or nation shall be handled jointly by the Primate and the civil authority. Those matters which pertain to the Insular Church in its entirety, especially in its dealings with those outside, are reserved to the Synod. Let no bishop arrogate to himself what belongs to a higher assembly, nor let the Synod be burdened with what is rightly left to local discretion.

CANON II

On the Order of the Primacies and the Organisation of Dioceses

We declare and define the fivefold structure of the Primacies of the Insular Church. The Archbishopric of Armagh, Primatial See of the Irish, holds the dignity of first among equals; its Archbishop must be present whensoever a Synod is held, and he it is who shall represent the whole Insular Church in dealings with other communions and religions abroad.

There is likewise the Archbishopric of Saint Davids, Primatial See of the Welsh and Cornish; the Archbishopric of Canterbury, Primatial See of the Anglo-Saxons; the Archbishopric of York, Primatial See of the Danes; and the Archbishopric of Edinburgh, Primatial See of the Scots. These five sees together form the foundations upon which all other governance of this Church rests.

Regarding the organisation of dioceses, we decree: that no more than one bishop shall exercise jurisdiction in any single town, lest confusion and rivalry bring harm upon the people of God. Each bishop has authority to ordain priests for the service of his diocese; he bears full responsibility for their conduct within his bounds, for the soundness of their teaching, and for the integrity of their lives. Any priest who desires to serve as a missionary beyond his diocese is required to communicate this intention to his bishop and to obtain his blessing.

We further declare that the number of bishoprics is not to be regarded as fixed in perpetuity. As new towns grow and as new peoples may by God's grace come to embrace the faith and enter into union with us, new bishoprics shall be established and, in time, new primatial sees may be erected — provided always that this shall not diminish or supplant the dignity of the five founding Primates herein named.

CANON III

On the Role of Temporal Princes in Ecclesiastical Affairs

Since God in His wisdom has given to the Church both spiritual and temporal guardians for the welfare of His people, we recognize that secular rulers, both local and national, possess the right to present a candidate for any vacant bishopric that falls within their civil jurisdiction. Moreover, they may raise lawful objections to a candidate put forward for such a see, on grounds that are manifest and grave — as when a candidate has been found to be politically seditious or disobedient to lawful authority; to have promoted false or heretical doctrine; to have been banished from the town or city in question; to have been declared an outlaw; to have committed treason against the commonwealth; or to have fomented schism within the body of the Church.

Nonetheless, that the liberty of the Church be in no wise subverted, we ordain that the final determination in all matters touching episcopal appointments shall rest with the Primate of the ecclesiastical province concerned. The prince may advise and object; he may not command or compel. Whatsoever is decreed in this matter by the Primate shall stand as the settled judgment of the Church.

CANON IV

On Relations with Other Communions, and with Those Outside the Christian Faith

We recognize, by reason of our longstanding brotherhood, our historic friendship, and our maintained apostolic succession joined to our prior-established union, that this Insular Church is in full communion with the Patriarchate of Constantinople. Any Church with which we stand in communion is permitted to traverse our lands freely, without let or hindrance, whether for the purposes of trade, of pilgrimage, or of fraternal exchange.

Concerning those who belong to communions not in union with us: they may freely traverse and trade within our lands, yet they shall not take up permanent settlement therein, nor may they enter our churches or receive our sacraments, unless they be received into the Insular Church by proper conversion. We concede nonetheless that, where a person's baptismal formula is found to be valid according to the form required by Christian tradition, such a person is to be recognized as a Christian and may be embraced within the hope of salvation.

Regarding the Jews: so long as they do not disturb the peace of the Church or the common peace of the realm, they shall be permitted to trade and travel through our lands, inasmuch as they too are followers of the God of Abraham and share with us a common heritage of sacred Scripture. When publicly known as Jews while sojourning in our territories, they shall wear the distinctive hat appointed for this purpose, in whatsoever colour they may choose, so that they may be recognized in the course of trade and diplomacy.

Regarding the Muslims: they are not to be reckoned as pagans nor treated as such. They are permitted to trade, to travel, and to engage in diplomacy within our lands; yet they shall not enter our churches nor receive our sacraments, unless they convert. We reserve the right of this Church to maintain relations with Muslim rulers, whether friendly or hostile, according to how those rulers treat the Christian inhabitants of their own lands — especially in matters touching the legal standing of churches and the safety of pilgrims.

As regards pagans, the ordering of immediate relations is left to the discretion of local authority. We extend a generous hand to any pagan, whether subject or ruler, who desires by God's grace to enter into the fullness of the faith and to worship the one true God. Such shall be received with all charity.

Regarding the confirmation of religious and missionary orders: inasmuch as the See of Peter is presently vacant, the authority to confirm such orders — both missionary and monastic — is held conjointly by all five Primates of the Insular Church. The full ordering of this matter is deferred to a future Synod. Priests ordained for missionary service shall be permitted to celebrate the Insular Rite, the Rite of Saint Ninian the Presbyter, or the Rite of Pope Saint Gregory the Great, according as is meet for their mission.

CANON V

On the Authorised Text of Holy Scripture

That the Church may speak with one voice in her official documents and that no ambiguity arise from diversity of translations, this Synod decrees that the Douai-Rheims-Challoner translation of the Holy Scriptures shall serve as the authoritative vernacular text for all official documents of the Insular Church. For all Latin texts and usages, this Synod ordains that a copy of the Vulgate — that translation of the blessed Jerome, long attested within Catholic tradition and which has historically represented the theological centre of the Western Church — shall be acquired and transcribed for the Church's official use.

CANON VI

On the Adoption of the Mvndi-Seasons Calendar, and the Bishops' Book

This holy Synod decrees that the Insular Church shall henceforth adopt as her official calendar the Mvndi-Seasons Calendar, composed by Robert of Oriel, and that all liturgical observances, the reckoning of feasts, fasts, and seasons of the Church's year shall be ordered according to its computation.

Furthermore, this Synod ordains adherence to the Official Revised Confession of Faith, contained within the latest iteration of the Bishops' Book, which shall be made freely available for all the faithful to read. That Confession stands as the settled teaching of this Church on all matters of doctrine and dogma.

Matters of pastoral prudence — such as the observance of particular saints' feast days, the appointment of fasts, and the like — are left to the discretion of the bishops, each in his own diocese, as has long been the custom of the Church.

CANON VII

On the Ordination of Clergy from Communions not in Union with Us

Since the integrity of holy orders is of the utmost importance for the life of the Church and the validity of her sacraments, this Synod decrees the following concerning the reception of clergy who come to us from communions separated from or opposed to this Church.

First, that any such clergyman, before he may be ordained or received in holy orders within the Insular Church, is required to profess and subscribe to the Insular Creed in its entirety, and to make a formal renunciation of whatsoever false churches or bishops he may have previously served.

Second, that to ordain those who have held high office in any false or schismatic church requires the express permission of the Insular Synod itself, that no irregular or clandestine ordination may take place without the knowledge of the whole Church.

Third, that any bishop who shall presume to ordain illicitly a clergyman from a false church, in contempt of this canon and without the requisite permission, shall thereby incur excommunication automatically, by the very act itself, without need of further process or declaration.

Fourth, we define that valid ordination within the Insular Church requires proper matter, the proper form and formula, the ministry of a bishop who is himself rightly

ordained and in good standing, and the right intention to do what the Church does. Where any of these four elements is found to be lacking, the ordination is to be regarded as null and without effect.

SUBSCRIPTIONES

The undersigned Primates, Archbishops, Bishops, and Abbots,

gathered in this holy Synod of Armagh, do subscribe and confirm

all the foregoing canons, in witness of which we affix our names.

I, Archbishop of Armagh, Primate of All Ireland, first among equals, confirm these canons:

+ Most Rev. Corpo Macirthir, Archbishop of Armagh

+ Excellentissimus ac Reverendissimus Dominus Corpo MacAirthir, Archiepiscopus Ardmachanus

I, Archbishop of Saint Davids, Primate of the Welsh and Cornish, confirm these canons:

+ Archbishop Claude of Saint Davids

+ Claudius, Archiepiscopus Menevensis

I, Archbishop of Canterbury, Primate of the Anglo-Saxons, confirm these canons:

+ The Most Reverend Lord Ellis, Archbishop of Canterbury

+ Reverendissimus Dominus Ellis, Archiepiscopus Cantuariensis

I, Archbishop of York, Primate of the Danes, confirm these canons:

+ His Excellency, Most Reverend, Acutis24 of York

+ Praestantissimus et Reverendissimus Acutis XXIV, Archiepiscopus Eboracensis

I, Archbishop of Edinburgh, Primate of the Scots, confirm these canons:

+ His Excellency, Most Rev. Archbishop Nathan of Edinburgh

+ Excellentissimus ac Reverendissimus Dominus Nathan, Archiepiscopus Edinburgum

Additional episcopal signatures:

+ [Bishop of Cardiff] Right Reverent Daryl, Bishop of Cardiff

+ Ius Reverende Daryl, Episcopus Caerdiffia

+ *The Reverend Lord Nildrif, Abbot of Armaghh*

+ *Reverendus Dominus Nildrif, Abbas Ardmachanus*

DATUM ARDMACHAE

Given at Armagh, in the year of Our Lord 70 AD